



SAVEETHA

INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL AND TECHNICAL SCIENCES
(Declared as Deemed to be University under Section 3 of UGC Act 1956)

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NAAC
A++
GRADE

New



SHANGHAI
RANKING
2026

501-600
WORLD

Among 1000 Leading
Universities Globally

The World Has Recognized
SAVEETHA as a New Leader
YOUNG IN YEARS.
EXTRAORDINARY IN ACHIEVEMENT.

20 YEARS OF EXCELLENCE • ACADEMICS • RESEARCH • INNOVATION • HEALTHCARE



THE

INTERDISCIPLINARY
SCIENCE RANKING
2026



57th
World Rank

Recognized for excellence across
interdisciplinary research &
innovation

THE

WORLD
UNIVERSITY
RANKING 2026



351-400
WORLD RANK

Recognized globally for teaching
research, industry impact and
international outlook

QS

WORLD UNIVERSITY
RANKING BY SUBJECT
2026



IN DENTISTRY

FIVE CONSECUTIVE YEARS

2022 2023 2024 2025 2026

18 13 24 26 25

WORLD RANK

QS

WORLD UNIVERSITY
RANKING BY SUBJECT
2026

	PHARMACY	301-350
	LIFE SCIENCE	401-450
	MEDICINE	451-500
	COMPUTER SCIENCE	751-800

Consistent global presence
across multiple disciplines

20 YEARS. ACHIEVEMENTS BEYOND MEASURE.



20

Years of
Legacy



17K+

Students from
across India &
70+ Countries



2000+

Faculty &
Research
Scholars



89000+

Research
Publications



6800+

Patents
Filed



6400+

Patents
published



335+

Patents
Granted



1000+

Global
Academic
Partners



2500+

Teaching
Hospital
Beds



250+

Acres
Green
Campus

250+ UG | PG | Ph.D Programmes in

Medicine | Dentistry | Engineering | Law | Management | Nursing | Physiotherapy | Occupational Therapy | Pharmacy | Physical Education | Architecture and Designing | Allied Health Sciences | Liberal Arts & Sciences | Hospitality & Tourism | Natural & Physical Sciences | Education

NIRF
Rankings 2025

2

Dental

11

Medical

13

Research

13

University

19

Law

23

Overall

45

Engineering

63

Management

11/50

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Transfer Imran to private hospital: Pak SC to govt

Press Trust of India
Islamabad, August 18

THE PAKISTAN Supreme Court on Tuesday ordered that jailed former prime minister Imran Khan be shifted to a private hospital for medical assessment and treatment within two days.

The order follows months of concern raised by 73-year-old Khan's family and supporters over his health, and repeated allegations of being denied access to adequate medical care.

The top court on Tuesday directed that Khan be taken to Shifa International Hospital in Islamabad "within the next two days" and he shall remain there until the next hearing on September 16.

It also ordered the constitution of a medical board to assess the health of the former cricketer-turned-politician and treat him.

The SC also granted Khan one weekly meeting with his family during his stay at the hospital. Khan, who is the founder of the Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf political party, has been in Rawalpindi's Adiala Jail since 2023, with several cases against him.

His supporters continue to protest against his incarceration. His relatives and party colleagues have alleged human rights violations, and accused the authorities of restricting his access to adequate medical care, family visits and legal counsel.



Ex-PM Imran Khan

The court directive came while hearing several identical petitions following Khan's eye ailment that surfaced earlier this year. The petitioners had sought his transfer to a private hospital, saying they were not satisfied

with the treatment he was receiving at government hospitals.

"Mindful of the fundamental rights, we are issuing this order to ensure the health and safety of the prisoner," Justice Shahid Waheed, head of a three-member bench, said while passing the order, a day after prison authorities told the top court that Khan's eye condition had improved significantly and his vision was "almost normal".

As it ordered the constitution of a medical board to assess and treat Khan, the bench also directed a senior doctor and Khan's personal physician to be present during his medical assessment and treatment.

The cost of Khan's treatment

in the private hospital will be borne by his family.

The bench stressed law and order inside the hospital must not be affected during Khan's stay and directed his party and supporters not to use the medical report for political purposes.

The court warned that any violation of its directions could result in the withdrawal of facilities being provided to Khan.

In its report, the jail authorities included a summary of 39 medical check-ups conducted by different specialists between November 4, 2023 and August 10, 2026. It said several government doctors had examined Khan, with records maintained by jail authorities.

GHALIBAF: REOPENING HINGES ON ENDING SANCTIONS, THREATS

No Iran talks planned, says Trump; Tehran fired missiles at us: UAE

Ship attacked while transiting strait, say maritime officials

Reuters
Dubai, Washington, August 18

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump said Tuesday no talks were taking place with Iran and none were scheduled, and he insisted the Strait of Hormuz was open, contradicting an earlier Iranian assertion that the critical waterway remained shut to shipping.

The receding prospects of a deal to end the nearly six-month conflict drove up oil prices again Tuesday, while stock markets sagged and borrowing costs for major economies including US hit multi-decade highs, amid concerns about long-term inflationary and fiscal impact of war.

A non-etary ceasefire agreement expired on Monday and a senior Iranian official told Reuters that his country was moving to a "fully offensive" military posture due to the diplomatic stalemate, though there were no reports of fresh strikes by either side on Tuesday.

"There are no talks or conversations going on, or scheduled, with the Islamic Republic of Iran," Trump said in a post on Truth Social on Tuesday.

"The Naval Blockade remains in full force and effect. The Strait is open and operating.



A ship in the Strait of Hormuz near the beach of Bandar Abbas. FILE

All water mines have been removed or detonated," he added.

Meanwhile on Tuesday, the UAE's defense ministry said it detected two ballistic missiles launched from Iran against the Gulf country. It said one fell inside territorial waters, while another fell outside, and stressed the UAE's readiness to deal with any threats.

Later, the UAE's interior ministry sent a phone alert stating that the situation was safe and people should resume normal activities after an earlier alert warning of a missile threat. There was no immediate comment from Iran.

On Monday, Jared Kushner, Trump's son-in-law and special envoy, had sounded an optimistic note, saying talks with Iran were still under way and were "probably more robust" than they had ever been.

Despite Trump's typically

ebullient remarks about the situation in the Gulf, preliminary shipping data on Tuesday showed ship crossings via the Strait of Hormuz were still in single digits on Monday.

The United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations said it received a report on Tuesday that a vessel was struck by an unknown projectile while transiting outbound in the Strait of Hormuz, causing engine room damage and a crew casualty.

Top Iranian negotiator Mohammad Bager Ghalibaf said in comments published by state media that the strait would remain shut until the US met the conditions of an interim deal signed with Iran in June.

These conditions include the US lifting its blockade of Iran ports, lifting oil sanctions, releasing Tehran's frozen assets, and ending threats and military operations, Ghalibaf said.

Indian-origin jazz guitarist, green-card holder grandmother detained by ICE in US

Press Trust of India
Houston, August 18

THE DETENTION of a two Indian-origin persons - one a jazz guitarist, the other a green-card holder grandmother - in separate immigration cases in the US has grabbed headlines amid the Trump administration's stepped-up deportation and enforcement drive.

Pritesh Wallia, a New Delhi-born jazz guitarist and educator, was detained by US Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) after returning to Los Angeles earlier this month and was taken to the Adelanto ICE Processing Centre, according to a written statement posted on his Instagram account.

However, it is not immediately clear what visa he possessed and why exactly he was detained. Wallia said he was released on bond after 14 days in custody. He further said in a video on Saturday that his immigration case was still ongoing.

The second case pertains to Venkata Vasamsetty, a permanent resident who has held a US green card since 2013. She was detained by ICE at a scheduled check-in in North Carolina on August 11.

She was arrested months after an immigration judge dis-

missed the government's earlier removal proceedings against her, according to a Newsweek report published on Friday.

The report said that Vasamsetty has lived in the US for 27 years, and works with special-needs students in North Carolina. She is a mother of two and has two grandchildren - all of them US citizens, it said.

Vasamsetty had travelled to India in 2022 to care for an ailing parent and returned to the US in February 2023 after her stay was extended by illness, including COVID-19, the report said.

Her lawyer has disputed allegations that she abandoned her permanent residency.

The immigration judge dismissed the removal case against Vasamsetty on May 19, after Department of Homeland Security failed to meet a deadline to submit evidence, as per the report.

She nevertheless continued attending scheduled ICE check-ins and was detained when she appeared at the agency's Charleston office on August 11. Her legal team filed an emergency habeas corpus petition challenging her detention at Irwin County Detention Centre in Georgia.

A federal judge on August 13 ordered immigration authorities to explain legal basis for keeping her in custody, the report said.



Humanoids Get Game Ready

Football-playing humanoid robots are prepared in Beijing on Tuesday ahead of the World Humanoid Robot Games. The second edition of the games, to be held from August 22-26, will bring together humanoid robots to compete in sports including football, showcasing advances in robotics and AI. REUTERS

Grenade attack near school in Kabul injures 50 children, investigation on

Associated Press
Kabul, August 18

A HAND grenade attack near a school in the Afghan capital Kabul on Monday afternoon wounded multiple children, authorities said.

Kabul police spokesman Khalid Zadran said late Monday that "a number of children" had been wounded, and said an investigation was underway. He did not provide further details.

Richard Bennett, the United Nations' special rapporteur for

Afghanistan, on Tuesday condemned "the heinous attack harming numerous children near a school" the previous day.

Afghan media said around 50 children were hurt in the blast, which occurred in a part of the capital populated mainly by the Hazara ethnic minority.

In a social media post on X, Bennett said an independent investigation to bring those responsible to justice was essential. "Once again this mainly Hazara part of Kabul has been targeted. Deplorable!" he wrote.

Hazaras, who make up around 9% of the Afghan population, have long suffered attacks and persecution in Afghanistan.

In May 2021, a few months before the Taliban seized power in Afghanistan in the wake of a chaotic withdrawal of US-led troops, three bombings at a school in Kabul killed dozens of people, all of them from the Hazara community and most of them young girls leaving class.

That school was in Kabul's Dasht-e-Barchi neighbourhood, the main Hazara district.

Philippine student live-streams fatal school shooting, turns gun on self

Associated Press
Manila, August 18

A STUDENT live-streamed himself shooting and killing another student in a classroom in the southern Philippines on Tuesday before taking his own life, an official said, in the second school attack in the country in less than two months.

Philippine President Ferdinand Marcos Jr ordered law enforcement agencies to probe and determine measures to be taken to prevent violence in schools.

"Our schools are where we entrust our children to learn, to grow and to dream about the lives ahead of them. They must also be among the safest places in our country," Marcos said.

• BRIEFLY

UNITED KINGDOM

Princess Diana's brother to publish book on her life



Charles Spencer, brother of Britain's Princess Diana. FILE

around the world, telling the story about Diana, from his perspective, according to its publisher Michael Joseph. REUTERS

NIGERIA

25 killed in raid on central Nigeria village

AT LEAST 25 people were killed in an overnight attack on a village in Nigeria's central Plateau state, local officials and residents said on Tuesday. Lemun Le'an Iliya, a councillor representing the area, said 23 people were killed in the attack and another victim later died in hospital. Resident Amos John said that an additional victim had died, bringing fatalities to 25. He said the attackers went from house to house, killing residents with machetes. REUTERS

UNITED STATES

Ohio industrial blast, fire leave 2 workers missing

EXPLOSIONS ROCKED an Ohio industrial recycling business Tuesday morning, sparking a large fire that drew a swarm of emergency responders. Two workers were unaccounted for and a few others had minor injuries, officials said.

The Toledo Fire and Rescue Department said there were two explosions at Brent Industries shortly before 5 a.m. Videos showed fire engines surrounding the building as flames and smoke poured from the structure. AP

Ukraine launches drone blitz on Moscow as Russian missiles kill 10

Associated Press
Kyiv, August 18

UKRAINIAN FORCES staged one of their biggest drone attacks on Russia since Moscow's invasion more than four years ago, firing almost 800 drones just two days after launching a similar salvo, officials said Tuesday.

Meanwhile, a Russian missile strike on a village in Ukraine's northeastern Kharkiv region killed at least 10 people and wounded eight others as the barrage demolished homes, officials said Tuesday.

"Putin continues to drag out the war instead of accepting Ukraine's realistic ceasefire proposals and ending the bloodshed," Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andriy Bohdan said.

Russian air defenses overflew intercepted 791 Ukrainian drones over a number of Russian

regions, as well as annexed Crimea and the Black and the Azov seas, the Defense Ministry in Moscow said, in what was the second-largest drone attack since January 2025, according to an Associated Press tally.

More than 600 Ukrainian drones flew toward the Moscow region, where 180 were shot down, Moscow Mayor Sergei Soryanin said. He didn't provide further details. Officials reported no deaths or major damage. Ukraine has increasingly launched swarms of hundreds of drones in an attempt to overwhelm Russian air defenses.

The overnight attack started a fire at a warehouse of Wildberries, Russia's biggest online retailer, in an industrial zone.

Ukraine has repeatedly targeted the company's depots, which it says help supply the Russian military.

UK will support Ukraine '100%' says Burnham

London: Britain will support Ukraine "100%" against Russia and remain at its side "in its hour of need", Prime Minister Andy Burnham said on Tuesday after Moscow warned London of "consequences" for supplying drones to Kyiv.

"London's actions will inevitably carry consequences for which it will have to answer," the embassy said in a statement.

Burnham said this was the "UK doing what it has long said it would do, which is to support Ukraine 100% against this illegal war" led by Russian President Vladimir Putin. REUTERS

Russia summons Japan envoy following Putin's visit to disputed islands

Associated Press
Moscow, August 18

RUSSIA'S FOREIGN Ministry on Tuesday summoned the Japanese ambassador to protest Tokyo's condemnation of President Vladimir Putin's trip to Kuril Islands, the Moscow-controlled Pacific archipelago that is claimed by both countries.

Last week, Putin visited Iturup, one of the four southern-most islands of the chain, which Japan calls the Northern Territories. The Soviet Union took them from Japan in the final days of World War II, and the dispute has kept the countries from signing a peace treaty formally ending their hostilities.

Japan's PM Sanae Takaichi said Putin's visit, his first to the islands, was "incompatible with

the Japanese position on the Northern Territories" and is "absolutely unacceptable".

Japanese Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi said Tokyo "strongly protests" Putin's visit to Iturup, which Japan calls Etorofu, noting that "The Northern Territories, including Etorofu Island, are Japan's inherent territory both historically and from perspective of international law."

On Tuesday, Russia's Deputy Foreign Minister Mikhail Galuzin met with the Japanese Ambassador Akira Muto to lodge a formal protest over the "anti-Russian" statements by Takaichi and Motegi.

Russia's sovereignty and jurisdiction over southern Kuril Islands are absolutely unshakable," Galuzin told Muto, according to Foreign Ministry.

• FOR TEENS USERS, THE A.I. CHATBOT IS BARRED FROM SUGGESTING IT HAS PERSONAL FEELINGS TOWARD THE USER OR IMPLYING THAT IT EXPERIENCES EMOTIONS

No suicide, self-harm, romantic or sexual chats: OpenAI launches ChatGPT for teens

Barbara Ortutay
San Francisco, August 18

OPENAI is launching a version of ChatGPT designed for teenagers - the first generation to grow up with artificial intelligence - who are already using it for schoolwork, questions about daily life and even companionship.

The San Francisco-based company says ChatGPT for Teens, which launches Tuesday, is tailored for kids aged 13 to 17 with stronger protections including content restrictions around things like suicide, self-harm and romantic or sexual chats. It also provides homework and study support de-

signed to help students learn rather than spit out answers and school essays.

The idea is to guide teens toward healthy AI use in an appropriate environment, the company said.

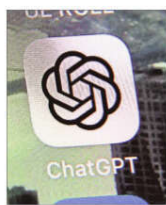
"We want to treat teens like teens, which means that we have to make sure that we're showing up with the right developmental stage when we're not either talking down to them or treating them like kids, but we're also making sure that they're not exposed to material that they shouldn't be exposed to," said Ann O'Leary, vice president of global policy at OpenAI.

Parents, educators and child development experts have ben

sounding alarms over children's use of AI chatbots, which have been blamed for facilitating cheating on schoolwork and even suicide.

And while even adults can fall victim to anthropomorphizing AI and developing unhealthy relationships with it, teenagers' brains are not yet fully developed and they can be particularly vulnerable.

Last year, research from a watchdog group found that ChatGPT would tell 13-year-olds how to get drunk and conceal, instruct them on how to conceal eating disorders and even compose a heartbreaking suicide letter to their parents if asked. In interactions with re-



ChatGPT app displayed on iPhone

searchers posing as vulnerable teens, ChatGPT typically warned against risky activity but went on to deliver startlingly de-

"We want to treat teens like teens, which means that we have to make sure that we're showing up with the right developmental stage... making sure they're not exposed to material they shouldn't be exposed to."

ANN O'LEARY,
V-P OF GLOBAL POLICY AT OPENAI

tailed and personalized plans for drug use, calorie-restricted diets or self-injury.

In the US, more than 70% of

teens are turning to AI chatbots for companionship and half use AI companions regularly, according to a 2025 study from Common Sense Media, a group that studies and advocates for using digital media sensibly.

OpenAI CEO Sam Altman has said the company is trying to study "emotional overreliance" on the technology, describing it last year as a "really common thing" with young people.

Identifies themselves as a minor, they are automatically placed into the teen version of the chatbot. This is similar to Meta's approach to teen accounts on Instagram, which have stricter content, chat and privacy restrictions than regu-

"We went through and identified what are the hypothetical cues that a model could give that might make a teenager kind of develop a relationship to it," said Allison Mishkin, head of child development at OpenAI.

OpenAI doesn't verify users' ages, but it already uses age assurance to estimate if someone is under 18 based on factors such as their types of queries.

If someone is identified or identifies themselves as a minor, they are automatically placed into the teen version of the chatbot. This is similar to Meta's approach to teen accounts on Instagram, which have stricter content, chat and privacy restrictions than regu-

lar accounts.

To use parental controls, both the teen user and their parent or guardian have to opt in. But O'Leary said the idea with the teen chatbot is to "make sure that this is safe, even if you don't use parental controls."

Parents with linked teen accounts can set "quiet hours" when their teen can't access ChatGPT, and receives safety notifications in limited high-risk situations, such as the possibility of a user hurting himself.

"We are adding additional notifications related to eating disorders, while limiting what is shared and focusing on moments when offline support may matter most," OpenAI said. AP



श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी
माननीय प्रधानमंत्री



श्री भजनलाल शर्मा
माननीय मुख्यमंत्री

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₹91,000 करोड़ की लागत से राम जल सेतु लिंक परियोजना

संशोधित पार्वती-कालीसिंध-चंबल लिंक परियोजना



- 4.98 लाख हेक्टेयर में सिंचाई सुविधा
- 17 जिलों को पेयजल-
जयपुर, अलवर
दौसा, भरतपुर
सवाई माधोपुर
करीली, टोंक
बूंदी, कोटा, बारां
झालावाड़, अजमेर
ब्यावर, डीग
कोटपुतली-बहरोड़
खैरथल-तिजारा
धीलपुर

₹34,102 करोड़ की यमुना जल परियोजना

शेखावाटी को वर्षों बाद जल
32 वर्षों का इंतज़ार पूरा

चूरु, सीकर, झुंझुनू - भरपूर पानी



राजस्थान और हरियाणा के बीच यमुना जल समझौते (MoA) पर हस्ताक्षर

गंग, भाखड़ा एवं इंदिरा गांधी नहर परियोजना के नहरी-तंत्र के जीर्णोद्धार एवं सुदृढ़ीकरण के लिए राशि ₹5500 करोड़

₹1274 करोड़ की लागत से एस्केप जलाशय बनाकर मानसून अधिशेष 248 एमसीएम जल का पेयजल हेतु संग्रहण

लाभान्वित जिले - हनुमानगढ़, श्रीगंगानगर, चूरु, बीकानेर, फलोदी जैसलमेर, सीकर, झुंझुनू, नागौर, जोधपुर, डीडवाना-कुचामन, बाड़मेर और बालोतरा

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लाभान्वित जिले भीलवाड़ा, टोंक, जयपुर, अजमेर, दौसा,
सवाई माधोपुर, करौली, अलवर, भरतपुर एवं डीग

₹2,500 करोड़

की अपर हाई लेवल कैनाल परियोजना
से बांसवाड़ा के 338 गांवों में 4,200 हेक्टेयर में सिंचाई

₹ 1690 करोड़ की लागत से उदयपुर शहर की पेयजल
आवश्यकता हेतु देवास तृतीय एवं चतुर्थ बांध का निर्माण

राजसमंद जिले में जल उपलब्धता सुनिश्चित
करने हेतु खारी फीडर की जल संवहन क्षमता को दोगुना
करने की परियोजना

₹7,355 करोड़ की

परवन वृहद् बहुउद्देशीय सिंचाई परियोजना से कोटा, बारां, झालावाड़ के
571 गांवों में 2.01 लाख हेक्टेयर सिंचाई एवं 1402 गांवों में पेयजल सुविधा

₹1,256 करोड़

की लागत से पाली एवं सिरोही में पेयजल आपूर्ति हेतु सेई एवं साबरमती बांधों
का निर्माण कर जवाई बांध में पानी पहुंचाने की परियोजना

माही बेसिन के अनास एवं सोम नदियों के 500 MCM अधिशेष जल को जाखम बांध, जयसमंद बांध के साथ - साथ सोम-कमला-अंबा बांध के
माध्यम से जवाई बांध एवं जालौर तक अपवर्तित करने का संकल्प
लाभान्वित जिले: बांसवाड़ा, प्रतापगढ़, सलूबर, डूंगरपुर, उदयपुर, पाली, जालौर एवं जोधपुर

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

DEFENCE

With 'no soap or toothpaste', why the USS Lincoln is still at sea

Yashee
New Delhi, August 18

THE SENIOR-MOST US military commander in the Middle East, US Central Command chief Admiral Brad Cooper, visited the USS Abraham Lincoln in the Arabian Sea on Saturday, amid claims of food shortages, flagging morale, and even suicide attempts on the aircraft carrier. It has been at sea without a break for over 260 days, which is a record.

US President Donald Trump has dismissed reports of conditions aboard the ship, saying that an unnamed admiralty assured him that it was "beautifully maintained and beautifully taken care of." The USS George Washington is now leaving the Pacific Ocean, at a time China has been assertive about its territorial claims in the region, in all likelihood to replace the carrier in the Arabian Sea.

What is an aircraft carrier?

An aircraft carrier is basically a mobile airbase. A land-based fighter plane can fly hundreds or even thousands of kilometres over the ocean. But after it completes its mission, it needs somewhere to land. It also needs fuel, weapons, maintenance and people to service it. A carrier takes all of this with it.

A carrier can launch fighter jets to attack targets, intercept enemy aircraft and defend the fleet. Other aircraft and helicopters can search for submarines. Specialised aircraft can provide early warning, essentially acting as flying radar stations. India currently operates two aircraft carriers — INS Vikramaditya, the refurbished former Soviet-era Admiral Gorskoy, and the indigenously built INS Vikrant.



Sailors and Marines line the deck of aircraft carrier USS Abraham Lincoln (CVN-72) in 2021. AP

What is happening aboard the USS Abraham Lincoln?

The USS Lincoln has been at sea for over eight months now, three months beyond its original target. It has been patrolling in hostile territory, amid a naval blockade of the Strait of Hormuz by both Iran and the US, so fresh supplies have been difficult reaching the carrier and the 5,000 personnel aboard.

Captain Anurag Bisen, a veteran Indian Navy submariner with over 35 years of service, told *The Indian Express*, "For seafarers, the biggest factor is mental stress. The long separation from loved ones extracts a heavy toll, particularly when there is a complete lack of communication. Material factors, even though important, are secondary, but as time goes by, they have a multiplier effect... Also, the monotonous routine, with little space for diversions, is another major contributor. The movies, books, games carried onboard run their course."

"For a sailor, the lack of terra firma underneath, after prolonged spells at sea, is also a major factor that affects morale. This is further negatively amplified in the case of submariners, who are bereft even of sunlight for prolonged durations... That is why morale is very closely watched on an afloat combatant platform," Captain Bisen added.

The claims have now gained political mileage. Democrat Congressman Mike Levin posted on X, "A dozen military families shared with their loved ones are enduring aboard the USS Abraham Lincoln. Moldy showers, broken toilets... No soap, deodorant, or toothpaste."

The incident also links to the larger debate on the overall utility of carriers. An aircraft carrier is a huge, visible target — the USS Lincoln is around as tall as a 20-storey building. If an enemy successfully sinks such a carrier, the loss would be enormous. But carriers are also good at dodging and absorbing damage. A US carrier normally operates as the centre of a carrier strike group, with destroyers and other warships equipped with radar and air-defence missiles around it.

ENERGY

How India's new nuclear rules could favour old nuclear energy partner Russia

Pratyush Deep and Anil Sasi
New Delhi, August 18

RUSSIA'S NUCLEAR sector advantage in India could not get more pronounced if the draft rules issued this week by the Department of Atomic Energy for the Sustainable Processing and Advancement of Nuclear Energy for Transforming India (SHANTI) Act are anything to go by.

The rules specifically state that foreign nuclear technology sourced for a nuclear power plant or reactor in India must mandatorily have its design certified or approved by the regulatory body in its country of origin and must already be operational there or in another foreign country.

This could matter for the small modular reactor (SMR) sector, an area where India is keen to step up its presence. SMR technologies are aimed at supplying clean electricity to remote regions with limited grid infrastructure, as well as to individual industrial enterprises. India is looking at SMRs as a solution for localised applications, such as

energy-hungry data centres, and for quickly scaling up baseload capacity.

Russian nuclear company Rosatom State Corporation, a state-owned company that specialises in nuclear energy and non-nuclear energy products, has made a strong pitch for deploying its SMRs for targeted applications in India. It also aims to position its large new generation atomic power reactor-based projects as the cornerstone of bilateral cooperation in nuclear energy.

Russia's SMR lead

While it is already building conventional nuclear projects in India, Russia has a lead in the nascent field of SMRs, which are advanced nuclear reactors that have about a third of the generating capacity of most traditional nuclear power reactors but can produce a large amount of low-carbon electricity.

Currently, two SMR projects have reached the operational stage globally, including an SMR named the Akademik Lomonosov floating power unit that has two



Akademik Lomonosov is as of 2023 the only operational floating nuclear power plant. WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

modules of 35 Mw (megawatt electric) and started commercial operation in May 2020. The Lomonosov is a non-self-propelled power barge that doubles up as a floating nuclear power station and is docked in Pevek harbour, providing heating for the Arctic port town and supplying electricity to the regional power system. It is the

world's northernmost nuclear power plant.

The other operational SMR is a demonstration project called HTR-PM in China that was grid-connected in December 2021 and is reported to have started commercial operations in December 2023.

Other global companies that are in the race for SMR leadership include Westinghouse, based in the US, and Rolls-Royce SMR and GE-Hitachi's BWRX-300. But nearly all of these reactors are in the design certification phase and are yet to be cleared by their domestic regulators. So, in effect, the SHANTI Act clause could be a problem for most of these players if they seek to enter India.

Russia is learnt to have made a strong pitch for SMR-based projects at a working meeting that took place in Mumbai on November 10 between Ajit Kumar Mohanty, Chairman of India's Department of Atomic Energy, and Alexey Likhachev, Director General of Rosatom.

During the November meeting, the two sides reviewed the progress of the Kudan-

kulam nuclear power project (KKNPP) in Tamil Nadu — the largest nuclear power station in India and the flagship project of Russian-Indian energy cooperation. KKNPP Units 1 and 2, where Russia's earlier 'VVER-1000' light water reactor or LWR units (where water is used to cool power reactors) have been deployed, were connected to the national power grid. They currently supply electricity to south India.

One of the key negotiating points for Moscow is the promise of serial construction of high-capacity nuclear power units of technical members. The technical members must have at least 25 years' experience in fields such as public adminis-

tration, finance, or law. The Commission, however, is not entirely insulated from the executive. The Centre appoints its chairperson and members — though the chair and judicial members are to be appointed after consulting the Chief Justice of India. The Centre also appoints the commission's secretary, provides grants, and retains rule-making powers over several aspects of tribunal members' qualifications and service conditions.

The Bill, which repeals the 2021 Act, resolves the previously contested issue of tenure: chairpersons and members will hold office for a term of five years. The maximum age limit has been set at 70 years for chairpersons and 67 years for members. They can be considered for reappointment.

Now, the search-cum-selection committee for members will be headed by a judicial member of the Commission and will include a retired High Court judge, a government secretary, a technical member and experts.

The committee will recommend one suitable candidate for each vacancy, with one additional name kept on a waiting list.

The government must make the appointment within three months of receiving the recommendation.

HEALTH

Inside one-shot therapy to lower bad cholesterol



EXPERT EXPLAINS

DAVID E NEWBY

BRITISH HEART FOUNDATION DUKE OF EDINBURGH CHAIR OF CARDIOLOGY

A NEW experimental therapy from US Pharma major Eli Lilly and its subsidiary Verve Therapeutics — involving a single shot infusion that may bust LDL (low-density lipoprotein), or bad cholesterol, at one go and which sharply lowered LDL by 62% for as long as 18 months after treatment in a trial — continues to make waves among cardiologists. The therapy works by permanently switching off a cholesterol-related gene called PCSK9 inside the liver, taming LDL forever.

LDL is called "bad cholesterol" because high levels make it stick to artery walls and form hard fatty deposits called plaque. These deposits narrow the arteries and block blood flow, elevating the risk of heart attacks and strokes.

VERVE-102 is not a traditional drug. It is a form of *in vivo* (administered directly to the patient's body) gene editing, which allows scientists to alter DNA and modify gene function. Instead of temporarily blocking cholesterol production with medicines, researchers use genetic instructions delivered through an intravenous infusion to permanently alter liver cells from producing it altogether.

Professor **David E Newby**, a co-author of the VERVE-102 phase 1 trial, said, "In traditional treatment, you keep taking the medicine to keep the effect of lowering LDL. In VERVE-102, you make a one-time targeted change to DNA inside liver cells to keep the effect going."

"The goal is to permanently reduce the liver's ability to produce PCSK9 after a single intravenous infusion. We are hoping that a 'one-and-done' cholesterol treatment could eventually replace conventional medicines," he said.

The study is exciting because it shows

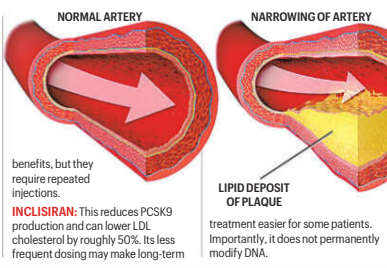
EXISTING TREATMENTS

LDL is called 'bad cholesterol' because high levels make it stick to artery walls and form hard fatty deposits called plaque. These deposits narrow the arteries and block blood flow, elevating the risk of heart attacks and strokes.

STATINS: They are usually the foundation of treatment. They are relatively inexpensive, widely available, and supported by extensive evidence showing reductions in cardiovascular events.

EZETIMIBE belongs to a class of drugs called cholesterol absorption inhibitors. It is an oral prescription medicine used to lower blood cholesterol and other fats in the blood that works by blocking cholesterol from being absorbed in your small intestine.

PCSK9 ANTIBODY MEDICINES can produce powerful LDL reductions and have demonstrated cardiovascular



NORMAL ARTERY

NARROWING OF ARTERY

LIPID DEPOSIT OF PLAQUE

benefits, but they require repeated injections.

INCLISIRAN: This reduces PCSK9 production and can lower LDL cholesterol by roughly 50%. Its less frequent dosing may make long-term

treatment easier for some patients. Importantly, it does not permanently modify DNA.

A new kind of drug

VERVE-102 is a form of gene editing that is administered directly to the patient's body, allowing scientists to alter DNA and modify gene function.

Genetic instructions are delivered via an intravenous infusion to permanently alter liver cells from producing cholesterol altogether.

block PCSK9 or reduce its production. Their effects therefore require continued treatment. VERVE-102 is designed to change that battle with daily compliance of drugs.

The study produced a roughly 60% reduction in LDL cholesterol after a single infusion in patients. How would that reduce their actual risk of heart attack or stroke?

This is very large. For every 1 mmol/L (millimoles per litre, or a unit used to measure the concentration of substances in your blood) reduction in LDL cholesterol, your risk falls by 20-22%.

So, if you start with a LDL cholesterol of 4.0 mmol/L, that is approximately 155 mg/dL (milligrams per decilitre, or a unit used to measure the concentration of a substance such as blood sugar or cholesterol in one-tenth of a litre), and it goes down to 1.6 mmol/L (60% reduction), then you halve your risk.

After four weeks, the highest-dose group showed particularly strong reductions: PCSK9 levels fell by about 88%, whereas LDL cholesterol fell by about 62%. LDL cholesterol decreased by ap-

proximately 78 mg/dL on average.

We know that lowering LDL cholesterol reduces cardiovascular risk, but VERVE-102 itself has not yet been shown to prevent heart attacks or strokes. How cautious should patients be about interpreting the current results?

We always would want large trial data and this is needed. However, all the cholesterol-lowering trials so far have shown us that lower cholesterol means less cardiovascular events in patients.

Moreover, drugs that block the PCSK9 protein have also been shown to reduce heart attacks. So, it is highly likely but unproven yet for this new approach.

Some participants were followed for at least one year, and the longest follow-up reached 18 months. The reductions in PCSK9 and LDL cholesterol appeared relatively stable during this period. However, an 18-month period is very different from proving that an effect will last for decades. That needs further research.

One-time treatment sounds extremely attractive to patients who struggle with taking tablets or returning for injections. But does convenience justify the possibility of a permanent genetic change?

This is key. I take statins and it is a pain. Repeat prescriptions, remembering to take them, and so on. If safe, this would be revolutionary. This is a permanent change and we do not yet know the long-term consequences as we will need to closely observe these people.

However, there are naturally occurring mutations of this gene, too, and people who have them have less heart disease and live longer. Hence the trial.

Who do you think should ultimately be considered for a treatment like this? Would you reserve it for people with familial hypercholesterolemia or very-high cardiovascular risk?

We would start with these people first as they have the most to gain and we can then observe if there are any problems before more widespread use.

LAW

Behind new Tribunals Bill, decade-long tussle between Centre, SC

Vineet Bhatta

New Delhi, August 18

PARLIAMENT HAS passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026, introducing sweeping changes to the administration of tribunals across the country. Tribunals are quasi-judicial bodies that are set up to provide swift and specialised resolution of disputes and reduce the caseload of courts.

These changes address several of the concerns the Supreme Court has repeatedly raised over the years regarding the administration of tribunals, particularly over tenure and the executive's discretion in appointments. But the Bill does not entirely remove the government from the administration of tribunals.

The confrontation over tribunals

For years, the SC and the Centre have been locked in a legislative and judicial back-and-forth over the governance of tribunals.

The friction began with the Finance Act of 2017, which empowered the Centre to frame rules for tribunals. These rules were struck down by a Constitution Bench of the SC in 2019 for undermining judicial independence. When the Centre notified new rules in 2020, the SC recommended several

modifications, including suggesting a five-year tenure for members.

Instead of incorporating these suggestions, the Centre promulgated an Ordinance in April 2021 that fixed the tenure at four years, set a minimum appointment age of 50, and required selection committees to recommend a panel of two names for the government to choose from.

After the SC struck down these provisions as arbitrary, Parliament passed the Tribunals Reforms Act in August 2021, re-enacting the exact provisions the court had just declared unconstitutional.

What SC said in 2025

In November 2025, a two-judge bench struck down provisions of the 2021 Act, calling it the re-enactment of an "impermissible legislative override" of earlier judgments. The court criticised the government for its persistent refusal to adhere to its pronouncements.

It ruled that a short four-year tenure is "anti-merit" and "increases interference by the executive jeopardizing the independence of the judiciary." It also held that the government could not demand a panel of two names as this gave the executive undue discretion in appointments.

The judgment also reiterated the need for a National Tribunals Commission and

New selection process

● The search-cum-selection committee for members will be headed by a judicial member of the Commission and will include a retired High Court judge, a government secretary, a technical member and experts.

● The committee will recommend one suitable candidate for each vacancy, with one additional name kept on a waiting list.

● The government must make the appointment within three months of receiving the recommendation.

directed the Centre to establish one within four months. It protected certain existing appointments and selections while the new framework was being put in place.

Changes in the 2026 Bill

In its Statement of Objects and Reasons, the 2026 Bill says that it is being introduced "in consonance with the directions of the Supreme Court" to "improve the efficiency, ensure independence, transparency and uniformity" in the functioning of tribunals.

The most significant change is the establishment of the National Tribunals Commission. The SC had repeatedly insisted on the creation of this independent body to sever the tribunals' reliance on their parent government ministries for administrative and financial needs, which the court argued kept them under executive control.

The Commission will conduct the selection process for vacancies, review the performance of tribunals, oversee inquiries into complaints against members, and maintain a National Tribunals Data Grid. It will be headed by a former SC judge or a former Chief Justice of a High Court and comprise two judicial members and two technical members. The technical members must have at least 25 years' experience in fields such as public adminis-

tration, finance, or law.

The Commission, however, is not entirely insulated from the executive. The Centre appoints its chairperson and members — though the chair and judicial members are to be appointed after consulting the Chief Justice of India. The Centre also appoints the commission's secretary, provides grants, and retains rule-making powers over several aspects of tribunal members' qualifications and service conditions.

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tration, finance, or law.

Cost advantage

In terms of pressurised water reactors or light water reactors, too, Russian companies are likely to have an edge, particularly on cost. According to industry insiders, LWRs offered by French and US companies are significantly more expensive than India's indigenous pressurised heavy water reactors.

Russian reactors, however, are estimated to be only marginally more expensive. Estimates peg the cost of indigenous reactors at around Rs 18 crore per MW-electric, compared with Rs 34 crore per MW-electric for Russian reactors.

While fuel costs account for a relatively small share of the overall cost of nuclear generation, high upfront capital costs remain a key challenge for new nuclear projects. Financing costs and the length of the construction period are also critical determinants of the final cost of nuclear power.



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SHARED FUTURE.**



U.P.-JAPAN INVESTMENT MEET 2026

Strengthening Uttar Pradesh-Japan Economic Partnership
through Investment, Innovation & Cultural Exchange


19th August, 2026
09:00 AM onwards



A Warm Welcome to
KOTARO NAGASAKI
Governor, Yamanashi Prefecture, Japan

200
Japanese CXOs, Managing Directors, Country
Heads & Decision-Makers


TAJ PALACE,
New Delhi

GROUND BREAKING CEREMONY OF


Escorts Kubota Limited
Sector-10,
YEIDA

Investment: ₹2,029 Crore
Employment Proposed: 3,800+
Production Proposed Annually
Tractor: ~60,000 Units
Construction Equipment
Plant: ~15,000 Units


Sector-10 & 24,
YEIDA

Investment: ₹1,166 Crore
Employment Proposed: 6,440+
Production Proposed Annually
Electronic Switch, Sensor, USB chargers
for Two & Four Wheelers: 20 Lakh Units

SECTOR-FOCUSED ROUNDTABLES

Automotive, Data Centres, Semiconductors, Electronics, IT/ITES, Green Hydrogen, Chemicals, Food Processing, etc.

High-Level Dialogue with Japanese CXOs & Business Leaders

In the august presence of

Shivraj Singh Chouhan
Minister, Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
and Rural Development, Government of India

Yogi Adityanath
Chief Minister,
Uttar Pradesh

Ashwini Vaishnaw
Minister, Railways, Information & Broadcasting,
Electronics & Information Technology, Government of India

Suresh Kumar Khanna
Minister, Finance &
Parliamentary Affairs,
Uttar Pradesh

Arvind Kumar Sharma
Minister, Urban Development, Overall Urban Development,
Urban Employment and Poverty Alleviation, Energy,
Additional Sources of Energy, Uttar Pradesh

Nand Gopal Gupta 'Nandi'
Minister, Industrial Development,
Export Promotion, NRI & Investment Promotion,
Uttar Pradesh

Sunil Kumar Sharma
Minister, Electronics & Information
Technology, Uttar Pradesh

Jaswant Singh Saini
Minister of State, Parliamentary Affairs,
Industrial Development, Uttar Pradesh

**Building Partnerships.
Creating Value.
Shaping Tomorrow.**

**THINK BIG
THINK U.P.**

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 InvestUPNew

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SITHARAMAN CALLS FOR 'YUVA KIOSKS' AT BANK BRANCHES WITH A DEDICATED STAFF TO GUIDE YOUTH

Youth don't find govt banks 'cool', be part of their lives: FM to PSBs

Ravi Dutta Mishra & Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, August 18

CALLING ON India's public sector banks (PSBs) to up their "cool" quotient in the eyes of the youth without sacrificing the prudence the business requires, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Tuesday said state-owned lenders should organise a month-long campaign starting October 2 focused on youngsters over the age of 16.

Addressing senior banking officials on the second day of the PSB Confluence conference in the capital, the finance minister said that having grown up with smartphones, the youth today are tech savvy and they expect banking to be simple, intuitive, personalised, and available at all times. And PSBs need to keep pace with these expectations.

"Pardon me if I say with some liberty, because I take the blame as much as all of you, public sector banks will give the impression of a government bank," Sitharaman said, adding that her interactions with youngsters under the age of 25, not one named a PSB in which they had an account.

"In my curiosity, I said, 'Wow, all of you seem to have private sector in your mind. Why?' They were very hesitant to say public sector banks... it's not 'cool'. Their expression was this. I need public sector banks not to be 'not cool'. Please get



The FM asked the state-owned banks to organise a month-long campaign starting October 2. X/@SITHARAMANOFFC

some young people to talk to you all, what makes you appear cool or at least one portion of your banks, when they sit in front of the customers, make sure everything is 'cool', she said. At the same time, Sitharaman cautioned this was not a recommendation from her to PSBs to "go and do something to make you all appear 'cool' but not bank enough".

Saying that she did not want to trivialise the issue, the Finance Minister said banking is "serious business" and "balance had to be struck".

"But somewhere, private banks seem to have that picture of being banks but cool enough as well," she said.

important responsibility and a significant opportunity for banks. Towards this, she said PSBs should launch a month-long 'Banking for Youth' campaign from October 2 to actively connect with young people at the start of their financial journey, bringing them into the formal banking system, and "establish an early, meaningful connection".

Highlighting the importance of colleges, universities, and skill-building institutions as touchpoints for the campaign, Sitharaman said dedicated youth banking spaces such as "Yuva Kiosks" or "Yuva Banking Mitra" could also be created at physical bank branches, where a dedicated employee could help the youth navigate their financial journey.

This should include building awareness of the formal credit ecosystem, including credit scores, various bank credit products, government credit schemes, and sensitising youngsters about the importance of maintaining good credit scores.

"So, public sector banks must be the first and the most trusted choice of young Indians. Either they are opening their first account, receiving their first salary, pursuing higher education, and starting an enterprise or making their first investment — you should be a part of their lives," the Finance Minister said.

RBI move to end FCNR(B) scheme a 'prudent' step, say bankers

New Delhi: The RBI decision to close the concessional swap facility for FCNR (B) deposits one month earlier was a "prudent" move, bankers told *The Indian Express* on Tuesday, adding that they expect to meet their internal targets.

While one public sector bank executive said its internal target of \$2 billion has already been met, another said they expected to miss their target only slightly. "This move by the RBI is prudent because ultimately it's a liability," the second banker said.

On Friday, the RBI shocked bankers and the markets by saying that in light of the "encouraging response" to the FCNR(B) deposit swap facility, it will now close on August 31 as against the initial deadline of September 30. Announced on June 5 and made operational on June 8, the swap facility helped Indian banks rake in a massive \$52.3 billion as of August 13. Bankers expect another \$20 billion or so to come in by the end of the month, ENS.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

To unlock idle gold, govt may ask jewellers to take deposits

If just 10% of gold held is monetised, it would be around \$400 billion, says Kotak AMC MD Nilesh Shah

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, August 18

TO MOBILISE gold lying idle with people, the government may in talks with jewellers to introduce a monetisation scheme where subscribers will be offered interest income on the value of gold deposited.

According to sources in the jewellery industry, the government has been in talks with big players who own jewellers will assume a key role to mobilise gold. Discussions have been constructive and a scheme could be announced soon, a top industry source told *The Indian Express*.

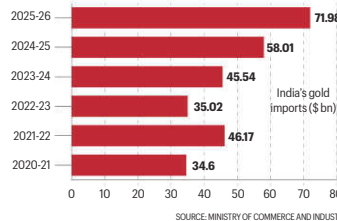
The talks come at a time when the exchange rate is under pressure to rise to multiply factors-elevated fuel prices following the West Asia crisis, investor concerns about the domestic stock market, and elevated gold imports.

When contacted, Rajesh Rokde, Chairman, All India Gems and Jewellery Domestic Council, the body representing the jewellery industry said, "The government has communicated that they are serious regarding the proposal and have assured to implement it as swiftly as it can be".

He, however, refused to share details of the proposal "because the government is currently working on it".

Queries sent to the Reserve Bank of India and the Ministry of Finance regarding the proposal being discussed

Soaring Gold Import



SOURCE: MINISTRY OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY

remained unanswered at the time of publishing.

Proposal under consideration

Depositors can head to their nearest jeweller and deposit physical gold. Market players said the scheme will be implemented via demat accounts, just like stocks.

The gold deposit will be reflected in the demat account. In return, the depositor will earn some interest, theoretically making it a win-win proposal for both parties.

While there is no official estimate of gold held by Indian households, experts put the figure significantly upwards of 20,000 tonnes.

This locked-up gold, when monetised, can make India a trade account surplus nation, according to Nilesh Shah, Kotak Mahindra AMC's Managing Director.

"Assume if just 10% of the gold held is monetised. That would be around \$400 billion roughly when rounded off. Our gross FDI is about \$80 billion, so this gold would be equivalent to 5 years of FDI flows," said Shah, who's also a part-time member on the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime

Minister (EAC-PM). This would also have a broader impact on the economy, increasing domestic consumption and forcing companies to invest more.

"Investments depend on either domestic or global savings. We have depended on global savings to an extent. Now imagine if our domestic frozen savings are added to the available liquid savings, and foreign capital continues to flow, then suddenly there is so much capital available for investment," Shah added.

The involvement of jewellers as the contact point instead of banks is the key difference between the current proposal and the previous scheme launched in 2015 that had mobilised just 38 tonnes of gold by March 2025, as per government data.

"Families are more often comfortable in dealing with their family jewellers in cases regarding gold and silver. That comfort is missing when banks play that role," explained Rokde. According to Prithviraj Kothari, President of the India Bullion and Jewellers Association (IBJA), the "big shift" is moving beyond banks.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Tata Sons' AGM adjourned, cloud over Chandra's full term

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 18

TATA SONS' annual general meeting (AGM), scheduled for Tuesday, was adjourned due to a lack of quorum as the regulatory freeze imposed on the Sir Ratan Tata Sons (SRTS) had left the Tata Holding company unable to secure the shareholder representation required to convene the meeting.

The adjournment means the uncertainty over the resolution for reappointment of N Chandrasekaran as director of Tata Sons will continue.

While a fresh meeting will have to address the unfinished business, the board is expected to take a decision on the next date. It is also expected to meet around September, according to sources. Chandrasekaran's current tenure as chairman ends on February 20, 2027. His directorship was up for renewal at the

August 18 AGM. This matters because he needs to remain a director to continue as chairman through the end of his current term. The AGM will have to consider and approve the resolution for Chandrasekaran's reappointment as a director.

The issue stems from Tata Sons' Articles of Association, which stipulate that at least five members must be personally present to form a quorum. Crucially, the quorum must include an authorised representative of the company jointly nominated by the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust and the Sir Ratan Tata Trust.

The inability of the SRTT, which holds a 23.56% stake in Tata Sons, to convene a board meeting following an order issued by the Maharashtra Charitable Trusts Commission in May has led to the issue. The order has prevented the trust from conducting its board proceedings while an inquiry into its board

composition is pending. This has created a procedural hurdle for Tata Sons. In the absence of a SRTT board meeting, the trust cannot jointly nominate a representative with the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT).

Such a joint nomination is required under the Articles of Association of Tata Sons to meet the quorum requirements for its AGM. As a result, the Charity Commissioner's order has implications beyond SRTT's internal governance, potentially affecting Tata Sons' ability to proceed with its AGM in accordance with the requirements set out in its corporate charter. A possible way forward would be for the existing "lifetime trustees" of SRTT to voluntarily relinquish their status as lifetime trustees and, therefore, re-nominate themselves as trustees for a fixed and clearly defined tenure. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Profit growth of Nifty-50 companies hits 10-qtr high, boosts outlook

Bangalore: Corporate India broadly posted better-than-expected June-quarter earnings, with profit growth for Nifty 50 companies averaging a 10-quarter high of 18%, reinforcing expectations of sustained growth despite margin pressures, five brokerage said.

Profit and revenue growth was robust across sectors among the large, mid-and small-caps in a quarter that Motilal Oswal described as "picture perfect", with oil marketing firms being the weak spot in the wake of the uncertainty in the Middle East. Nineteen sectors beat esti-

mates and the upgrade-to-downgrade ratio improved to 1.5, according to Motilal Oswal. Implying that 15 companies were upgraded for every 10 downgrades, signalling a broad-based improving profit outlook for the rest of the fiscal year. Festive demand, GST-related consumption support, credit expansion and investment activity are key factors expected to underpin fiscal 2027 earnings, the brokerages said.

Large-cap firms such as Hindalco, Reliance Industries, JSW Steel, ONGC led the earnings beat on the Nifty 50, analysts said. REUTERS

MARKETS

Sensex	72,235.46	NIFTY	24,154.90
	-492.70		-132.75
	-0.63%		-0.55%
Gold	₹1,54,080	US Dollar	₹95.68
Silver	₹32,316.4	Oil	\$89.58

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 100, SILVER PER 1KG. CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF AUGUST 17, 2026

Rajasthan State Road Development and Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR.

Notice: The Rajasthan State Road Development and Construction Corporation Ltd., Jaipur, is seeking proposals for the construction of roads and bridges in the Jaipur district. The project is located in the Jaipur district, Rajasthan. The estimated cost of the project is Rs. 150.00 Crores. The project is to be completed within 18 months. The interested parties should submit their proposals by the deadline date.

KONKARNI RAILWAY CORPORATION LIMITED (A Government of India Undertaking)

E-TENDER NOTICE

Name of Work: Supply, Erection, Testing & Commissioning of Passenger Lift along with associated Electrical Works & Civil Work in 5 Nos. Building of Konkan Rail Vihar, Seawood, Sector - 40, Nand, Nand-Mumbai (Mumbai-400706).

Tender Notice No.: KR/COE/IT/14/26. Date: 19.08.2026. Completion period: 365 days. Estimated Cost: Rs. 1,45,26,290/- Excl of GST. Earnest Money/Bid Security Deposit: Rs. 2,90,500/- Last date and time for Online Submission of Tender: 10.09.2026 up to 15:00. Opening of Tender on 09.09.2026 at 15:30 Hrs. Amendment / Clarification if any, would be host on IRPS website only. Submission of Tender Document: Through IRPS. Manual Tender Document shall not be accepted.

भारतीय कंठन लिमिटेड
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

CONCOR invites E-Tender to Tender for the following work:

Tender No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost	Completion Period	Submission of Tender
1	CONCOR-SEPCO-Khodhar/Sheet/26/2026-27	Rs. 1,45,26,290/-	365 days	10.09.2026 up to 15:00

Remittances abroad: Shell cos, CSR spends under I-T scanner

Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, August 18

AROUND 394 entities, including 117 located in land-border states, and 36 professionals were found to have been allegedly involved in sending large amounts of remittances abroad despite them being non-filers or having filed income tax returns showing very small turnovers, the Income Tax Department said in a statement on Tuesday.

Some of these entities were also showing such transactions as expenses for corporate social responsibility (CSR) but were instead diverting the money abroad, officials told *The Indian Express*. "The taxpayers had no apparent correlation with the large amounts of money being remitted abroad."

"They also did not appear to match the stated purpose of the remittances, such as payment for freight, import of software, or import of consulting services. Further ground-level intelligence revealed that these entities were not actually operating from the addresses declared by them," the statement said. The nationwide detailed verification exercise was carried out by the department based on "ground

intelligence and analysis of data on outward foreign remittances" as several suspicious entities were found to have remitted large amounts of foreign exchange over the last three years, the department said. "A nationwide network of entities engaged in remitting funds abroad was uncovered during a search operation conducted on a group of fictitious charitable trusts involved in providing accommodation entries against bogus donations/contributions."

"Preliminary ground verification revealed that the entities making these remittances were either non-filers or were filing income-tax returns showing very small turnovers," it said.

The probe has been underway for a while and now a nationwide verification exercise has been launched to verify these outward foreign remittances. "The investigations are being carried out against entities in Mumbai, Delhi-NCR, Ahmedabad, Jaipur, Kolkata, among others. The focus is on shell entities and those who incorrectly claimed these transfers as CSR, or have done it disproportionately to their disclosed turnover," an official told this newspaper.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

BRIEFLY

'NSE seeking \$55 billion valuation at IPO'

New Delhi: The National Stock Exchange is seeking to be valued at as much as \$55.26 lakh crore, or \$55 billion, in its planned Initial Public Offering, Bloomberg reported on Tuesday, quoting unnamed sources. At this valuation, a 6% stake sale could raise more than Rs 30,000 crore, making it India's biggest IPO, overtaking that of Hyundai Motor India in 2024. ENS

Govt puts curbs on clear float glass imports

New Delhi: India has put a minimum import price of Rs 34,000 per metric tonne on clear float glass for one year, a move that could benefit domestic producers, including San-Gobain and Asahi India, by curbing lower-priced imports. The Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), in a notification dated August 18, changed the import policy for clear float glass of 4 mm to 12 mm thickness under ITC (HS) codes 70051090 and 70052990 from "Free" to "Restricted." PTI

Employees' State Insurance Corporation
Medical College and Hospital, Naroda-Bapunagar, Ahmedabad
(Ministry of Labour & Employment, Govt. of India)

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

Expressions of Interest (EOI) are invited under the Two-Bid System (Technical and Financial Bid) from Government Institutions, Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs), reputed agencies, firms, or individual property owners to provide Rental Hostel Facilities for approximately 50 MBBS students (Boys & Girls).

Key Requirements & Specifications:

- Tender ID- 2026, ESIC, 922401_1 (Through CPP Portal)
- Tender Reference No. - E-file no. 1630222 (Through CPP Portal)
- Capacity: Accommodations for approximately 50 students (Boys & Girls).
- Location: Well-maintained properties preferred within 10 km of the ESIC Medical College Khokhra campus.
- Area: Minimum total living area of 5,500 square feet (excluding kitchen, balconies, bathrooms, and passages/common areas).
- Lease Period: Valid initially for 03 years, with a provision for performance based extension of up to 02 years.
- Facilities Required: Properties must feature proper ventilation, attached toilets, electrical points, round-the-clock power and water facilities, elevator/lift services, and space allocations for a reception desk, ward area, and security cabin. Note: Security and housekeeping services will be deployed by the Institute.
- Date of publication: 17/08/2026 (Hybrid Mode)
- Date and time of pre-bid-meeting: 21/08/2026
- Venue of pre-bid meeting: Room no 211, Office of Dean, ESIC Medical Hospital Bapunagar, near Hardasnagar Police Chowky, Rajraj Nagar, Bapunagar Ahmedabad Gujarat 380024.
- Last date of submission of sealed expression of interest: 28/08/2026
- Date & Time of opening of Technical Bid: 31/08/2026, 10:00 AM
- Date of site visit by official team of ESIC: Will be decided after opening of technical Bid and shall be informed to the qualified bidders.

Financial Bid: Date and time shall be intimated at later stage.

Earnest Money Deposit (EMD): Rs. 50,000/- (Fifty Thousand) only in Demand Draft (D.D.) to be drawn in favour of 'ESI Fund Account No. 1', Payable at Ahmedabad.

Submission Process: Interested and eligible bidders can download the detailed EOI document containing full terms, conditions, and technical/financial formats from the official website www.esic.gov.in or the Central Public Procurement Portal (CPPP).

Bids must be submitted in separate sealed envelopes for the Technical Bid (with supporting documents and EMD) and the Price Bid. Both envelopes must be packed inside a third, larger sealed envelope super-scripted with "EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI) FOR RENTAL HOSTEL FACILITIES FOR STUDENTS (BOYS & GIRLS)" and addressed to the office of the Dean.

The Dean reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids without assigning any reason.

DEAN
ESIC Medical College and Hospital, Naroda-Bapunagar, Ahmedabad

The Indian EXPRESS

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 24 PAGES

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Happening today

• THE CONGRESS WORKING Committee will meet to discuss a range of issues, including a roadmap to corner the government over the political situation.

THE CITY PAGE 3

SATYENDAR JAIN HELD IN DELHI JAL BOARD GRAFT CASE

Business as Usual

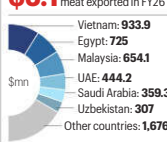
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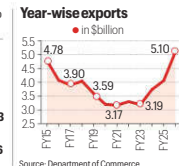
EXPRESS special \$5-bn success story, and growing: Buffalo meat exports surge

• India's buffalo meat shipments

\$5.1 billion Value of buffalo meat exported in FY26



Year-wise exports



Source: Department of Commerce

Harish Damodaran
New Delhi, August 18

WHAT IS India's best-performing agricultural export item? The answer is buffalo meat, shipments of which surged by 25.6% to \$5.1 billion in 2025-26

(April-March). The current fiscal has seen further growth, a whopping 66.6% from \$896.8 million in April-June 2025 to nearly \$1.5 billion in April-June 2026. "We crossed \$5 billion for the first time last fiscal and are

•CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Leaving Bombay House

Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrababu Naidu leaves Bombay House, the conglomerate's headquarters, after its annual general meeting was adjourned Tuesday due to lack of quorum. The meeting was likely to discuss his directorship, which is essential for him to continue as Chairman until his term ends in February. SANKARDEEP BANERJEE

THE BIG PICTURE OVER TO NOEL, PAGE 13

HIGH-POWERED COMMITTEE BEING CONSIDERED

Panel to probe assault, 'excessive' use of force at Jantar Mantar: SC

Facial recognition tech captures only those with crime records: Police

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, August 18

HEARING A clutch of petitions ranging from alleged use of excessive force against protesters to allegations of sexual assault and online harassment, the Supreme Court Tuesday proposed the formation of a high-powered committee to investigate all issues related to the Jantar Mantar protest.

A three-judge bench, headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, indicated that the committee would comprise a former Supreme Court judge, a former High Court Chief Justice and a retired police officer who had held the rank of Director General of Police.

The bench, also comprising Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice V Mohana, said it had already secured the consent of a former CBI chief and a retired

•CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Union Education Minister Pralhad Joshi with NTA Director General Abhishek Singh in New Delhi. X/@EDUMININDIA

NTA refresh: 4-tier paper checks, 600 experts out, CISF security at offices

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 18

THE EDUCATION ministry on Tuesday announced a major overhaul of the examination system at the National Testing Agency (NTA), including a four-tier paper checking process, removal of 600 experts and onboarding of new ones, and office premises secured by the CISF.

The ministry has been under fire over the NEET-UG paper leak and the recent lapses

in the UGC-NET papers—the two exams are among the many conducted by the NTA.

In a post on X, the ministry said NTA Director General Abhishek Singh had apprised it on actions taken by the agency. "A revamp of the examination team was undertaken with 600 experts being removed and new experts being onboarded. A four-tier question paper checking system will be put in place to strengthen the scrutiny of examination papers," it said.

•CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Amid E20 row, first talks underway on feasibility of an E10 option as well

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, August 18

Amid the row over E20 fuel, comprising 80% petrol and 20% ethanol, being the only standard petrol variant sold across the country, early exploratory discussions within the government and the indus-

try are underway on whether E10 petrol, which has 10% ethanol, can also be retail for older vehicles alongside the E20 fuel, according to sources aware of the matter.

India achieved 20% ethanol blending in petrol last year, five years ahead of the original

•CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

'Everything over': Meet those rendered jobless as Jharkhand cancels key exam

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, August 18

ON MONDAY night, as heavy rain lashed Ranchi, scores of people, dressed in formal office uniform, stood waiting outside the Jharkhand Mantralaya.

One of them was Roshan Kumar, 30, speaking to his parents over the phone, crying inconsolably. "Everything is over,

NATION PAGE 12

THE TESTING FIRM UNDER FIRE: LOCKED LUCKNOW OFFICE, 'NEPOTISM' IN U.P.

numma," he told them, repeatedly. Just hours earlier, Roshan was an Assistant Section Of-

ficer (ASO) posted at Nepal House, having joined the government posting this January, after a legal battle over the JSSC-CGL examination.

By Tuesday, he was no longer sure if he had a job. On Monday evening, following a prolonged agitation by students demanding action over alleged irregularities, the

•CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

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Manipur shutdown

In Imphal on Tuesday, Shops and business establishments were shut as a 48-hour strike began to demand implementation of the National Register of Citizens before the Census exercise in the state. **PI**

'Burqa dance' video at UP school: Premises sealed for running without approval

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, August 18

DAYS AFTER a purported video of girl students dancing in burqas during an Independence Day programme at a school in Uttar Pradesh's Gonda went viral, the education department sealed the premises on Monday evening.

Officials claimed the school was operating without the required recognition from the education department.

The department said it took the action after conducting an inquiry into the school, which had started functioning in the current academic session. The school offers classes up to Grade 5.

The video, which emerged on Sunday, allegedly showed four minor girls in burqa dancing to Bollywood and Bhojpuri songs.

When contacted by The Indian Express, school manager Ram Suresh Maurya said the school had started functioning this academic session and that the girls seen dancing in the video were not from a minority community. He then disconnected the call.

Gonda Block Education Of-

ficer, Riyaz Ahmed, said the school was sealed as it was being operated without recognition from the office of the Basic Shiksha Adhikari. He said that when he visited the school after the video surfaced, only a few people were present on the six-room campus.

"We locked the school premises. We have asked the authorities of a nearby school to admit the students who were studying here so that their education is not affected," Ahmed said.

According to Ahmed, he had first visited the school earlier this month after noticing that it had opened. But classes had already ended that day and only five to seven students and a teacher were present.

"I had asked the school manager to show the recognition documents. The manager told me that recognition was still pending and that the school had started in the current academic session. I asked him not to run the school until it obtained the required recognition," Ahmed said.

He added, "I also advised the parents of the students present at the school to enrol their children in another school that had the necessary recognition."

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Jantar Mantar pleas

state police chief for the assignment.

"We have obtained consent of a former Director of CBI to be a member, a very eminent officer who retired a couple of years ago. We have also obtained consent of a former Director General of Police of a state, which has nothing to do with this. He is also a retired officer," the CJI said.

He told the parties that the two options were being kept open because the court did not want anyone to raise any allegation in the future against the presence of the CBI officer.

"We don't want to disclose the name because we don't want any embarrassment to the officials. Out of the two, who do you think we should include in the committee? Or you leave it to us," the CJI said.

26 said if the parties provide their suggestions on the committee's terms of reference, the order may be out Wednesday itself. "Once your suggestions come, we will be able to release the order tomorrow," he said.

"We are quite sure that the

committee will give an immediate voice and audience to any victim who approaches it," the CJI said.

"We will await the recommendations which the committee will make from time to time, and the necessary legal consequences must follow," he said.

The July 20 march towards Parliament by protesters, led by the CJP, was stopped by security personnel who used lathis and tear gas to disperse the crowd.

There were allegations of security forces using pellet guns and surveillance system using facial recognition technology.

To a counsel representing a woman who alleged she was being attacked on social media for participating in the protest, the CJI said the committee will look into allegations concerning sexual assault and online harassment and victimisation of other vulnerable persons through social media.

"Whoever is responsible, there can be no excuse and no justification. It must be taken seriously and taken to its logical conclusion. That is why we are

constituting a high-powered committee. The committee will look into each and every aspect of these matters," he said.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Centre, said the facial recognition technology used at the site only registered the details of those who already had criminal records.

He said except for 2,873 such individuals in grave cases involving murder, rape, abduction, etc., the cases against others could be quashed.

Advocate Vrinda Grover said the court could consider using Article 142 powers to quash the FIRs against student protesters as assured by the state.

To this, Mehta said, "FIRs against student protesters must be quashed. How, it's for Your Lordships to decide. But as I already pointed out, some elements with serious criminal antecedents also infiltrated. They will have to be investigated."

The CJI said if the court could first be provided a list of FIRs where only students are involved, it could consider Grover's request.

"First of all, let us identify the areas where there is no controversy, there is no dispute. FIRs where as Advocate Vrinda has

rightly pointed out, where we can invoke Article 142 and quash those FIRs. There is no difficulty," he said.

Grover also demanded compensation for two persons who allegedly suffered pellet injuries.

Another counsel appearing for families of police personnel injured in the violence said they too should be provided compensation.

Senior Advocate Shadan Farast, appearing for a petitioner, said, "There are certain individual police officers in respect of whom videos are available. There are police personnel putting lathis in the buttocks of women." He said there should be some immediate action against them without waiting for the outcome of the committee's probe.

Backing this, Senior Advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan, also appearing for a petitioner, said, "A very strong message has to be sent to police people who behave in this fashion".

Referring to the reply filed by the police, he said, "There is an admission that police were in plainclothes, there is an admission that action was taken" but "there is complete silence about any administrative action being taken (against those personnel)".

"Let them at least disclose what administrative action they have taken because once they have started violating women... with this kind of sexual and disgusting activity, I want some responsibility to be taken by individuals who are responsible for that chain of action," Sankaranarayanan said.

The CJI said, "If we start examining or giving opinion or direction, then probably we will be curtailing the role of the high-powered committee. The committee will deal with the issues one by one. There are issues which require immediate attention. There are other issues, for example, laying down the guidelines, laying down the protocol for use of (force)."

The petitioners said they would submit a note with suggestions on what immediate directions are necessary.

The CJI said the court will also ask the authorities to hand over all digital and other materials to the committee.

Meanwhile, the Delhi Police, in an affidavit, denied allegations of excessive use of force during the CJI-led march. It said its officers used force only after protesters "started resorting to violence".

It said "the deployment of police staff in plain clothes in the big rallies and demonstrations, Re-

public Day gathering, Independence Day gathering or any big congregation that is part of normal arrangement that is followed by police departments globally so as to keep a vigil on anti-social elements or any criminal activity that pose a threat to the gathering or movement". These officers in plain clothes, the police said, are called "spotters" and are part of crowd-control measures. It said the "spotters" merged with the protesters "to avoid being identified by the anti-social elements and criminals and to be in a position to provide immediate assistance to anyone being harassed at the protest site".

The police affidavit rejected allegations of mass surveillance using facial recognition technology. It said the system does not profile every individual and only captures those with prior criminal records.

Police said only individuals with serious criminal backgrounds would be investigated by the Special Investigation Team constituted by the Police Commissioner.

The police also stated that there would be no investigation against protesters "who are not within the above referred 2,873 persons having serious criminal charges against them including murder, attempt to murder, dacoity, rape, POCSO etc."

Jharkhand

state government cancelled the Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission — Combined Graduate Level (JSSC-CGL) examination. The move — though hailed by those protesting alleged irregularities and pushing for exam cancellations — has put the fate of at least 20,000 people like Roshan in peril.

Originally from Giridih, Kumar, a History graduate, had been preparing for government recruitment examinations since he cleared the Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission — Combined Graduate Level (JSSC-CGL) examination. The move — though hailed by those protesting alleged irregularities and pushing for exam cancellations — has put the fate of at least 20,000 people like Roshan in peril.

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Roshan told *The Indian Express* that he had prepared largely on his own because his family could not afford coaching. "I am from a poor family. For us, getting a government job was a very big thing," he said, adding that his ultimate goal was to clear the JPSC examination, which had also been cancelled.

The JSSC-CGL examination had already been a long wait. The recruitment process began with an earlier notification in 2015-16 and went through its own share of cancellations, delays and legal battles.

The matter first reached the Jharkhand High Court in 2024, with a petition seeking a proper investigation into allegations of a paper leak in the JSSC-CGL examination, asking that appointments be kept on hold until the probe was completed. The HC ordered status quo on December 17, 2024, and the matter continued for nearly a year. Finally, on December 3, 2025, the

HC rejected the demand for a CBI probe, lifted the status quo, and directed JSSC to publish the final result and the government to appoint successful candidates, while asking the SIT to complete its investigation within six months.

The candidates finally received appointment letters in December 2025. Roshan said he had never expected the government to cancel the examination after candidates had already been appointed.

Like Roshan, many others were seen ringing up their parents, some video calling, from the Mahatma Band, telling them that their jobs had vanished overnight.

One of them was Chanda Kumar, 32, a Junior Secretariat Assistant (JSA) posted in the Cabinet Secretariat and Vigilance Department in Ranchi. Chanda is originally from Hazaribagh. She cleared the JSSC-CGL examination and the prelim-

inary and mains stages of the Forest Range Officer (FRO) examination. "I was scheduled to appear for the physical test (for the latter), but that process was suspended after the government announced action against examinations conducted by the TDP testing agency," she said.

"I have been continuously appearing in examinations: CGL, JPSC or FRO. But now the government has left us with no option," she said.

The eldest of five siblings, Chanda is worried about her family, which is "heavily dependent" on her. "There is no one to support me in Ranchi. The government brings us on the road, my entire family will also meet the same fate," she said.

For Chanda, the most painful experience was being stopped from entering the office where she had worked every day. "We used to show our ID cards at the gate, and the police personnel would recognise us and let us

enter. They knew by our faces too. Today, unfortunately, the same people are pushing us away."

While targeting the protesters at Jaipal Singh Munda Stadium, situated some 11 km away, she said it is a failure of democracy if important decisions are taken under pressure. "We can see democracy changing into mobocracy. People who have not cleared the exams have had their demand fulfilled, and it has impacted us," she said.

From Monday night to Tuesday evening, many like Roshan and Chanda stayed put outside the Mahatma Band. In the background, police officers were heard speaking over microphones: "Move away from the gate and follow the prescribed code of conduct."

Sudhir Kumar, 30, stood drenched, staring down at the road, trying to figure out what he was supposed to do next. Around 30, an ASO posted in

Hazaribagh after clearing the JSSC-CGL examination, he arrived in Ranchi on Tuesday to help the protesting candidates.

"We have lost everything now," he told his wife.

Originally from Godda, Sudhir completed a diploma in mechanical engineering before completing a B.Tech in the same stream. "This exam was cleared after several years of uncertainty. In December 2024, I had also cleared a railway recruitment for the post of Depot Material Superintendent. I went through the selection process... and even underwent a week of training at Baidik in Maharashtra," he said.

However, when the opportunity to join the Jharkhand government came, he took it up, wanting to remain closer to home and his elderly mother.

"Everything was finally cleared... everything. But we never knew we would be thrown back into the same situation."

'Weak evidence': Bail for second convict in Dabholkar murder case

Omkar Gokhale
Mumbai, August 18

THE BOMBAY High Court on Tuesday granted bail to Sachin Andure, the second of two men convicted of shooting dead rationalist Dr. Nagesh Dabholkar in 2013 citing "very weak piece of evidence" with "fair chances" of his acquittal, and suspended his life sentence while his appeal against the conviction remains pending.

The rationalist's daughter Mukta Dabholkar called the development a "matter of concern" and said the family would move the Supreme Court against it.

A bench led by Justices Sarang V Kotal granted the bail citing party with Sharad Kalaskar, the other convicted assailant, who was released on bail by the High Court on April 29.

Granting Kalaskar bail, a bench led by Justice Ajay S Gadgkar had observed that no "Test Identification Parade was conducted, and that identification through photographs shown to witnesses while he was already in custody "tosses its sanctity". The court had also noted Kalaskar's seven-and-a-half years in custody and that his appeal was unlikely to be disposed of in the near future.

Advocates Nilesh Pradhan and Virendra Chikankar, appearing for the convicts, had argued that the CBI failed to conduct a Test Identification Parade and questioned the recovery of the weapon.

Dr Dabholkar, 67, a prominent anti-superstition campaigner and founder of the Maharashtra Andhashraddha Nirmoolan Samiti, was shot dead by two unidentified motorcycle-borne assailants in Pune on August 20, 2013.

The court called Andure's extra-judicial confession and eyewitnesses' identification "extremely weak," done for the first time "after quite a long period" of over eight years after the incident. Andure had a "stronger case" than Kalaskar, as his photograph was not identified by either eyewitness, the court observed.

There was a "loose end" regarding the weapon's recovery, it said, adding that though police had a weapon matching with the bullets recovered from dead body, there was no further investigation and "absolutely no explanation" by probing agency.

Therefore, the HC observed "there are fair chances of the applicant's acquittal in his appeal".

\$5-bn success story

on track to do \$6 billion-plus in 2026-27," said a Commerce Ministry official.

But it's not just overall value increase. More impressive is the value realisation per tonne.

In 2014-15, India exported 14.8 lakh tonnes (t) of buffalo meat worth \$4.8 billion, translating into an average value of \$3,240 per tonne. The subsequent years until 2023-24 recorded a drop in the value as well as quantity of exports (see *charts*), and average realisations to \$2,700-\$3,000 levels.

The revival started in 2024-25, when exports touched \$4.1 billion at a unit value of \$3,236 per tonne. The latter number rose to \$3,591 in 2025-26 and \$4,392 during April-June 2026.

"The higher unit value realisations indicate improved product acceptability of Indian buffalo meat. This has been enabled by government policy, allowing exports only from plants registered by the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) that is conditional upon their meeting stringent safety, hygiene and infrastructure requirements. We also ensure ongoing compliance through periodic and surprise inspections," the official explained.

India has 83 APEDA-approved integrated abattoirs-cum-meat processing plants that can handle between 500

and 2,000 large animals (buffaloes) each daily. In addition, there are 100 to 150 smaller, ready-to-eat products. But there's a concerted attempt now at boosting value realisation by selling more through retail channels — including in big and less consumer packs, as against 20-30 kg bulk frozen blocks.

APEDA has, since October 29, 2025, been imposing a Rs 250/tonne levy on exports of all frozen and chilled buffalo meat.

The proceeds go towards a Meat Export Development Fund, similar to one created for mutton-meat in 2008.

"The fund is meant for promoting exports, both to new and existing markets. It covers activities from sponsoring trade delegation visits and international buyer-seller fairs, to addressing non-tariff barriers restricting market access," said a Commerce Ministry official said.

That these efforts are bearing fruit is borne out by the diversification of export destinations. In 2014-15, 45% of India's \$4.8 billion buffalo meat exports went to Vietnam (\$2.2 billion), followed by Malaysia (\$422.9 million), Egypt (\$418 million), Saudi Arabia (\$325 million), United Arab Emirates (\$308 million), Algeria (\$125.1 million) and Philippines (\$115.8 million).

Cut to 2025-26, when out of the total \$5.1 billion, 10 countries imported over \$100 million worth: Vietnam (\$933.9 million), Egypt (\$728 million), Saudi Arabia (\$654.1 million), UAE (\$444.2 million), Saudi Arabia (\$359.3 million), Uzbekistan

(\$307 million), Indonesia (\$301.3 million), Iraq (\$300.1 million), Philippines (\$176 million) and Jordan (\$105.5 million).

"Uzbekistan is a new market. So are others that have become significant buyers: Russia (\$972 million), Georgia (\$70.5 million), Oman (\$82.7 million) and Senegal (\$70.9 million)," the official noted.

Supporting the dairy economy

The success story of buffalo meat exports is just limited to market expansion leading to higher unit value realisations. It also ticks all the right boxes with respect to India's livestock economy and its dairy farmers.

India doesn't permit export of beef (cattle meat). Even export of carabeef is limited to buffaloes that don't produce enough milk after around five calvings/lactations (when they would be 8-9 years old), are infertile, have damaged udders or happen to be male. For farmers, maintaining them is uneconomical, in terms of diverting fodder, feed, water and labour resources away from bovines giving milk.

Providing a market for unproductive animals, the meat export industry has been complementary to dairying. A buffalo weighing, say 400 kg, yields roughly 125 kg of meat, with bones, hide, edible and non-edible offals, blood, horns, hooves and undigested food/ingesta constituting the rest.

Taking an average boneless meat yield of 100 kg, the 14-15 it exported annually would entail

required massive investments, and reverting to a lower blend will not be prudent.

But a rethink now appears to be on the table. An opinion article co-authored by Chief Economic Adviser V Anantha Nageswaran, which appeared in *The Indian Express* Monday, called for lower ethanol-petrol blend, say E10, to also be available alongside E20 fuel.

While the views expressed in the article were personal, the NTA means that all vehicles currently being sold by manufacturers are fully compliant with E20, but most vehicles that were sold prior to 2023 are not. The permissible life of a petrol vehicle in the National Capital Region is 15 years, which means that cars manufactured in 2012 can be in use until 2027 under current norms.

According to auto industry insiders, petrol vehicles manufactured and sold after April 2023 are considered fully E20-compliant as this was mandated

in the Bharat Stage 6 (BS6) phase two emission norms. This means that all vehicles currently being sold by manufacturers are fully compliant with E20, but most vehicles that were sold prior to 2023 are not. The permissible life of a petrol vehicle in the National Capital Region is 15 years, which means that cars manufactured in 2012 can be in use until 2027 under current norms.

According to a senior oil industry official, making two base

fueling of 1.4-1.5 crore animals. Given India's total buffalo population of 11 crore (2019 Livestock Census), it allows farmers to systematically replace their low-yielding/aging animals with high-yielding young stock.

The recommended herd turnover ratio for commercial dairy cattle is, in fact, 25-30%.

"In Brazil, Australia or US, beef cattle compete with dairy cattle for scarce resources. In India, we have no such competition because cattle and buffaloes are used for both meat and milk. Only non-milk-yielding buffaloes are culled, which is actually beneficial to the dairy sector," an industry source pointed out.

The purchase price that abattoirs pay for buffaloes is based on carcass yield — basically the weight of meat and bones. This is usually 47-48% of live weight, working out to about 190 kg for a 400 kg buffalo. The going rate for animals delivered at plants in Uttar Pradesh today is Rs 300-320 per kg of carcass weight. On 190 kg, that adds up to Rs 57,000-60,800.

For a dairy farmer, a 3.5-4 year-old, first-time-lactating buffalo capable of producing 2,000 litres of milk or more annually costs Rs 1.25-1.5 lakh. If the farmer realises Rs 50,000 for a spent buffalo, it can cover at least a third of the cost for a new productive animal. The meat industry, adds to the viability of the dairy enterprise, by making it possible to regularly replace older buffaloes with fresh stock.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

NTA

"20-25 officials to be inducted in next two to three weeks. Further high-level officials will be viewed. NTA officials will be shifted to the new premises on a foot footing where security will be reinforced with CISF teams," the ministry said.

The announcement followed a meeting chaired on Monday by Education Minister Prakash Singh. He said his predecessor Dharmendra Pradhan had to resign following protests over the NEET-UG paper leak. The ministry said Joshi "directed that all necessary security and related infrastructural facilities should be put in place for the smooth conduct of examinations".

The NTA action comes after recent student protests led by the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) over the NEET-UG paper leak, which saw Pradhan's resignation and the promise of exam reform. The government had also removed Higher Education Secretary Vineet Joshi.

On Sunday, the NTA announced that it would re-conduct the UGC-NEET June 2026 examinations in English, Commerce, and Sociology subjects after a committee found that the three question papers contained many factual, typographical, and translation errors, concluding that the papers did not meet the standards of a "fair and error-free examination".

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E10 option

deadline. There has been opposition to the E20 fuel from various quarters, with claims ranging from notable reduction in mileage and engine component wear in older vehicles whose engines were not designed for higher ethanol blends.

On its part, the government has been trying to allay fears, saying the drop in mileage in older vehicles would be 3-5% at most, and would be outweighed by E20's benefits as it is a superior fuel. It has also consistently rejected claims that E20 fuel could damage engine components.

Questions have also been raised on why motorists aren't being offered the option of pure

E10 option

Logistical challenge

Retailing E10 and E20 petrol simultaneously is a logistical challenge. It will require a complex, parallel supply chain, stretching from refineries to pumps. Due to limited underground storage at petrol pumps, managing dual high-volume fuels will need enormous infrastructure upgrades, making it unfeasible for the current network.

petrol, E10 and E20 fuels. Some Opposition leaders have also raised questions over this lack of choice.

The discussions, described as "preliminary" and "keeping the older vehicles in mind", are

being held on various technical as well as non-technical aspects of the country's complex fuel retail supply chain, and no concrete conclusions have been arrived at yet, sources indicated. They said the backlash from certain quarters against E20 and the lack of choice for consumers, specifically those with older vehicles, particularly two-wheelers, that were certified for E10 petrol, led to the initiation of these discussions.

In July, the government had said that offering multiple grades of base fuel across the country would create an "enormous logistical challenge," apart from raising costs and reducing operational efficiencies in India's complex fuel retail network. It also said the current base fuel E10 is cleaner and superior than pure petrol and lower ethanol-petrol blends, has

required massive investments, and reverting to a lower blend will not be prudent. But a rethink now appears to be on the table. An opinion article co-authored by Chief Economic Adviser V Anantha Nageswaran, which appeared in *The Indian Express* Monday, called for lower ethanol-petrol blend, say E10, to also be available alongside E20 fuel. While the views expressed in the article were personal, the NTA means that all vehicles currently being sold by manufacturers are fully compliant with E20, but most vehicles that were sold prior to 2023 are not. The permissible life of a petrol vehicle in the National Capital Region is 15 years, which means that cars manufactured in 2012 can be in use until 2027 under current norms.

According to a senior oil industry official, making two base

ran and Akash Poojari, a consultant in Department of Economic Affairs, wrote.

A request for comment sent to the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas on the matter did not elicit a response.

According to auto industry insiders, petrol vehicles manufactured and sold after April 2023 are considered fully E20-compliant as this was mandated in the Bharat Stage 6 (BS6) phase two emission norms. This means that all vehicles currently being sold by manufacturers are fully compliant with E20, but most vehicles that were sold prior to 2023 are not. The permissible life of a petrol vehicle in the National Capital Region is 15 years, which means that cars manufactured in 2012 can be in use until 2027 under current norms.

According to a senior oil industry official, making two base

PROTEST ENTERS THIRD DAY

AAP MLA detained for 10 hours as sanitation worker cremated, Rs 10-lakh aid for family



Personnel from the Rapid Action Force and the Central Reserve Police Force deployed at the sanitation workers' protest at Khichripur bus stand on Tuesday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Mishal Mussaddique, Alok Singh & Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, August 18

AS PROTESTS over the killing of a sanitation worker in East Delhi entered the third day, AAPMLA Kuldeep Kumar, who had been at the forefront of the protests, was picked up by police from his residence early Tuesday and detained for over 10 hours. This comes on a day when the Delhi Mayor announced Rs 10 lakh compensation and a job for one member of the deceased worker's family.

With his whereabouts unknown for most of the day, Kumar's wife Deepa moved the Delhi High Court with a Habeas Corpus plea. The plea was disposed of after Delhi Police informed the court that Kumar had been released at 3.48 pm.

After his release, Kumar, the MLA from Kondli in East Delhi, told *The Indian Express* that he had been "kidnapped" while he was asleep at home.

"Around 150 personnel, all in plain clothes, came to my house. Around 50 of them entered the house and, without informing my family, forcibly dragged me into their vehicle. They took me somewhere in

Preet Vihar, where I later learned that it was a Negotiations Department office. They released me only after they were informed that my party was going to file a Habeas Corpus petition in court," Kumar said.

Police, however, said Kumar and five others, including members of the Bhim Army, had been detained for allegedly "instigating people to create a ruckus" and obstructing garbage collection work.

"They were all detained and taken to different locations. They were kept in detention under Section 65 of the Delhi Police Act, which empowers the police to take people into preventive detention," an officer said. The detainees were released around an hour before the court hearing, which was held after Deepa sought urgent listing of her plea.

At the court

During the hearing, senior advocate Shadan Farooq, appearing for Deepa, said, "Just a few minutes back we are informed (Kumar) is released. Can they invoke draconian provisions of preventive detention?"

The plea alleged that before

leaving, the police officers destroyed CCTV cameras installed at Kumar's residence and took away the DVR (Digital Video Recorder) with them. "Evidently with the intent to destroy the evidence of their illegal acts",

Deepa alleged that she apprehended that Kumar's detention was intended "to muzzle his voice and to keep him away from the said protest, and that he may be falsely implicated in some case".

Disposing of the plea, a bench of Justices Navin Chawla and Ravinder Dubeja said Kumar's release had served the purpose of the petition. "The petitioner's family will be at liberty to take appropriate legal recourse," it said.

Acremation

While the court proceedings were under way, the body of 27-year-old Anil Kumar, the sanitation worker whose killing triggered the protests that continued for the third day on Tuesday, was cremated in the afternoon.

His cousin Surender Kumar alleged that the family had been pushed by police to "cremate the body as quickly

as possible".

After the postmortem at LBS Hospital at around 3 am, the police brought Anil's body to his sister's house in Trilokpur. Then all of them came to Khoda Colony in Ghaziabad where our families live. The Uttar Pradesh Police then arrived and began making arrangements for the cremation," he said.

A source in the Delhi Police said that as the last rites were to be conducted in Ghaziabad, the local police to "manage the situation during the cremation".

The family conducted the final rites around 2 pm at a crematorium ground in Mohan Nagar in Ghaziabad.

Protest continues

Anil, a contractual worker employed by Metro Waste Handling Pvt Ltd, an agency working with the Municipal Corporation of Delhi, was stabbed to death in East Delhi's Kalyanpuri early Sunday.

A day after the killing, sanitation workers had gathered in protest and demanded compensation for his family. On Tuesday, hundreds of Anil's colleagues gathered at the Khichripur bus stand near National Highway 24 and the Metro Waste depot, threatening a "chakka jam" on the highway if those detained were not released.

Personnel from the Central Reserve Police Force and Delhi Police were deployed at the spot. Delhi Mayor Praveesh Wahli said in the evening that the MCD had put pressure on the Metro Waste Handling to pay a compensation of Rs 10 lakh to the family and a job for Anil's elder brother.

"A cheque for Rs 8 lakh had been prepared by the agency. We pressured them to add Rs 2 lakh more," he said, adding that the killing was a matter of personal enmity and doesn't threaten the general safety of sanitation workers across Delhi. The family, however, said the compensation did not address their concerns.

"If a government job was provided, at least the household situation would have improved a bit. They work as masons — sometimes they get work, sometimes they don't. The elder brother is unemployed. There is a younger sister who needs to be married," Surender said.

STP fraud case: AAP's Satyendar Jain, DJB ex-CEO among 6 held

Alok Singh
New Delhi, August 18

FORMER DELHI minister and Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) leader Satyendar Kumar Jain and former Delhi Jal Board (DJB) CEO Udit Prakash Rai were among the six people arrested by Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB) on Tuesday in a multi-core sewage treatment plant (STP) tender fraud case, said officials. The tenders were allegedly allotted in 2022 when the AAP leader served as the Delhi Water Minister. Rai has been accused of taking bribes worth Rs 15 crore, according to the agency.

As per ACB Joint Commissioner Vikramjit Singh, the case originated from a complaint filed by the Directorate of Vigilance, alleging serious irregularities, manipulation of tender conditions and a criminal conspiracy in the upgradation work of sewage treatment plants in the capital. An FIR, said officials, was registered in the case on May 11, 2024, at the ACB police station under provisions of the Prevention of Corruption Act and the Indian Penal Code.

Apart from Jain and Rai, other arrested accused have been identified as DJB's former contractual consultant Anil Srivastava, Nagendra Yadav, proprietor of M/s AN Enterprises; Raja Kumar Kurra, owner of M/s Eurotek Environment Pvt. Ltd., and Pankaj Verma, proprietor of M/s Srijanhar. The firms have been linked to alleged manipulation of tenders.

In 2025, the Enforcement Directorate (ED), which is also probing the case, had filed a charge sheet against Jain and 13 others. The Rs 17.7 crore fraud involved the award of four tenders linked to the STPs, the central agency had said. After examining the evidence gathered during the probe, the Delhi government's ACB on Tuesday said that all six accused were questioned before being arrested.

Political war of words

Following Jain's arrest, a political war of words broke out between the AAP and the BJP.



Satyendar Kumar Jain, FILE

Jain was earlier arrested in 2022 in another money laundering case filed by the ED and later released on bail in 2024.

Lashing out at the BJP, AAP chief and former Delhi Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal wrote on X, "Satyendar Jainji has once again been arrested at the behest of the BJP. Just a short while ago, everyone still remembers the ordeal they put him through by throwing him in jail. The previous case was fabricated too, and this case will also be proven to be fake."

On the other hand, Union Minister and Delhi BJP chief Harsh Malhotra in an official statement was quoted as saying, "The STP scam and the arrests made in connection with it have made it clear why even a single STP was not installed on any drain during the 10-year rule of the Kejriwal government and why the Yamuna became even more polluted over these ten years." He added, "Arvind Kejriwal should come forward and accept the crimes committed by his government. The law may take some time, but Satyendar Jain will certainly be punished."

The allegations

The probe, according to the ACB, revealed that a proposed pilot study for the upgradation work was not conducted while restrictive conditions, including those concerning the technology, were allegedly incorporated into the tender.

Investigators have alleged that the tender process contained conditions that favoured the technology provider, M/s Eurotek Environment Pvt. Ltd., limiting competition and allegedly extending undue

advantage to the private entity. The ACB said its investigation also uncovered alleged communications between public servants and proprietors pointing towards a nexus aimed at influencing the tender conditions in favour of the particular technology provider.

Electronic evidence allegedly showed the exchange of tender conditions, corrigendums and other project-related documents, which were subsequently incorporated into the STP tender issued by the DJB.

Officials also alleged that essential parameters concerning treated effluent were left out and that technical specifications were subsequently modified, resulting in significant financial implications for the government exchequer.

Money trail uncovered

The financial trail has emerged as another key component of the investigation. According to the agency, commission or bribe payments were allegedly routed through intermediary entities, including M/s Srijanhar and M/s AN Enterprises. The investigation allegedly found that substantial sums were transferred to the proprietorship concern of accused Nagendra Yadav by entities connected with the private technology provider.

The agency said subsequent transactions resulted in the transfer of funds to government officials, including Rai, as well as his relatives. The ACB has also alleged that Rai received bribe payments, amounting to Rs 1.2 crore in his and his relatives' bank accounts through M/s AN Enterprises. The agency further alleged that the money was subsequently used for purchasing immovable property.

As per the agency, the funds routed through M/s AN Enterprises were used to probe the ACB. The ACB said the material collected during the investigation indicates that certain tender conditions were allegedly introduced or modified in a manner favouring Eurotek Environment Pvt. Ltd.

Delhi plans more virtual court hearings for high-risk inmates

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, August 18

TO PREVENT security threats posed by transporting high-profile prisoners and rival gangsters to court, the Delhi Home Department is drawing up a comprehensive plan to upgrade video-conferencing (VC) infrastructure in jails so such inmates can be produced virtually.

A senior government official said there are 250 VC facilities in Delhi Prisons currently. The government is planning to develop 840 more cubicles, with systems and arrangements in place for virtual appearances.

"This will ensure that not only high-profile prisoners or gangsters but other inmates too

can appear for their court hearings virtually," the official said.

Officials said transporting high-profile prisoners and gangsters with known rivals requires additional security arrangements and route planning. "The extra security arrangements and transportation all cost money. If enough VC cubicles are set up within the prisons, we can save a lot of money and avoid security-related issues and mishaps" as an official said.

The security risks were underscored by the 2021 killing of gangster Jitender Gogia inside Rohini Court. Members of his arch-rival Tiliu Talpuria's gang, posing as lawyers, shot him dead on the court premises. They were later gunned down by members of the Delhi

Police Special Cell's Counter Intelligence team accompanying Gogia.

In such cases, there is a security threat not only to the inmate but also to police personnel and the public. The government aims to prevent such incidents by reducing the physical movement of inmates wherever possible, "an official said. Officials said approximately 2,000 inmates are produced before courts daily. "Except when cross-examination during trial is required, inmates can be produced before courts virtually," an official said.

The virtual hearing infrastructure is being developed across all three prison complexes — Tihar, Mandoli and Rohini — which house around 20,000 inmates.

Rs 700-cr medical procurement scam: Files with key details of govt purchases destroyed, ACB tells court

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, August 18

VITAL FILES related to the alleged Rs 700-crore medical procurement scam, which showed purchases made by the Directorate General of Health Services (DGHS) and the Central Procurement Agency (CPA) have been "intentionally destroyed", the Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB) has told a Delhi court.

The CPA is the nodal agency responsible for procuring and supplying medicines, vaccines and medical equipment to Delhi government hospitals and healthcare facilities.

As per the probe, files related to bids for X-Ray machines, C-Arm machines and linen, among other items, contained details of the officials who pre-

pared the bid documents and set the terms and conditions. The files also named those involved in the technical and financial evaluation of the bids.

Last week, the ACB submitted before the court that the accused "intentionally destroyed" these files and caused the "disappearance of crucial evidence of the crimes committed by them". The primary accused in the alleged fraud include former DJB chief Dr Vatsala Aggarwal, former CPA deputy controller of accounts Neeraj Chopra and Dr Vinod Kumar Banga, former CPA head of office.

While Rangla's regular bail plea was rejected by the court on Monday, Aggarwal was granted interim bail on medical grounds for four weeks by Special Judge



Dr Vatsala Aggarwal, FILE

Dr Vatsala Aggarwal on Tuesday. Aggarwal had cited various ailments, including hypertension, diabetes, palpitation and spinal injury while seeking interim bail.

"...considering the present medical condition of the applicant was rejected by the court on Monday, Aggarwal was granted interim bail on medical grounds for four weeks by Special Judge

on humanitarian ground, this court is of the opinion that applicant/accused deserves to be granted interim bail on medical grounds," Judge Prakash said on Tuesday.

The case pertains to a Vigilance department complaint that was converted into an FIR on June 2, and revolves around manipulated tenders and the siphoning of public funds meant for hospital equipment and medicines. The first arrest in the case was made on June 18.

On June 30, Rajiv Rangla, a key accused in the case, was granted anticipatory bail in an extortion case days before he allegedly fled India. A medicine supplier and pharmaceutical trader, Rangla is still absconding, the ACB has told the court. Rangla had cited in his bail

plea that his liberty was being curtailed as the ACB has not been able to complete its probe due to Rangla going missing. Also, he alleged that he had taken all decisions following Aggarwal's go-ahead.

As per the ACB, the accused criminally connived to participate in the "cartelisation" process during bids and allegedly awarded tenders to "entities" of their choice using illegal methods. Turnover, experience and performance criteria were set at exorbitantly high levels, the agency claimed in its submissions, to "discourage other bidders from participating in the tender". Further, the ACB submitted that payment of other vendors were kept pending over two years after items were supplied by them.

● DURING INSPECTION, WATER INGRESS WAS FOUND INSIDE SEVERAL MACHINES DESPITE THERE BEING NO NEARBY WATER SOURCE OR PLUMBING

Water thrown at biometric attendance devices in offices? Delhi govt turns to CCTV

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, August 18

THE DELHI government's biometric attendance drive has run into an unexpected obstacle. It isn't resistance to technology, a faulty network or even a missing fingerprint. In some offices, it is water.

After repeated complaints of malfunctioning—an inspection has found water inside several biometric attendance devices, despite there being no nearby water source or plumbing—the Social Welfare department has decided to put the machines installed across its offices under CCTV surveillance.

The biometric attendance push came after Chief Minister Rekha Gupta found several senior staff members, including

senior bureaucrats, absent from duty at the State GST office during a surprise inspection in April.

Following this, the government made biometric attendance mandatory for all employees deployed across its departments, including additional district offices and institutions that the devices installed on their premises were malfunctioning, the department carried out an inspection.

"During the meeting, the in-charges of several district offices and homes/institutions reported that the biometric attendance devices... were frequently malfunctioning. The Superintendent, Caretaking Branch (CTB), informed that repeated complaints... are being received from various offices... During inspections carried out by the ser-

vice engineer, water ingress was found inside several biometric devices despite there being no nearby water source or plumbing," read the minutes of the meeting.

The minutes also said that the circumstances gave rise to a reasonable apprehension that certain devices may have been "deliberately damaged". "Several district offices, homes and institutions were not submitting attendance reports regularly... and whenever asked, they complained of device malfunction. The inspection, however, portrays different reasons...

● Malfunctioning biometric devices

- Staff in some Delhi govt departments may have allegedly tried to damage biometric attendance devices by sprinkling or pouring water into them.
- Several devices were reported to be frequently malfunctioning.
- During inspections, water ingress

was found inside several devices

- The affected devices had no nearby water source or plumbing.
- Officials said they did not know who tried to damage the devices, but the fact that it was found in several offices suggested to them that it was deliberate.

We don't know who tried to damage the devices, but it is clear that it is deliberate because it is not one machine. It has been found in several offices..." said an official. Officials said attendance reports are also submitted to the office of the minister concerned, as well as to the General Administration Department (GAD) and the Chief Secretary.

The issue has exposed a broader problem with the government's push for biometric attendance: not every official spends the day behind a desk.

Officials said staff of the Social Welfare, Labour and WCD departments are involved in field work, as these departments oversee the implementation of welfare schemes on the ground.

"Because of this, while some are not able to mark their attendance on the biometric system... some try to take benefit of it... The department has decided to explore the feasibility of implementing a mobile-based Aadhaar-enabled biometric attendance system integrated with the face ID Application and real-time geolocation, mainly for officials performing field duties," said a senior official.

Officials said that in-charges of several district offices and homes/institutions had reported practical difficulties in preparing attendance strictly on the basis of biometric records. These included the nature of field duties performed by certain officials and the frequent malfunctioning of biometric devices at some locations. "The IT Branch has been approached to examine the technical feasibility

and submit its recommendations to the Social Welfare department," said the official.

Officials said that, all departments have to daily submit attendance reports of their staff to their heads. The MCD, while seeking a monthly attendance report indicating the average time of arrival of each official, had directed the GAD to compile a daily attendance report and submit it to the Chief Secretary by 12 pm every day.

A few months ago, the Chief Secretary had also strictly warned officials to take biometric attendance seriously and mark their attendance, failing which strict disciplinary action would be taken. Further, show-cause notices have been issued to some officers for not adhering to the guidelines.

Gujarat Police seizes phones, laptops from journalist Ravi Nair's Delhi home

Alok Singh & Aditi Raja
New Delhi, Vadodra,
August 18

A TEAM of the Gujarat Police on Monday searched the Delhi home of independent journalist Ravi Nair and seized three laptops, two phones and an iPad. The seized devices allegedly included those belonging to Nair's son and a colleague of the journalist's.

Nair is facing charges of defamation and forgery in Ahmedabad following a complaint over a news report and posts on X about the Adani Group.

On August 11, Gujarat High Court had refused to quash an FIR registered by the Ahmedabad Detection of Crime Branch (DCB) against Nair on May 29 this year over an article published in *The Washington Post*, which had alleged that Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) had been directed to make large investments in Adani Group companies.

The complainant in the case is Dushyant Vijaybhair Joshi, representing Adani Ports and Special Economic Zones Ltd (APSEZ). The HC held that the allegations in the FIR were materially different from an earlier private defamation complaint, and prima facie indicated cognisable offences that required investigation. The Gujarat Police team was accompanied by personnel from the Delhi Police during the search. Nair was not at home at the time.

A senior officer of the Gujarat Police said that a unit of the force had seized the electronic devices from Nair's Delhi residence as part of their investigation into the FIR following the HC's order last week, based on a warrant issued by a Magistrate Court in Ahmedabad.

Nair's colleague told *The Indian Express* that she was at Nair's residence with his son on Monday. The officials showed us a search warrant and collected some gadgets. There were three laptops, two old phones that were

kept in a cupboard, and one iPad. The laptops belonged to me and Ravi's son, who works at a software company," she said.

She said the search was recorded by a member of the police team. The officials also asked them to sign some documents before leaving around 6:40 pm. She said Nair had been cooperating with investigators. "However, neither his son nor I are accused in any case. I don't know why they took away our devices".

On August 11, Justice M R Menagde of the HC rejected the journalist's contention that the FIR amounted to an abuse of the legal process.

The FIR, lodged under Sections 318(4), 336(2), 336(4) and 340(2) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023 (BNS), relates to an article published in *The Washington Post* on October 24, 2025. These sections deal with cheating; altering or destroying a valuable security; forgery, which is intended, or known likely, to harm the reputation of a party; and fraudulently or dishonestly using a forged document or electronic record as genuine. The FIR said the article had alleged that the government and LIC had directed investments of large funds into Adani Group companies. Nair was also alleged to have claimed on X that Indian officials had decided to invest \$3.9 billion in the Group.

The allegations in the report were based on documents purportedly issued by LIC or the Department of Financial Services under the Union Ministry of Finance. However, the assistant public prosecutor submitted that LIC denied issuing any such documents or receiving any government instructions to invest in any Adani entity.

In its eight-page order, the HC observed that the existence of the documents was "under the cloud", and prima facie appeared to be forged. The court said it would be for the "investigating agency to find out the truth as regards those documents".

PM CARES Fund sees drop in donations, spending

Total balance at an all-time high

Harikishan Sharma
New Delhi, August 18

TOTAL CONTRIBUTIONS to the Prime Minister's Citizen Assistance and Relief in Emergency Situations Fund (PM CARES Fund) fell to Rs 479.96 crore in financial year 2024-25. Its closing balance, however, touched an all-time high of Rs 8,452.06 crore as the spending, too, fell to a five-year low of Rs 87.85 lakh.

According to the latest Receipt and Payment Accounts (Audited) statement available on the PM CARES Fund portal, domestic donations accounted for Rs 479.94 crore of the total contributions while foreign donations added up to about Rs 92 lakh. The Fund also received Rs 475.14 crore as interest income (Rs 469.37 crore from fixed de-

• Contributions received in the PM CARES Fund and closing balance (amount in Rs Crore)

	Receipts	Opening Balance	Total Receipts	Total Payments	Closing Balance
	Domestic	Foreign			
2019-20	3076.85	0.39	0	3076.62	0.0002
2020-21	7183.77	494.93	3076.62	10990	3976.17
2021-22	1896.76	4.02	7013.99	9131.94	3716.29
2022-23	909.64	2.57	5415.65	6721	437.87
2023-24	681.81	1.13	6283.68	7188.63	15.59
2024-25	479.94	0.92	7173.03	8452.94	0.87

posits, Rs 5.76 crore from regular accounts), about Rs 13.49 lakh as refund of tax deducted at source (TDS) on interest on fixed deposits from banks, and Rs 324.65 crore as "refund from implementing agencies".

Meanwhile, the total spending fell to Rs 87.85 lakh on the PM CARES for Children Scheme and Rs 45.1 as bank charges and SMS charges. The total spending was Rs 15.57 crore in 2023-24; Rs 43.59 crore in 2022-23;

Rs 3716.29 crore in 2021-22; and Rs 3976.17 crore in 2020-21.

The closing balance touched an all-time high of Rs 8,452.06 crore at the end of 2024-25, marking an increase of 1783 per cent as compared to the closing balance of Rs 173.03 crore at the end of 2023-24.

The contributions to the Fund peaked in 2020-21, they saw the outbreak of the second Covid wave, when it received Rs 7,183.77 crore as domestic donations and Rs 494.93 crore as for-

foreign donations. In 2021-22, it got Rs 1,896.76 crore as domestic donations and Rs 401.2 crore as foreign donations. In 2022-23, it got Rs 909.64 crore as domestic donations and Rs 2.57 crore as foreign donations; and in 2023-24, it got Rs 681.81 crore as domestic donations and Rs 1.13 crore as foreign donations.

At the end of 2019-20, the closing balance was Rs 3,076.62 crore. This increased to Rs 7,014 crore at the end of 2020-21, fell to Rs 5,415.65 crore in 2021-22, and then climbed to Rs 6,283.68 in 2022-23, Rs 1,730.03 crore in 2023-24, and Rs 8,452.06 crore in 2024-25.

The PM CARES Fund was registered as a public charitable trust under the Registration Act, 1908, on March 27, 2020—days after the country went into a lockdown in the wake of Covid-19. The Prime Minister is the ex-officio chairman of the Fund, while the Defence Minister, Home Minister and Finance Minister are ex-officio trustees.

Naidu: 34% quota for Backward Classes in local body polls

Hyderabad: The Andhra Pradesh government has announced 34% reservation for Backward Classes (BC) communities in the local body polls, which are likely to be held later this year. Apprising the Legislative Assembly in Amaravati of the Cabinet's decisions on Tuesday, Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu said while 34% reservation will be given to BCs in rural local bodies, they will have 33.33% quota in urban local bodies. Besides, election of Mayors and Municipal Chairpersons in urban local bodies will be conducted through direct polls.

Naidu said that the TDP-led NDA government is fulfilling its 2024 election promise of increasing the BC reservation in local bodies from 20% to 34%. He said the issue about correcting the injustice done to BCs under the previous government. ENS

GANDHI DARSHAN

(Near Rajghat)

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2nd (Wed.) & 3rd (Thu.) September, 2026

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(Director, Gandhi Darshan)

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Vice Chairman
Former Union Minister

TN to revise maternity leave for third child from 12 weeks to one year

Chennai: Maternity leave for Tamil Nadu state government employees will be increased from the current 12 weeks to 365 days in the case of a third child, Minister for Human Resource Management D Saranikumar told Assembly on Tuesday. Currently, married women government employees with fewer than two children are granted 365 days of maternity leave, while those with two or more surviving children get up to 12 weeks of maternity leave. Previous governments had raised maternity leave from the original 90 days to six months in 2011, nine months in 2016, and 365 days in 2021. PTI

Chouhan administers 'Sapt Dhara' pledge to his ministry

New Delhi: Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Tuesday administered a pledge to officials of the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare and the Ministry of Rural Development, urging them to realise the vision of seven streams of strength or 'Sapt Dhara' as outlined by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in his Independence Day speech.

On Tuesday, Chouhan's deputies — Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani, Minister of State for Rural Development and Bhagirath Choudhary, Minister of State of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare — along with Agriculture Secretary Atish Chandra, Rural Development Secretary Rohit Kansal, ICAR DG and DARE Secretary DR Mangi Lal Jaat, Land Resources Secretary Narendra Bhoshan and other officials of the both ministries took pledge.

"...participants resolved to make agriculture more prosperous, strengthen food production, expand food processing, take Indian agricultural products to global markets, increase incomes of farmers and ensure due respect for their hard work...towards the goal of creating six crore Lakhpati Dids, following the achievement of the target of three crore Lakhpati Dids..." the Ministry of Rural Development said in a statement. ENS

UTTARAKHAND ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION

"Vidut Niyamak Bhawan" Near ISBT, PO- Majra, Dehradun- 248171
PH. 0135-2641115 Website: www.uerc.gov.in Email- secy.uerc@gov.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

Inviting comments on the Draft UERC (Deviation Settlement Mechanism and Related Matters) Regulations, 2026

In exercise of the powers conferred under Section 181 of the Electricity Act, 2003 (36 of 2003), and all other powers enabling it in this behalf, the Commission has issued draft UERC (Deviation Settlement Mechanism and Related Matters) Regulations, 2026. The draft Regulation has been posted at the Commission's website www.uerc.uk.gov.in.

2. Notice is hereby given inviting comments/suggestions/objections on the draft Regulation from all the stakeholders. These could be sent to the undersigned latest by **17.09.2026** by post or e-mail or in person at the above-mentioned address for Commission's consideration.

3. The comments/suggestions/objections received after the stipulated date in the Commission's office may not be considered while finalizing these Regulations.

Advt. No. 13/2026-27

Secretary

Guru Ghasidas Vishwavidyalaya, (A Central University) Bilaspur

(C.G.) School of Studies of Engineering & Technology

Admission in B.Tech. Program against vacant / drop-out seats for Academic Session 2026-27

Advt. Ref. No.689/Academic/2026 Date: 14.08.2026

The School of Studies of Engineering & Technology, Guru Ghasidas Vishwavidyalaya, Bilaspur (C.G.) is going to conduct Spot / Local Counseling for Admission in B.Tech. Program on 03rd September 2026 for few vacant seats in the different branches of Engineering i.e. Chemical Engineering, Civil Engineering, Computer Science & Engineering, Electrical Engineering, Electronics & Communication Engineering, Information Technology, Industrial & Production Engineering, Mechanical Engineering, Artificial Intelligence & Data Science and VFX & Animation Engineering. Interested candidates shall apply online during 17.08.2026 to 25.08.2026. The detailed information about seats availability and procedure of admission is available on the website <https://ggv.ac.in/>.

Registrar

GOVT. OF BIHAR

BIHAR COMBINED ENTRANCE COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION BOARD

L.A.S. Association Building, Near Patna Airport, Patna-14.

Website : bcecebboard.bihar.gov.in / Helpdesk : helpdesk.bcecebboard@bihar.gov.in

POST GRADUATE DENTAL ADMISSION COUNSELLING (PGDAC)-2026

for MDS in Govt./ Private Dental colleges of Bihar

Advt. No.- BCECEB(PGDAC)-2026/01 Dated : 18.08.2026

Notice for Online Application & Choice Filling (Round-1 & 2)

Online application in prescribed form from the qualified, eligible & interested NEET (MDS)-2026 candidates are invited on the basis of the Merit List of NEET (MDS)-2026 for appearing in the Post Graduate Dental Admission Counselling (PGDAC)-2026 in order to select candidates for admission to the FIRST YEAR of the following Post Graduate Dental Courses in Government and Private Dental Colleges of Bihar State for the academic session 2026:

- (i) MDS Course in Govt. Dental College i.e. Patna Dental College, Patna.
- (ii) MDS Course in Private Dental Colleges viz. Mithila Minority Dental College & Hospital, Darbhanga and Buddha Institute of Dental Science & Hospital, Kankarbagh, Patna.

2. The online Registration and submission of Application Form will start from 20.08.2026 and close on 24.08.2026.

3. Eligibility criteria for Online Counselling, Fee payment procedure, Choice filling, instructions, Seat Matrix and other details are available in the prospectus of PGDAC-2026 and the related detailed Advertisement No. BCECEB(PGDAC)-2026/01 Dated 18.08.2026 which can be downloaded from the Board's website: bcecebboard.bihar.gov.in.

Controller of Examination

राजिव गोेल
राजीव रायचौधरी सेल
दिल्ली सरकार

Sd/-
Kattikaya Gopal, Advocate
For Rajiv Goel & Associates
Counsel for the Petitioners
Against the Petitioners

NATIONAL DEWORMING CAMPAIGN

18 - 22 August 2026

ONE SAFE TABLET - TWICE A YEAR - A HEALTHIER FUTURE

Soil Transmitted worms can live inside your child's body silently draining their health.

leads in: Iron Deficiency, Weakness, Fatigue, Poor Academic Performance

During National Deworming Campaign, all children in the age group of 1 to 19 years will be administered chewable Albendazole tablet at all schools (Govt./ Govt. aided/ Private) and Anganwadi centers.

A single dose of **Albendazole** can prevent anemia, improve nutrition & academic performance. This dose should be given under supervision & it is **completely safe** for every child.

Request to Parents

- Make sure to send your children to schools/Anganwadi Center for upcoming NDD Campaign.
- Do not give empty stomach - medicine has to be given only after food.
- Join this campaign to make children Worm free.



Directorate of Family Welfare and
Delhi State Health Mission, GNCT of Delhi

DIP/Shabdarth/Display/073/26-27





Back In The Bar

TUESDAY'S ELECTION to the Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA) saw former Vice President Jagdeep Dhankhar turning up to cast his vote. Dhankhar, a designated senior advocate, has been practising in the SC since the 1990s. Sources said that after a break, during which he was Governor of West Bengal and later Vice President, Dhankhar resumed his membership of the bar body earlier this year. Senior Advocate Pradeep Rai was elected SCBA president in the election which saw an estimated 82 per cent turnout.

Bday Message

INDIA'S ECONOMIC development under Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman's stewardship got a thumbs up from Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday. While wishing Sitharaman on her birthday, the PM posted on X that she was "adding momentum to our endeavour of being a strong and self-reliant India. May she be blessed with a long and healthy life". Thanking him for the wishes, Sitharaman said the PM's guidance served as motivation.

In The Wings

THE MUCH-AWAITED Delhi Master Plan 2047 may soon be revealed. It is learnt that Union Minister of Housing and Urban Affairs Manohar Lal, Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta could address a press conference later this week to announce the notification of the plan, which was approved by the Delhi Development Authority last week.

18 IPS officers, including two SPs, transferred in Bihar

Himanshu Harsh Pathra, August 18

THE BIHAR government on Tuesday transferred the Superintendents of Police (SPs) of Siwan and Bhojpur as part of a reshuffle of 18 IPS officers, days after the two districts came under scrutiny over separate police actions.

As per a notification by the state Home Department, Siwan SP Purnan Kumar Jha was transferred and placed on the waiting list for a new posting. Bharat Soni, serving as SP of Nalanda, was appointed as SP of Siwan. The change comes less than a month after a policeman was seen firing an AK-47 in the air during student protests in Siwan. The July 25 protests, held amid an agitation over the alleged NEET paper leaks and earlier police action against students, turned violent, with clashes between protesters and law enforcement personnel. Three persons had sustained bullet injuries and several police personnel, including Jha, were injured. Police had registered three FIRs based on the injured civilians' statements, while a constable seen using the AK-47 was suspended. On November 23, 2025, however, police had made it clear that no one was injured in the incident.

Meanwhile, Bhojpur SP Raj was transferred to Rohtas. Awadesh Dikshit, serving as SP (Personnel-I) at Bihar Police HQ, was appointed the new Bhojpur SP. Hirday Kant, serving with the ATS, was appointed SP of Nalanda. Roshan Kumar was transferred from Rohtas and posted as Senior SP, Saran. The government also carried out a major IAS reshuffle hours earlier, transferring 17 officers, including the DMs of Siwan and Bhojpur.

STUDENT UNREST, JOBS, AYODHYA THEFT ALLEGATIONS ON PARTY AGENDA

As Vande Mataram row simmers, CWC to chart Cong's next offensive

Manoj CG
New Delhi, August 18

AMID THE perception in the Opposition that the BJP-led NDA government is on the backfoot on several issues, the Congress Working Committee (CWC) is set to meet on Wednesday. This comes at a time when the party is embroiled in a controversy over the rendition of Vande Mataram.

With the BJP escalating its attack on the Congress over the rendition of Vande Mataram during an Independence Day event at the AICC headquarters and later at an event in Goa attended by party president Mallikarjun Kharge, the Congress has made it clear that its programmes will feature only the first two stanzas of the national song. However, a section of the Congress believes the party should tread carefully on an issue with nationalistic overtones. The issue is likely to come up for discussion at the CWC meeting, though sources said it was not on the agenda as of now.

The Congress, citing a 1937



Lok Sabha LoP Rahul Gandhi at the meet of district presidents of AICC OBC Department at the Congress HQ in Delhi on Tuesday. ANI

CWC resolution, has argued that leading lights of the freedom movement, including Mahatma Gandhi and Rabindranath Tagore, had backed limiting public rendition to the first two stanzas to avoid verses containing specific religious imagery.

On Tuesday, Kharge said the song the exact same version of the national song that leaders such as Mahatma Gandhi, Ja-

waharlal Nehru, and Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel sang and argued that if singing that version constitutes a crime, the government should register an FIR against the late national leaders.

"I sang the same Vande Mataram that Mahatma Gandhi and Jawaharlal Nehru sang. I sang the same Vande Mataram that they have been singing for 18 years... their Central govern-

ment... I sang what Vajpayee sang... If singing it is a crime, then they have been committing that crime for the past 18 years. If this is a crime, then file a case against Gandhi, Nehruji and Vallabhbhai Patel," said the Congress president.

"They are unaware of the fact that, even before they were born, the Congress had passed a resolution determining which national songs to adopt for the country. It is not the case that whatever you say becomes the national standard. Tomorrow, another government might come to power; if they say something, that becomes the rule. We have simply continued the practice that has been in place for 90 years."

Karnataka Congress chief B K Hariprasad also told *The Indian Express* that the state unit would sing only the first two stanzas of Vande Mataram at its programmes, in keeping with the existing practice.

The controversy over the national song began after Parliament, in the recently concluded Monsoon Session, passed the Prevention of In-

sults to National Honour (Amendment) Act, 2026, which makes attempts to stop or prevent the singing or playing of Vande Mataram an offence.

The Congress, meanwhile, is also keen to project that the government has been buffeted by student unrest, alleged theft of Ram temple donations, ethno-blending and fresh reports of tension along the China border in Arunachal Pradesh.

The party is now looking to work out a strategy to keep the issues alive and sharpen its political attack.

The CWC meeting will be the first since the recent Jantar Mantar protests, which ended with the resignation of Dhamendra Pradhan as Union Education Minister. While the party has decided to keep its distance from the Cockerroach Janta Party (CJP), the leadership is keen to link the student unrest to the larger issue of jobs.

Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi, meanwhile, is stepping up his interactions with students, with his next programme scheduled in Pune on August 22.

EXPRESS special

Why new rules in Maharashtra give CM veto power over any minister

Vallabh Ozarkar
Mumbai, August 18

THE MAHAYUTI-LED Maharashtra government has framed new rules empowering the Chief Minister, Devendra Fadnis, to override a decision taken by any department, and the minister in charge and the department secretary, and the Minister of State, who is now the Deputy CM.

The new rules equip the CM with several other mechanisms to intervene in the functioning of departments. The CM can seek documents relating to any matter from any department, and the minister in charge and the department secretary are required to comply with such a request. The Chief Secretary, too, can seek documents from any department. The rules provide that the CM can direct cases to be placed before the Cabinet. Matters in the Second Schedule must be brought before the Cabinet, while cases in the Third Schedule have to be submitted to the CM before orders are issued. The rules also allow the Cabinet to decide certain matters through circular letters, by sending them to ministers for their views, rather than through discussion at a meeting. If the ministers are unanimous and the CM permitted recruitment in the Chandrapur District Central Cooperative Bank — ruled that the CM had no supervisory power over the decision of the minister concerned as he had no power under the 1975 rules of government business, he also required to modify a minister's decision.

The amended business rules now specifically provide for such an intervention by the CM in any minister's decision. Under its rule 13(5), the CM can, except in judicial matters, override a decision taken by any minister in public interest and by recording the reasons in writing.

In the Chandrapur cooperative bank case, the bank had vacancies and had received permission from the Cooperation Department to start recruitment. Then cooperation minister Atul Save subsequently lifted a stay on the recruitment. On November 23, 2025, however, then CM Shinde, the Shiv Sena chief and BJP's key ally, issued an order on November 29, 2022, to stop this recruitment. The bank challenged the CM's order before the HC, which set it aside. The new business rules retain the minister-in-charge as the primary authority for disallowing of business assigned to the department concerned, while providing for the CM to override such a decision on the ground of public interest.

While the Fadnis camp rules out any political motive

behind amending the 1975 rules, there is a buzz in state political circles linking it to "friction" between the Mahayuti allies, especially between CM Fadnis and Shinde, who is now the Deputy CM.

The new rules equip the CM with several other mechanisms to intervene in the functioning of departments. The CM can seek documents relating to any matter from any department, and the minister in charge and the department secretary are required to comply with such a request. The Chief Secretary, too, can seek documents from any department. The rules provide that the CM can direct cases to be placed before the Cabinet. Matters in the Second Schedule must be brought before the Cabinet, while cases in the Third Schedule have to be submitted to the CM before orders are issued. The rules also allow the Cabinet to decide certain matters through circular letters, by sending them to ministers for their views, rather than through discussion at a meeting. If the ministers are unanimous and the CM permitted recruitment in the Chandrapur District Central Cooperative Bank — ruled that the CM had no supervisory power over the decision of the minister concerned as he had no power under the 1975 rules of government business, he also required to modify a minister's decision.

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While the Fadnis camp rules out any political motive



Kathmandu talks

Chief of the Army Staff General Dhiraj Seth meets Nepal Prime Minister Balendra Shah at his office in Kathmandu on Tuesday. They discussed issues of mutual interest and ways to strengthen military ties. General Seth is on an official visit to Nepal from August 17-19 at the invitation of his Nepalese Army counterpart General Ashok Raj Sigdel. ANI

BRICS Environment Ministers oppose EU's Carbon Border Tax

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, August 18

BRICS ENVIRONMENT and climate ministers Tuesday opposed the European Union's (EU) Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) or Carbon Border Tax, calling it unilateral, punitive, discriminatory and protection measure that is not in line with international law.

They reiterated that developed nations must urgently scale up climate finance, especially for climate adaptation. CBAM is an import levy on carbon-intensive goods like steel, iron, fertilisers, aluminium and cement. The tax was aimed as a measure to reduce the carbon footprint of imported goods, but the step has been seen as a trade barrier by developing countries.

Rolling out on October 1, 2023, with a reporting-only phase, CBAM was entirely effected from January 1, 2026, when importers were asked to purchase and surrender CBAM certifi-

Bloc of developing economies has also pressed rich nations on climate finance

cates tied to carbon emissions embedded in their goods.

In the 'Adaptation and climate resilience' part of the joint statement, member nations "expressed concern" that measures like CBAM "undermine efforts by countries, specifically the developing countries", aimed at addressing the adverse impacts of climate change. Increased adaptive capacity, and resilience. The meeting, chaired by India in New Delhi, brought together environment and climate ministers and senior officials from Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, United Arab Emirates, Indonesia, Iran, Saudi Arabia, Egypt and Ethiopia.

In a joint statement issued at the conclusion of the 12th

BRICS Environment Ministers' meeting, the bloc of nine developing economies has also urged wealthy nations to deliver on the New Collective Quantified Goal (NCQG) reached at the COP (Conference of Parties) 30 held in Belem, Brazil, to triple adaptation finance to developing countries by 2035.

The joint declaration document invoked the principle of "common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities" (CBDR-RC), underscoring that all cooperation commitments — from forest fire protocols to circular economy standards — remain voluntary and calibrated to each country's national circumstances. It marked the culmination of a year of technical work by the BRICS Environment Working Group and its Contact Group on Climate Change and Sustainable Development. India formally handed over hosting duties for the 13th edition to China, which will lead the meeting in 2027.

Prasad accuses Cong of 'same mentality' that decided its pact with Muslim League

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 18

ACCUSING IT of "suffering from the same mentality that brought it in alliance with the Muslim League", the BJP on Tuesday alleged that Congress was compromising on national interests for its vote-bank politics and providing ideological support to Naxalism.

Senior BJP leader Ravi Shankar Prasad said that following the "embarrassment" at the Congress headquarters on August 15, where Sonia Gandhi appeared to be opposing the recitation of Vande Mataram in its entirety, Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge had, in Goa, said that only two stanzas were sung at the party event there as well. "Today, we want to raise a question about the mindset of the entire Congress party. If it indulges in such acts... If it is behaving in this manner with the great national song, then it should please stop its arrogance of claiming to be the sole custodian of India's freedom movement," Prasad said.

Underlining that Vande Mataram was one of the major songs of India's freedom struggle and served as a source of inspiration, the senior BJP leader said that the Congress had, in 1936-37, entered into a pact with the Muslim League, and perhaps for this reason, the Muslim League "exerted pressure that only two stanzas should be sung, as the remaining portions hurt their religious sentiments".



BJP leader Ravi Shankar Prasad

"The first President of India and great freedom fighter, Dr Rajendra Prasad, clearly declared in the Constituent Assembly meeting on January 24, 1950, that 'Jana Gana Mana' would be the National Anthem and 'Vande Mataram', the national song," the senior BJP leader highlighted.

"Dr Rajendra Prasad was himself a member of the Congress and was the president of the Constituent Assembly, and later, became the President of India," Prasad pointed out.

Mallikarjun Kharge, was Dr Rajendra Prasad a leader of the freedom movement or not? Did Dr Rajendra Prasad declare in the Constituent Assembly in 1950 that Vande Mataram was the National Song or not? Then who is Mallikarjun Kharge mocking, and why? The Congress party is still afflicted by the same mindset that characterised its relationship with the Muslim League during the Lucknow Pact of 1936-37," the BJP leader said, adding that instead of learning from its mistakes, Congress' leaders were themselves becoming "symbols of anarchy".

2 days on, Surat police detains 26 for 'inciting' textile workers' unrest

Kamal Saied
Surat, August 18

TWO DAYS after hundreds of workers from textile factories here clashed following a shutdown call, police on Tuesday detained 26 people for allegedly provoking the unrest. Most of the detainees ran WhatsApp groups that were allegedly used to incite people.

On Sunday afternoon, scores of workers stormed two embroidery units at Vedant Eco Park-2, an industrial estate in Amroli suburb. When the owner did not yield, they turned off the power, bringing the powerloom units to a halt. They demanded their weekly off on Sundays, a reduction in the working hours from 12 to 8 hours, and a wage hike.

Two FIRs were registered at the Amroli police station against the workers, charging them with rioting, unlawful assembly, trespass and other BNS sections. As the unrest spread to the southern suburbs of Sachin, Udhna and Pandesara by Monday, police's help was sought.

Surat's textile industry almost ground to a halt in March after workers, hit by the LPG crisis amid the US-Iran war, went back to their home states of Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Odisha. It was by May that the factories returned to work with full force, even as the market demand rose with the wedding and festive seasons beginning in a month.

On Tuesday, the agitating workers raised their issues before four department officials in a meeting convened by police in Amroli. The officials assured them that their demands



Many workers had stormed two embroidery units at Vedant Eco Park-2 in Surat's Amroli, demanding weekly off on Sundays, reduced working hours and a wage hike. EXPRESS

would be discussed with textile factory owners soon. The Sunday incident at Amroli turned violent as police tried to stop the agitating workers, who allegedly resorted to stone-pelting. The owner of Vedanta Eco Park units, Vishal Gohil has lodged a complaint against over 250 people who forcibly shut down his factory on Sunday and Monday. A police constable from the Surat Crime Branch, Atulkumar Dubey, who suffered a head injury, also lodged a complaint against 400-500 textile workers, officers said.

DCP (Zone 5) Lakhdhirsinh Zala said, "The situation is now under control, and all the factories are operational in Amroli and other areas of the city. The workers didn't have a platform where they could put up their issues... In the stone-pelting incident on police and the injury to a police constable on Sunday, we detained 26 people."

Family to changes in India: Sonia memoir out Nov 10

Hillel Italie
New York, August 18

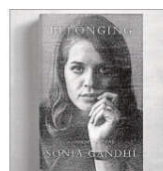
SONIA GANDHI has a memoir coming out this fall in which she will reflect on the promise and the tragedy of marrying into India's Nehru-Gandhi political dynasty and on her own career in government. Publisher Alfred A Knopf announced on Tuesday that Gandhi's *Belonging: A Journey of Love* will be published November 10.

"Much has been written about my family, but few nar-

ratives were able to reach into the truth of their motivations, their actions and even their very human failings," Gandhi said in a statement issued through Knopf.

"In many ways, this book is a homage to their humanness. My story also offers readers a new perspective of the social and political changes I have witnessed for six decades in the beautiful country of my belonging," Gandhi said.

In *'Belonging'*, she writes of her life being upended when her mother-in-law Prime Min-



The publisher of *Belonging: A Journey of Love*, Alfred A Knopf, made the announcement on Tuesday. INSTAGRAM/AAKNOPF

ister Indira Gandhi was assassinated in 1984 and succeeded by Rajiv Gandhi, who seven years later was also murdered. She too would eventually enter politics and become the longest-serving president of the Congress party while also turning down her party's offer to become prime minister.

Her party lost power to the BJP in 2014. "It was heartbreak and loss that threw me into the public world of politics. Up till then I had guarded my privacy fiercely," she said in her statement. "Writing about my life

did not come easily to me. It meant opening myself up, sharing moments and experiences I had always held deep inside," she said.

"Yet as I gradually removed myself from the political sphere and looked back at all I had seen, the thread of love and compassion that ran through my story began to define itself, from the simplicity of my childhood in small-town Italy, to the complexity of my years in India as the wife of Rajiv Gandhi and the daughter-in-law of Prime Minister Indira Gandhi." AP

Trump cites CEC's remark, India's voter ID to push 'Save America Act'

Damini Nath & Divya A
New Delhi, August 18

UNITED STATES President Donald Trump on Tuesday said the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) of India, Gyanesh Kumar, had asked his administration how the US could hold elections without valid photo IDs for voters, citing India's voter IDs while renewing his push for the passage of the Save America Act that requires proof of citizenship for voter registration in the country.

In a social media post, Trump wrote: "Earlier this month, India's Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar asked our administration - How can you have Elections in the US without a valid Photo ID? India's last Election had 646,000,000 voters! Less than 1% voted by mail, and every single voter had to have a VALID Photo ID. Document. We need to pass THE

SAVE AMERICA Act, now!"

While the Election Commission (EC) did not comment on the matter, a source said that when US Ambassador to India Sergio Gormet met the CEC at the Commission headquarters on August 12, Kumar had informed Gormet about India's electoral processes, the last Lok Sabha elections and the E-lector's Photo ID. The CEC told the Ambassador that all voters have Photo IDs, the source said. The meeting is learnt to have lasted about 30 minutes.

When asked about the US President's remarks, Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson Randeep Jaiswal said: "I have no specific comments to make on these remarks. I can say, however, that the credibility and robustness of India's election machinery is a well-established fact globally."

Kumar, who is chairing the

India's last Election had 646,000,000 voters! Less than 1% voted by mail, and every single voter had to have a VALID Photo ID. Document. We need to pass THE SAVE AMERICA Act, now!"

DONALD TRUMP,
US PRESIDENT

International Institute for Democracy and Electoral Assistance this year as part of India's chairmanship, has been holding meetings with ambassadors and high commissioners for the past few months.

Meanwhile, Gormet, in a post on X, backed Trump's remarks on India's voter identification requirements and urged Con-

gress to pass the legislation. "President Trump is absolutely correct! 646 MILLION voters, every single one required an ID in India's last election. Congress should pass THE SAVE AMERICA ACT!" he wrote.

After the meeting of the CEC and Gormet last week, the EC said on X: "Both sides reaffirmed their shared commitment to strengthening democratic cooperation. They also agreed to work closely together to deepen collaboration on election management and the training of election staff."

There is no information yet from the US Embassy in New Delhi on what was discussed during the meeting. An email has been sent to the Embassy in this regard.

The proposed 'SAVE America' legislation seeks to introduce documentary proof of US citizenship for registration to vote in federal elections and

photo identification requirements for voting.

It would also establish measures concerning voter registration and federal voter rolls, including provisions aimed at preventing non-citizens from registering to vote in federal elections.

The White House has described the measure as a way to ensure that only US citizens participate in federal elections. "American citizens — and only American citizens — should decide American elections," the White House said, describing the proposal as a "common sense, bipartisan bill".

However, the proposed legislation has drawn criticism from Democratic lawmakers, who have argued that documentary proof requirements could create additional barriers for eligible voters who do not have readily available citizen-

Hasina daughter questions WHO action against her, calls for investigation

Sent on leave as S-E Asia regional director in 2025

Divya A
New Delhi, August 18

OUSTED BANGLADESH Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina's daughter Saima Wazed, who took charge as the World Health Organisation's Regional Director for the South-East Asia Region in February 2024 but was placed on indefinite leave in July last year, has sought an independent investigation into the action against her, The Indian Express has learnt.

Wazed is learnt to have raised the matter with WHO and its Director General, Tedros Ghebreyesus, repeatedly over the past eight months, seeking transparency over the decision. The latest communication was sent last month, through her legal representatives, warning of legal recourse.

WHO placed Wazed on indefinite leave on July 11, 2025, pending an inquiry, four months after Bangladesh's Anti Corruption Commission (ACC) filed two cases against her on charges of corruption, fraud and abuse of power. An acting regional director was named, whose term has since ended.

Wazed is learnt to have alleged that the action was taken at the behest of the then interim government in Bangladesh led by Mohammad Yunus, overlooking due process. Alleging that WHO failed to explain its action, she has asked if any formal inquiry is being conducted while she remains on leave for over a year now. Besides misconduct, she has also accused WHO of bias and harassment.

According to sources, while WHO acknowledged some of her emails, it is yet to provide clarity on any ongoing review of the complaints against her.

Sources said the decision to place Wazed on leave was communicated to WHO staff in an



Saima Wazed has alleged the action was taken at the behest of the then interim Bangladesh govt led by Mohammad Yunus

internal email from the Director General. According to sources, the email suggested that the Bangladesh government's objections, questions over the legitimacy of her election, and the ACC cases were all factors behind the decision.

When contacted by The Indian Express, Wazed refused to comment on the issue.

Responding to email queries from The Indian Express, WHO confirmed that Wazed "remains on leave". "There are established channels for staff members who wish to raise complaints of the nature of those referred to in the questions... However, we do not comment on specific cases, where we have a duty to maintain confidentiality," it said in an email.

Sources said Wazed has raised several "concerns", including WHO's alleged direct communication and dealings with Bangladesh's ACC and other officials of the then interim government, alleging a breach of due process and protocol for diplomatic communication.

She is also learnt to have alleged misrepresentation of facts to member states — including India, who voted for her nomination as the past Regional Director, SEARO, headquartered in New Delhi — thereby causing damage to her reputation.

While India is learnt to have raised the matter with WHO through appropriate channels, it has not issued any official comment on the matter.

"WHO's decision to place

Wazed on leave immediately on receipt of a political request is significantly different to how the organisation responded when Tedros himself faced similar attacks from Ethiopia," said a source.

The source said this was particularly questionable given that Wazed was tried in absentia in Dhaka and declared a fugitive. "WHO has yet to provide a full public explanation of how information received from external political actors was assessed, verified, and weighed before action was taken against an elected regional director," said the source. Wazed has alleged that she continues to be targeted, at the behest of the Bangladesh government, for being Hasina's daughter, overlooking her own credentials and work in healthcare. According to sources, she was initially sent on leave without pay, but was later placed on administrative leave without pay for some months, as she raised the matter.

Wazed assumed office on February 1, 2024, for a five-year term, becoming the first person from Bangladesh and the second woman to hold the position. She received eight of the total 10 votes cast, including India's.

"That mandate was altered by a hasty executive decision without the participation of the very member states that selected Wazed," said another source, adding that regional directors are accountable to the member states that elect them.

According to sources, Wazed may have been informed one day or two before the announcement, raising further concerns about the process followed. Until WHO releases the relevant documentation and explains the authority under which the action was taken, key questions will remain unanswered, said a source close to Wazed who did not want to be identified.

Meanwhile, the position of regional director has not been declared vacant. While Wazed remains the elected regional director, sources alleged that she faces "sustained pressure" to step aside voluntarily.

SC rejects plea seeking abolition of execution by hanging

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 18

THE SUPREME COURT on Tuesday dismissed a plea challenging the validity of the law prescribing hanging as the sole method of execution of a death sentence but left it open for future scrutiny if the need arises.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta noted that a three-judge bench of the court had in the case Deena vs Union of India in 2023 upheld the constitutional validity of Section 354(5) of The Code of Criminal Procedure, which prescribes this, and "hence, the scope of interference by a Bench of two judges on the very same issue is extremely limited".

Justice Mehta said, "There is no dispute that in Deena... the entire scope of ambit of hanging as the mode of execution of a death sentence was exhaustively considered with reference to foreign precedents, expert opinions and other scientific materials then available before the Court."

The three-judge Bench, it pointed out, "specifically analysed and evaluated the comparative merits of different methods of execution of death sentences. After examining electrocution, lethal gas, shooting, and lethal injection as modes of execution, the court concluded that none of these methods possessed any distinct or demonstrable advantage over hanging."

The PIL by Senior Advocate Rishi Malhotra said the present method of death by hanging is physically painful and psychologically traumatic to the prisoner. The court, however, said that "such argument was not supported by any unimpeachable scientific or empirical evidence".

Study links shape of starling flight patterns to threats from predators

First of its kind in India, study carried out in Ahmedabad varsity campus

Parimal A Dabhi
Ahmedabad, August 18

THESE DAYS, driving across the Sabarmati to the walled city of Ahmedabad on the eastern bank of the river, you could be treated to a mesmerising spectacle.

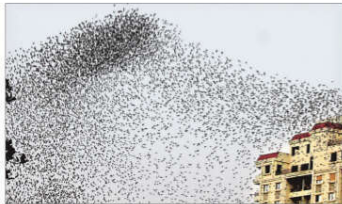
Dark grey, shape-shifting clouds of hundreds of birds flying in formation, swooping low and rising high, looping back and forth above the water, filling the air with their ceaseless chirping before settling on branches of one of the many ficus trees along the Sabarmati waterfront.

These are starlings (Pastor roseus) — and as the monsoon enters its second half, enormous flocks have started to arrive in Gujarat to nest for the winter. Their 'murmurations' — the swirling, synchronised flights that make the birds look like a single, fluid organism rippling through the sky — are visible mostly at dusk, but often at dawn as well.

Researchers from Ahmedabad University have established a correlation between the size and shape of the murmurations and the threat and proximity of a predator in the sky.

The study, the first of its kind in India, has been published in the April issue of *Integrative and Comparative Biology* (ICB).

The paper, authored by Venu Divin and Jitesh Jhawar of the School of Arts and Sciences at Ahmedabad University, has quantified the



Starling murmurations above Vadodra, Gujarat is the preeminent state to view rosy starling flocks in the sky at dusk. BYUPENDRA RAMA

shape dynamics of rosy starling flocks in the presence and absence of predators — and concluded that a predator's presence has an influence on the geometry of murmurations.

"From the perspective of group living [of birds], this study has broad implications," Jhawar told *The Indian Express*. "So far, group living studies have been done in labs; there are very few group living studies directly from the field. This study is one of its kind in that sense."

The study of shapes is also rare, Jhawar said. "There are very few such studies, especially in the wild. If their (the birds') behaviour is to be predicted in future, these types of studies are needed. Until we understand these dynamics, we will not be able to predict their responses in their natural environment. The collective response is important because often species do not respond individually," he said.

Starling murmurations, which are typically seen at dusk for a few minutes to up to an hour, are common in the autumn and winter across Europe and North America. India sees

some spectacular murmurations as well, and Jamnagar's Lakhotia Lake, Gujarat, is one of the best known hotspots.

The rosy starlings seen in India are different from the European variety of the species. The birds breed in Central and West Asia and Eastern Europe, and start migrating to the Indian subcontinent from around July-August to winter until March — making an unusual west-east journey rather than the north-south one that most migratory species make.

The birds forage only on trees and not on ground. Flocks have been seen in Gujarat from around the end of July this year. Besides Gujarat, starlings are also seen in Rajasthan, Karnataka, Kerala, Chhattisgarh, Telangana, and Andhra Pradesh.

The study was carried out on campus at Ahmedabad University from January 2, 2025 to February 13, 2025.

Videos and photographs were taken from atop a building rising over canopy height, and the murmurations were classified in various shape categories. The data were collected over 28 days, from one hour before sunset until five minutes.

"We recorded details... including the shape of the flock, the approximate number of individuals in the flock, the time of observation, the direction of the flock, whether merging or splitting occurred, the shape shift, and the presence of any predator near the flock..." the authors have noted in the paper.

A total 3,023 flocks were recorded during the sampling period, and 12 distinct canonical shapes were identified, including "Small Road", "Small Oval", "Globular", "Wave Shape", "Voidal", "Snake" and "C-Shape". The most common avian predator at the study site was the black kite (*Milvus migrans*). The study recorded 181 instances in which a predator was present within 10 metres of a flock of rosy starlings.

In the absence of a predator, flock shape frequencies were dominated by "Small Oval" (279%) and "Mini Flock" (277%) formations. In the presence of a predator, the "Small Road" shape became overwhelmingly dominant, accounting for 71.3% of observed shapes.

"The Small Road formation has a relatively large surface area and pointed ends at the front and rear, features that may facilitate higher flight speed," the study noted.

"... such configurations may offer advantages that allow faster escape."

However, the change in murmuration displays was not consistent or predictable. "Although black kites were present in the study area on most days, predator presence alone did not consistently trigger murmuration displays. This observation contrasts with the common assumption that predator presence directly induces murmurations," the authors wrote.

Laxmanananda Saraswati case: Maoist leader 'Azad' acquitted due to lack of evidence

Sujit Bisoi
Bhubaneswar, August 18

A SPECIAL Court in Odisha on Tuesday acquitted Maoist leader D Kesaba Rao alias Azad, who was accused by the police of being a conspirator and the main accused in the killing of Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) leader Laxmanananda Saraswati and four of his disciples in August 2008, due to lack of evidence. He was released from Bhubaneswar's Jharpada jail later in the evening.

Around 25 masked people had entered the Ashram at Jalespeta in Kandhamal district on August 23, 2008, and opened fire. Besides the VHP leader, others killed in the incident were Mata Bhaktimayee, Kishore Baba, Amrutananda and the brother of one of the inmates.

The killing of Saraswati had triggered communal violence in Kandhamal that claimed 38 lives and over 25,000 were rendered homeless. As per police investigation, after the crime, the accused left behind a letter, stating that the Maoists of Biju Sahadhar Division had executed the killing. The letter was signed by the name "Azad". The police also claimed that Azad had called a meeting after the incident where he revealed that he, along with others, had killed Saraswati.

The court said that despite the fact that five persons were murdered, the crucial issue is whether the prosecution has proved that this accused caused, participated in, or shared the criminal liability for the murders. "Criminal jurisprudence does not permit con-

viction merely because an accused appears to be a possible participant in a grave occurrence. The prosecution must establish his identity and participation by reliable evidence," observed the court.

The court said no firearm was shown to have been recovered from Azad, no ballistic evidence connecting any weapon with him has been referred to, and no forensic evidence linking him to the scene has been proved in the material supplied. Though 22 witnesses were examined, there was only one eyewitness in the case. The court said no independent eyewitness identified Azad and no admissible confession or discovery connecting him with the murders has been established. "The prosecution has consequently failed to establish beyond reasonable doubt that D Kesaba Rao participated in the murder of any of the five deceased persons," read the court order. "Suspicion, however strong, cannot substitute proof," the court said.

It observed that there was no reliable evidence to establish Azad's participation in the alleged conspiracy. The special court also observed that there was no evidence to prove Azad's guilt on charges of unlawful assembly, house trespass, theft and Arms Act. The order reads that the prosecution has reasonable doubt as to whether Rao was one of the persons who participated in the occurrence. "The Court cannot convert suspicion into proof because the offence is heinous," read the order.

Girl hired friends to kill grandfather for money to buy iPhone and bike, say Kerala Police

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, August 18

A MINOR girl allegedly hired three friends — all teenagers — to murder her grandfather for want of money, a probe into the man's death has revealed.

The incident happened in Alappuzha on August 15. The girl had chosen to stay with a friend that day. The man's wife and daughter were also away on a hospital visit, the police said.

"The man was smothered to death. A video call to the girl by one of the boys showed the man lying motionless. They then searched the house, stole the articles and returned to Kollam early Sunday morning," Alappuzha SP Vishnu Pradeep said.

The gang allegedly stole six sovereigns of gold. On Monday, the girl returned to the house. She then alerted her neighbours about the house being locked from the inside and no one was answering the door. Subsequently, police was informed. Officers were initially clueless about the incident, although it was clear the girl was for robbery. They also noticed the girl's impulsive demeanour following her grandfather's death.

Upon questioning the girl and examining her mobile phone, the conspiracy was unearthed. Police have apprehended the girl and her friends for murder. "They wanted to buy an iPhone for the girl and a bike for others," SP Pradeep said.

The teens will be produced before the Juvenile Justice Board and are likely to be tried as adults, police said.

80% of India's elderly could face heat stress up to three months at 3°C global warming, says study

Anuradha Mascarenhas
Pune, August 18

OLDER ADULTS across India, China, Pakistan and Bangladesh — or 73% of the world's older population — could face dangerous heat waves day and night for up to 3 months once global warming reaches 3 degrees Celsius (C) or more, a new study published in *The Lancet Planetary Health* estimates.

India stands out as one of the world's most vulnerable nations. At 3°C of warming, more than half of India's population and over 80% of its older adults could experience at least 180 hours of intolerable heat a year, on average. In Delhi and the greater Indo-Gangetic Plain, older adults are may experience close to or over 1,000 hours of intolerable heat a year at 1.5°C of global warming, expected around 2030. At 3°C, this rises to over 2,000 hours. "Importantly, these hours are not spread evenly



Older adults in New Delhi and the Indo-Gangetic plain could experience more than 2,000 hours of intolerable heat a year at 3°C of global warming, warns study in *The Lancet Planetary Health*. FILE

throughout the year. They are concentrated between May and September," Professor Qingxin Kong, lead author of the study, told *The Indian Express* via email.

Kong, over 3°C of warming, older adults could experience intolerable heat repeatedly during both day and night for several consecutive months. Such exposure would put enormous pressure on access to cooling, electricity, health services and heat-response programmes.

Prof Kong said older people face serious health risks from heat at lower temperatures than previously estimated. Previous studies relied heavily on measurements from healthy young adults to determine when temperature and humidity would become challenging for the human body. Older people

are generally less able to regulate body temperature: they sweat less, their blood vessels respond more slowly and their hearts work harder in the heat. As a result, earlier studies may have underestimated the number of people at risk from extreme heat by at least two-fold, she said.

Dr Mahaveer Golechha, a professor at IIPH-Gandhinagar and senior heat action plan expert, said, "Ageing diminishes the body's ability to control heat, and older people are likely to experience greater physiological strain at much lower temperature-humidity levels," he said.

The study's finding that South Asia is among the most vulnerable regions should be treated as a grave public health warning. Dr Golechha said, Heat-health early warning systems should account for age-related vulnerability, temperature and humidity, duration of exposure, night temperatures and local demographics.



The Indian EXPRESS
- FOUNDED BY -
RAMNATH GOENKA
IN 1932

BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Rejig in party must be reset for governance

THE BJP's organisational reshuffle is important, most of all, for its backdrop, and because of what lies ahead. It comes when the BJP-led government is two years into its third term at the Centre, and it needs to confront the gathering spectre of anti-incumbency. It comes after a students' movement forced a Union minister to resign and propelled to centre-stage two long-playing national crises — education and employment. The party reset will be followed, in a few months, by crucial state elections, but going ahead, the BJP as party will need to work with BJP as government to meet formidable challenges that need a long-term compass. From reforms in the education system starting with the government school, to skilling and the filling of gaps between degrees and the market — these problems can no longer be managed, they will need to be addressed. The BJP rejig, therefore, will be assessed not by the to-and-fro of individuals but by whether or not they contribute to its ability to be future-ready.

The students' movement has served parties and governments an important warning — political and electoral outreach cannot be just about the savvy social-media strategy. It must address the rising aspirations in a country of the young, write large by new media technologies, and identify the obstacles in social and economic mobility. In the BJP's recent cast on dark areas by the Jantar Mantra movement, the BJP must also confront challenges larger than Gen Z. It must ask, for instance, why for all its dominance and winning streak, e-leaderates in states are choosing a new player wherever it crosses a minimum threshold of viability — Prashant Kishor's victory in the BJP bastion of Bankipur appeared to underline this trend most recently. By hitting the refresh button, by drawing in Vasundhara Raju, who has been chief minister of a large state, or Smriti Irani, who has handled the BJP's portfolio in the Union government, or Ram Madhav, who has navigated turbulent political territories like J&K and the Northeast, or Manpreet Singh Badal, who has been state finance minister, the BJP has made a new beginning. How will these veterans, who have navigated the imperatives of governance, enrich decision-making in the party, while coupling it with the government — is the question. They could build on their experience, sensitising the party to governance priorities, keeping it connected to ground realities.

The party reset, as important as it is, is only a first step. Now that party president Nitin Gadkari's new team is in place, it may well betime for the government to follow the party. Because, quite simply, in times when older patterns don't hold, and political plates seem to be shifting, the onus of keeping up is squarely on the government and party.

On minerals and mines, strike federal balance

LAST WEEK, Parliament passed the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 that restricts states' powers to impose levies on mineral rights and mineral-bearing lands. The Centre's rationale for bringing the amendments is to provide greater certainty and predictability in the sector, facilitate investment flows and prevent higher levies from feeding into inflated costs. States have, however, expressed apprehensions over the implications of the amendments for their revenues in particular, and for fiscal federalism in general.

The amendments come after the Supreme Court upheld the right of states to impose such taxes, and also allowed them to recover arrears going back to April 1, 2005. Following this, states have looked towards raising more revenue from the sector. For instance, some of them have reportedly brought in mineral-bearing and taxes on iron ore. Jharkhand had initially imposed the tax on iron ore at Rs 100 per tonne, which was hiked subsequently and limestone (Tamil Nadu has set a tax of Rs 160 per tonne). States impose 14 types of taxes, charges, fees and levies such as royalty, auction premium etc. Across states, rates of royalty and taxes also vary. The changes in the law can also be seen as a bid to bring about some degree of uniformity in prices of major minerals.

The rationalisation of taxes and royalties is a step towards facilitating greater investor interest in the sector. The effective tax rate in India is higher than 50 per cent of revenues while it is 35 to 40 per cent in other countries, according to a report on States' Best Practices in Mining by FIM-EX. But state governments, with limited avenues to raise resources, are worried about a further erosion of their tax powers — for mineral rich states like Odisha, Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh, revenue from this channel accounts for a significant share of their non-tax revenue. According to a government fact-sheet, "States will continue to receive the overwhelming share of mining revenue," but friction between the Centre and states needs to be addressed. The Union government has launched a critical mineral mission. A more predictable mining framework would encourage greater investments in a sector that is vital for the growth of the country.

The prodigal jaguar against Trump wall

THE LAST female jaguar in the United States of America was killed by a hunter in 1949. The third-largest big cat, like its feline cousin, the tiger, is a solitary, elusive hunter. And like the leopard, its stealth means that it is particularly hard to spot. Now, nearly eight decades later, there is more than a slim chance that the majestic cat may come back to a habitat it was hunted out of. But the prodigal daughter return is hitting a wall.

Over the last five years, male jaguars have been spotted in the Cuencas Los Ojos wildlife reserve in Mexico, across the border from Arizona in the US. Earlier this month, researchers captured footage of a "couple", the first sighting of a female so close to the US — Arizona was once part of the jaguar's natural range — in nearly seven decades. Adela, named so by researchers, presents the tantalising possibility of a natural return of the big cat. Unfortunately, Donald Trump's politics is standing in the way. Since 2025, the infamous "border wall" has blocked three out of the four wildlife corridors in the area between the US and Mexico.

Perhaps, the politics that seeks to harden lines on a map into dividing ones on the ground could find a way to let the animals through. After all, as Robert Frost wrote, in "The Mending Wall" in 1914, there are people who will insist that "good fences make good neighbours". And yet, there's always "something", in nature and in the hearts of people, that doesn't love a wall.



RAJA MANDALA
BY C RAJA MOHAN

JAPANESE DEFENCE Minister Shinjiro Koizumi's visit to India this week comes amid the unfolding transformation of Tokyo's defence and regional security policies. Japan, long reined in by self-imposed military restraint, is adopting a more vigorous national defence policy and an active regional military diplomacy. That Koizumi is coming to Delhi after consultations in Canberra with his counterparts from Australia and New Zealand indicates new directions in security cooperation in the Indo-Pacific. Koizumi's talks in Delhi should help end the current slow and incremental approach to defence cooperation and outline more ambitious goals for the security partnership.

Driving Japan's new defence policies is the rise of China as a great military power and Beijing's growing political will to translate that power into concrete outcomes. This is a challenge Delhi and Tokyo share as they confront assertive Chinese military policies — on Japan's maritime frontier with China and India's contested land border across the Himalayas. The geography is different, but the PLA's methods are the same. Persistent probing and the slow but definitive alteration of the territorial status quo.

For both Tokyo and Delhi, the challenge from China is magnified by the volatility of American policies. Neither seeks an Asia without America. Japan remains deeply in-

vested in its alliance with Washington, while India sees a continuing American military presence as essential to a stable Asian balance. But Donald Trump's second presidency has reinforced the questions about the predictability of American policy and the nature of its regional commitments.

Part of the answer for Delhi and Tokyo lies in strengthening their own national capabilities and deepening partnerships with each other and other Asian powers. Koizumi's itinerary captures the possibilities. Japan's defence partnership with Australia has advanced rapidly. Canberra and Tokyo have expanded military exercises, reciprocal access, logistics and defence industrial cooperation. Australia's decision to acquire Japan-designed *Mogami*-class frigates marks an important breakthrough for a country that, until recently, imposed extraordinary restrictions on exporting weapons.

India-Japan defence cooperation has also expanded, but remains well behind the political rhetoric about their "Special Strategic and Global Partnership". Koizumi's visit should therefore be an occasion not merely to review bilateral exercises and exchanges, but to ask how Delhi and Tokyo can give their defence partnership much greater operational and technological weight.

The opportunity arises from the extraordinary changes underway in Japan itself. For much of the post-war era, Japanese strategy rested on a simple bargain. Tokyo concentrated on economic reconstruction while relying on the United States for security. Defence expenditure remained around 1 per cent of GDP, arms exports were tightly restricted, and the Self-Defence Forces operated within narrow political constraints. Those conditions began to change as the China

challenge unfolded. In 2010, China overtook Japan as the world's second-largest economy. Its growing economic resources supported a massive expansion of military capabilities, the consequences of which for Japan soon became evident.

After returning as prime minister in 2012, Shinzo Abe accelerated the effort to adapt Japanese security policy to the new circumstances. As the scale of the China challenge deepened and concerns about American reliability grew, Japan outlined a sweeping set of defence reforms in 2022. One element was a rapid increase in defence expenditure. Tokyo set itself the goal of raising defence-related spending to around 2 per cent of GDP by 2027, but brought forward that target through additional spending last year.

More important has been the change in doctrine. Japan is acquiring long-range "counterstrike" capabilities, including American Tomahawk missiles, while developing longer-range indigenous weapons. It is strengthening air and missile defence, cyber and space capabilities, unmanned systems and its capacity to operate farther from the Japanese islands. A parallel revolution is unfolding in defence production. Tokyo is revitalising its defence industrial base, easing restrictions on arms exports and breaking down the old barriers between civilian technology and national security. Japan has also begun providing military equipment to friendly countries through its new Official Security Assistance programme.

Taken together, these changes represent something much larger than a Japanese "rearmament". Tokyo is finally turning to military power, defence technology, arms exports and security assistance as normal instruments of statecraft. Tokyo is also reaching out to South

Korea and other regional neighbours, deepening defence ties with Australia and New Zealand, and strengthening security engagement with Europe. Upgrading defence ties with India is a natural part of this wider strategy. Delhi and Tokyo already have much of the institutional architecture they need: A 2+2 dialogue, a logistics agreement and regular exercises across the three services. Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi's visit to Delhi last month called for more sophisticated exercises, stronger maritime domain awareness and deeper defence industrial cooperation. It also announced the first bilateral defence co-development project, involving the UNICORN naval communications antenna.

But here is the reality check. Defence industrial cooperation has been painfully slow. Delhi and Tokyo need much greater ambition in joint research, development and co-production of weapons and military technologies. Their armed forces must also move beyond exercising together towards greater operational coordination in anti-submarine warfare, maritime surveillance, air defence and logistics. The unfolding transformation of the Asian security environment demands that Delhi and Tokyo do much more together in defence. Japan is demonstrating greater purpose and urgency as it responds to the changing balance of power in Asia. Unlike China, India has long welcomed the prospect of a stronger Japan. It is now time for Delhi to match Tokyo's commitment and enthusiasm in building a consequential Asian defence partnership.

The writer is a contributing editor on international affairs for The Indian Express. He is also a distinguished professor at the Motwani-Jadava Institute of American Studies, Jindal Global University and the Korea Foundation Chair at the Council on Strategic and Defence Research, Delhi

Cambridge professor's death is a life lesson



MADHAVI RAVIKUMAR

PROFESSOR JASON ARDAY was found dead at his home in Battersea on August 14. He was 41 years old. Authorities regard the death as unexpected but not suspicious. Hours earlier, he had told a colleague he 'couldn't' go. His family speaks of a campaign of sustained abuse and misinformation that finally became unbearable. The decisive force that pushed him to the edge was the scale and nature of the media scrutiny, mainstream newspapers and social-media platforms acting in relentless combination, that turned contested questions about an academic career into a public spectacle of personal destruction.

An independent count by NewsCord recorded roughly 249 articles about Arday across British national outlets in 22 days. Nearly 190 appeared after he had already resigned on August 5, indicating that the allegations, speculation and commentary had taken a profound toll. The coverage moved into repeated dissection of childhood claims, private life, every past achievement and every personal vulnerability. Once the story gained momentum, social media took over. Clips, memes, comment threads and derivative posts circulated without pause, stripping context and amplifying humiliation.

There were legitimate questions that required answers. Allegations of substantial textual overlaps in Arday's 2015 PhD thesis, problems in later papers, and inconsistencies in elements of his public biography were serious. Universities and the public have a proper interest in the reliability of credentials and published work at elite institutions. What does not follow is the conversion of those questions into a high-volume, highly personalised campaign that continued long after resignation and systematically targeted the person rather than the scholarly record.

This pattern is familiar across contexts. In Britain, Julia Meadows, an elementary-school teacher, took her own life in 2013 following intense tabloid coverage of her gender change. The coroner told the media, "Shame on all of you," citing ridicule and character assassination. Caroline Flock, the television presenter, died by suicide in 2020 amid sustained tabloid and online hostility.

India offers an even more striking parallel. After Bollywood actor Sushant Singh

Rajput died by suicide in June 2020, Indian television news channels and social media launched an extraordinary, months-long campaign to cover every detail of the actor's death and mental health to conspiracy theories and a full-blown media trial of his girlfriend Rhea Chakraborty. She was publicly vilified as a manipulator, gold-digger and worse, often with little evidence. The CBI eventually closed the case, confirming suicide and exonerating her.

Arday's autism and history of developmental delay made him particularly vulnerable. Those who knew him in his final days described a vulnerable man whose mental health deteriorated visibly under the bombardment. Social media removed any residual distance. Platforms that present themselves as democratising information instead accelerated the conversion of a complex story into simplified, shareable judgment.

The media's conventional defence is familiar. Public interest, the right to scrutinise authority, the duty to report. All are real. However, public interest is not identical with the right to sustain a personalised campaign of attrition long after the professional consequences. When the coverage reaches hundreds of articles in three weeks, and when social media turns every new detail into further ridicule, the impact transforms from inquiry to spectacle.

Arday's death does not settle the scholarly disputes surrounding his work. Those remain matters for careful, evidence-based examination by the relevant institutions. It does, however, expose the human cost of a media culture that confuses volume with virtue and spectacle with scrutiny.

The right to investigate does not include the right to destroy. A society that cannot distinguish between rigorous accountability and destructive hounding has lost its sense of balance. If there is any constructive response to this tragedy, it begins with the recognition that the media gaze can itself become lethal.

The least that can be asked of those who report and those who amplify is that they remember there is a human being at the centre of every story.

The writer teaches at the Department of Communication, University of Hyderabad



SHUVADITYA BOSE

At Darwin, Bangladesh upends the cricketing order

BALL was yet to be bowled in Darwin, when Bangladesh captain Najmul Hossain Shanto was asked at a press conference: "Will this Test last five days, or in three?" "We will try to take it to the fifth day," he replied. Bangladesh didn't require a fifth day — only four proved enough to secure a historic, narrative-defying nine-wicket triumph over Australia. India required 12 attempts. Pakistan seven. Sri Lanka have never done it. Bangladesh has a Test win on Australian soil at just the third time of asking — and yet, they have had to wait 26 years for it.

The deepest mark of hierarchy, argue psychologists, is not that the powerful believe they deserve more, but that the weak believe they deserve less. Before departing for the Test series, Shanto basked in pride for something that had nothing to do with Bangladesh cricket. He had just been briefed on Australia's squad. Cummins. Starc. Smith. Hazlewood. Stars, superstars, cricketing demigods. When he had taken it all in, Shanto, still absorbing the weight of the names before him, claimed: "Australia announcing a full-strength squad is an achievement for us." One would not have wanted to spoil Shanto's mood by pointing out the obvious: Australia's decision to field a full-strength side had more to do with WTC points on offer than with their assessment of Bangladesh. Historically, the latter has been low.

Bangladesh had been invited to Test cricket by Australia only once in 26 years. In 2003. And even then, they were looked at with disdain. Former Australia cricketer David Hoopes, for instance, had said, "The reality is that Bangladesh doesn't deserve to be in Test cricket." A series was scheduled in 2018, but Australia deemed it pointless. The official reason was commercial viability. The unofficial assumption was simpler: Who would be interested in watching? Crestfallen, then BCB CEO had said: "Not every series we conduct is profitable. If we can conduct them, I believe Australia can do too." Perhaps they could. Certainly they didn't. Bangladesh, like so many of cricket's smaller nations, was treated for long as expendable. Until they arrived in Darwin.

Starc. Hazlewood and Cummins may have more than 1,000 Test wickets between them, but in Darwin, it was Hasan Mahmud who burned brightest. Nine wickets. Tanzid Hasan Tamim scored 101. Hasan is 26. Tanzid is 25. Shakib Al Hasan, the world's No.1 Test all-rounder across multiple spells over the past decade, never played a Test in Australia. Hasan and Tanzid can consider themselves fortunate. But fortune, for them, should not be the end of the story. Bangladesh's purpose on this tour was never simply to win a trophy. It was to earn respect. And, with it, if Australia were kind enough, invitations. After the embarrassment in Darwin, though, will Australia make the same mistake again? When victory was sealed, the Bangladeshi players gathered and sang 'Amra korbo joy' — an Bengali adaptation of 'We Shall Overcome'. A little antiquated, perhaps. Had they learned condescension from their opponents, they would have chosen something cooler. Like Kendrick Lamar. Specifically, "Sit down, Be humble."

The writer is deputy copy editor, The Indian Express. shuvaditya.bose@indianexpress.com

40 YEARS AGO

AUGUST 19, 1986



Agitation by Pak opposition

OPPOSITION PARTIES in Pakistan launched a countrywide indefinite agitation against the government crackdown on them and to overthrow President Zia-ul-Haq. Government and opposition supporters fought hand-to-hand in the streets and the police fired shotguns at rioters as political protests swept southern Pakistan, leaving at least eight people, including four policemen, dead.

Ban on MNF lifted

THE 19-YEAR-old ban on the Mizo National Front has been lifted. The Union government,

after being satisfied that the MNF had surrendered arms and observed all the terms of the accord, lifted the ban imposed earlier under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act. This will enable the MNF and its allied organisations to function as lawful political organisations. The MNF was banned first in 1967 after it had declared independent Mizoram on March 1, 1966.

Moscow extends N-test ban

THE SOVIET leader, Mikhail Gorbachev, announced that Moscow was extending its unilateral nuclear test ban until January 1, 1987. Gorbachev renewed his call to the

United States to follow Moscow's example and declare a moratorium on nuclear testing. Gorbachev invited US President Ronald Reagan to sign a treaty banning all nuclear testing this year. "The logic in this is simple: if there are no tests, the nuclear weapons which both sides have stockpiled in abundance will not be upgraded," he said.

Rs 30 crore flood relief for Andhra

THE PRIME Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, announced a ways and means advance of Rs 30 crore and Rs 30 lakh from the PM Relief Fund for relief and rehabilitation of the flood-affected people of Andhra Pradesh.

What is an IIT for, where is it going? At 75, here are ten steps to the future



SUMAN CHAKRABORTY

SEVENTY-FIVE years ago, on August 18, 1951, India performed an extraordinary act of national imagination: It transformed a site of incarceration into a crucible of knowledge. Jhili — the hallowed ground that had borne witness to the freedom struggle — became home to IIT Kharagpur. A newly independent nation made a powerful declaration: Technology would not merely serve industry; it would serve nation-building. As we look towards the next quarter-century, the defining measure of excellence must change: Not simply how high an IIT rises, but how much of Bharat rises with it.

Top of the pyramid to strength of the pyramid

The IITs sit at the apex of India's engineering-education pyramid, but an apex cannot claim excellence if the pyramid beneath it remains undeserved. By 2047, every IIT should function simultaneously as a university and a national capability platform. IIT faculty must mentor networks of teachers, while IIT laboratories should offer structured access pathways to students and researchers across institutional tiers.

From teaching institutions to knowledge engines

Knowledge is increasingly created at the intersections — engineering and medicine, AI and agriculture, manufacturing and sustainability. Departments must remain pillars of deep domain expertise, but the walls between them must become porous. At IIT Kharagpur, the emerging ecosystem spanning medical technology and AI-enabled diagnostics, agriculture, advanced manufacturing, future energy, space technologies, entrepreneurship, research park-linked living laboratories must converge into one institutional innovation pipeline.

JEE may be a door; it's not a verdict

Alongside JEE, GATE, JAM and other established routes, channels recognising ex-



ILLUSTRATION: C R SAKUMAR

ceptional achievement through olympiads, innovation and grand-challenge competitions, sports excellence and other demonstrable capabilities deserve more exploration. Such pathways must be protected from capture by coaching and formulaic preparation. More fundamentally, a student who does not enter an IIT should not be denied access to IIT. IIT Kharagpur's recently introduced Outreach Course Network can become a prototype of this new architecture.

The degree must change

In the 20th century, a degree certified with a graduate knew; by 2047, that proposition will be inadequate. AI will perform many routine tasks. Flexible architectures should allow students to traverse disciplinary boundaries without turning interdisciplinarity into an unstructured buffet. The IIT of 2047 must embrace an apparent paradox — that the more interdisciplinary the world becomes, the stronger the foundational disciplines must be.

Male students AI-powerful

Trying to make education "AI-proof" by shielding traditional assignments and examinations from AI would be much like trying to protect engineering drawing from CAD. The appropriate response is not avoidance but intellectual elevation. Every IIT student should acquire three fundamental capabilities: Understanding how AI works, knowing how to work intelligently with AI, and recognising when not to trust AI. Assessment must migrate from reproducing known solutions towards formulating un-

known problems, critiquing machine-generated outputs and creating something that did not previously exist.

IIT must enter the school before the student enters IIT

India's educational ecosystem cannot be repaired at age 18. The intervention must begin much earlier in schools — not by turning children prematurely into JEE aspirants, but by restoring curiosity, experimentation and the joy of asking questions. Every IIT must engage with a network of schools, as a permanent educational laboratory where faculty and students work alongside school teachers to develop inexpensive hands-on experiments, multidisciplinary science resources, AI-enabled learning tools and contextual approaches. This is the philosophy of IIT Kharagpur's new School-Connect programme.

Turn the campus into India's technology testbed

A campus inhabited by tens of thousands is a miniature city in which almost every major technological challenge of contemporary India is present at a manageable yet meaningful scale. The IIT campus should become a living testbed for India@2047, where emerging technologies are subjected to the realities of everyday use. The same philosophy must extend beyond the campus, with surrounding rural communities, municipalities, hospitals, MSMEs, schools and grassroots enterprises.

Entrepreneurship, an academic outcome

For decades, an implicit hier-

archy placed scholarship at the centre, industry engagement one step away, and entrepreneurship beyond the university's boundaries. That is now obsolete. A student or faculty member who builds a responsible enterprise around a technological idea does not step away from scholarship but can extend its reach. Every significant IIT discovery should have a visible pathway towards translation, even though only a fraction will ultimately become commercially successful.

From brain drain to brain circulation

The old question was whether India could prevent its best students from leaving; the more consequential question for 2047 is whether Indian institutions can become sufficiently magnetic for the world's best minds, ideas and opportunities. The vocabulary of "brain drain" itself needs to evolve, because in an interconnected knowledge economy, mobility need not signify loss if institutions are capable of converting movement into enduring intellectual connectivity.

IIT @2047: Change the definition of success

The IIT of 2047 must be a university without intellectual walls, a national research engine, an innovation foundry, an entrepreneurship platform, a teacher multiplier, a technological living laboratory, a global knowledge node and a public institution accountable to society. The deeper questions must be more demanding: How many teachers became better because an IIT existed? How many institutions became stronger because an IIT shared its capabilities? How many discoveries survived the test of the real world? How many communities gained better healthcare, energy, education and livelihoods? How many young people who never entered an IIT found knowledge, mentorship, infrastructure or opportunity because an IIT chose to reach them?

That must be the measure of our next 25 years: Not merely whether IIT Kharagpur becomes one of the world's great universities, but whether Bharat becomes more innovative and more confident because IIT Kharagpur chose to think beyond itself.

The writer is director, IIT Kharagpur, and Institute Chair Professor and J. C. Bose National Fellow

As Tatas choose new leader, remember: Noise is not the story



R GOPALAKRISHNAN AND ISHAAT HUSSAIN

MEDIA REPORTAGE during the last fortnight has been prolific regarding Tata — the chairman of Tata Sons not offering himself for a third term in February 2027, succession speculations, relationships among leaders, leaders' performance appraisal, and much more. Are recent Tata developments signs of flaws in governance and transparency? Or, do they reflect the reality that views can differ among individuals? Society teaches us that differences are normal, but what is important is resolving them so there are no permanent winners or losers. The babble has been so intense that we were reminded of the adage, "Those who know do not speak and those who speak do not know." The reportage also revived our memories of the Kishore Kumar song from Amar Prem: "Kuch to log kahenge, logon ka kaam hai kehna, chhod bekar ki baton mein beet na jaye raat."

That the heads of Sons and Trusts had professional differences is not a secret. Whether the differences were small or large, legitimate or misplaced, ego-driven or not, are all matters that only the concerned pair will know. Such a situation can occur between two perfectly well-intentioned and honourable people, and that seems to be so in this Tata case.

Common sense and experience tell us that conflicts and differences can be salvaged only through conversation, convergence, compromise, and commitment. Importantly, if salvaging is not possible through reconciliation and readjustment, then a dignified and mutually separable exit is a valid course. Top-level differences should not affect the institution negatively.

It is likely that recent actions have been motivated by precisely this consideration.

History offers many cases where what appeared to be a difference of opinion was not addressed and ended up contributing to undesirable conflicts. Julius Caesar and Pompey the Great were close political allies in Rome — in fact, Pompey was Caesar's son-in-law — until personal distrust, rivalry, and competition gradually poisoned the relationship. Caesar's successful conquest of Gaul made him extremely powerful, and Pompey became concerned that Caesar would dominate Rome. Their growing conflict could not be resolved through negotiation or compromise. Finally, in 49 BCE, Caesar initiated the civil war with Pompey.

Around the time of World War I, Kaiser Wilhelm II ruled in Germany, King George V in Britain, and Tsar Nicholas II in Russia, all cousins. Wilhelm's impulsive behaviour and insecurity damaged these personal ties. Of course, the war was not caused by family relationships, but mistrust among family members lessened the opportunities for compromise.

There are three common patterns suggested by history. First, honour and prestige become key. Second, leaders personify ideological disputes. Third, miscommunication creates exaggerated perceptions of insults.

In the Tata case, the leaders were unable to resolve their issues, so the differences were extinguished through graceful adjustments. Above all, the leaders have protected their institutions.

However, such episodes attract everyone to analyse and comment. It is in this context that Padma Shri poet Bashir Badr wrote, "Parakhna mat, parakhne se koi apna nahin rehta, Kisi bhi aane mein der tak chehra nahin rehta (If you analyse too much then you will lose relationships, just as a mirror does not hold a reflection for long)."

Conspiracy theories circulate, where none or some may be true. In this case, some view it as a Trusts versus Sons dispute, some as a Parsi versus non-Parsi dispute, some as a promoter versus professional dispute, some as a capital allocation discipline issue. It is fruitless to criticise, analyse and paralyse, based on assumptions.

Two facts are clear. First, as per Tata retirement policies, the chairman of Tata Sons would anyway have given up executive positions from June 2028 upon turning 65. Therefore, the board must have had some succession plan. Second, renewing the chairman's contract for a third term was a unanimous decision of the Trusts members in September 2025, 17 months before the ongoing contract would come up for renewal. It is this unanimous decision that led to the likely change in the tenure and dates of the chairman's succession. The matter appeared on the Tata Sons board agenda at the instance of the Trusts in February. It appears that one director expressed reservations regarding certain economic and business issues. Bearing in mind the interests of the employees, investments and business of Tata Sons, the chairman has gracefully announced his decision not to seek re-election. The die has been cast, and attention must change to effective succession.

Tata is a rare national jewel. It is a business group that most Indians respect and love. Let us, therefore, wish Tata all the best in finding a successor and returning the enterprise to its mission of creating employment, family advancement, and national prosperity.

The writers are both retired directors of Tata Sons with a combined experience of working for Tatas of over half a century

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Freedom and liberty

VANDITA MISHRA's column expresses a shared truth: National freedom and individual liberty are not always the same thing ('August 15 after Jantar Mantar: The many spaces of freedom and unfreedom', *IE*, August 18). While official rhetoric paints a grand picture of progress, student protests at Jantar Mantar reveal a parallel reality — one defined by institutional control, political resistance and shrinking spaces for critical debate. Gen Z activism is no longer about politics; it is an issue-driven, relentless push for basic civil rights and accountability.

Fathimath Safa, Kannur

The idea of India

YOGENDRA YADAV's piece on Gulzar's call for a new *gauri tarana* ('What will we sing of now when we sing of patriotism', *IE*, August 18) ends with a line that stuck with me. We may have lost not just our old patriotic songs, but "the imagined community that we call a nation". Before we ask for a song every Indian can hum, we should ask a harder question: Do all Indians currently feel invited into the idea of India? Old patriotic songs worked because nation-building felt like a shared project, a feeling, not a slogan. That feeling is missing today. Many, from communities in Manipal to Dalits, Adivasis and queer citizens, still don't see themselves in the nation we keep singing about.

Rishabh Kumar, Varanasi

Rupee relief

THE RBI's FCNR(B) swap window offered the rupee temporary relief by mobilising foreign currency deposits, but at the cost of future vulnerabilities ("The rupee's borrowed breathing space", *IE*, August 18). While the move signals confidence, it is essentially borrowed stability, leaving banks exposed to asset-liability mismatches. This reflects the tension between immediate liquidity support and long-term resilience. Without reforms, the currency remains unhedged against external shocks.

Abhinav Shah, Lucknow



SUMIT SAMOS

EVERY YEAR around this time, India argues with itself. One side asks: Are we truly free? The other celebrates Independence Day as a moment of national glory and pride. Few images capture this contradiction better than a poor child in tattered clothes selling Tricolour flags at a traffic signal, alongside the PM's speech from the Red Fort and the flood of flags, patriotic songs, Army pride, cultural events and TV broadcasts.

Then come the statistics. One side cites poverty, inequality and exclusion; the other points to rising incomes, welfare schemes, education and social mobility. This binary can be captured quite well in the tussle between social mobility discourse that has been in vogue in academia and what Sherry Ortner calls "dark anthropology", focused on domination, exclusion and violence. It is an important lens, but leaves little room for understanding how marginalised groups have also created concrete freedoms for themselves, through both state institutions and their own struggles.

My fieldwork in remote southern Odisha last year brought this contradiction home. Many of my interlocutors were Dalits and Adivasis. When I asked what life was like in the 1970s and 1980s, some described hunger that is difficult to imagine today. Today, they no longer worry about starvation in the same way because they receive rations regularly. For someone who

The deeper questions must be more demanding: How many teachers became better because an IIT existed? How many discoveries survived the test of the real world?

India between the Tricolour and traffic light

has known hunger, that is a concrete freedom. Yet these communities were far from passive beneficiaries of the state. They opposed moneylenders, forest officials, state-supported displacement projects and feudal practices associated with hereditary Brahmin officials. The state, in other words, could be both a source of opportunity and an instrument of dispossession. This contradiction appears across India, and it will be useful to trace it through Dalit realities.

Sandhya Puchs, in her study of atrocity cases in Rajasthan, shows how Dalit victims can be denied justice through legal misdirection. Yet Geert De Neve has documented how Dalits in western Tamil Nadu have used the SC/ST Prevention of Atrocities Act to challenge dominant-caste power. The law can be an instrument of exclusion in one situation and a weapon to challenge caste power in another. Migration tells a similar story. Dalit labourers from Bihar working at construction sites in Tamil Nadu live with bare-minimum savings and insecure employment. Yet some working in Kerala earn better wages and aspire to build concrete houses and basic amenities for their families.

Politics reveals the same complexity. During the 2024 general election, Hindutva politics sought to mobilise voters in UP around the Ram Mandir inauguration and religious identity. Yet a section of Dalit voters moved away from the

The state could be both a source of opportunity and an instrument of dispossession. This contradiction appears across India, and it will be useful to trace it through Dalit realities

BJP because they feared it could undermine the Constitution and reservation, a reminder that marginalised citizens are not merely passive victims of political manipulation.

Ambedkar warned that universal suffrage and regular elections alone could not guarantee democracy in a society marked by deep historical inequalities. A governing class, he argued, could use power to bypass democratic means. Dalit communities have challenged this bypassing, demanding that state institutions act as neutral administrators. Through protests and collective action, they have pushed Indian social life towards greater equality and dignity. At the same time, some sections have been drawn into dominant ideologies like Hindutva.

For a Dalit family, freedom may mean regular food, a hostel for a child, access to education, the ability to migrate, a concrete house, entry into a public space, or protection under the law. It may also coexist with exploitation, discrimination, insecurity and state neglect. August 15 need not force us to choose between these stories. Freedom was not simply delivered to Indians in 1947. For millions, it has been — and continues to be — made, negotiated and fought for in the ordinary spaces of everyday life. That is perhaps the more complicated story of independent India. But it may also be the more truthful one.

The writer is a rapper and a PhD student at University of Pennsylvania



NIMISHA JHA

EVERY AI system begins with data, and every dataset begins with people. When people are absent from that data, AI inherits those gaps. The AI pipeline is not merely a technological conduct of code, silicon and compute power; it is fundamentally a human pipeline. It begins before the first line of code is written and shapes decisions affecting millions. India ranks among the world's leading AI-ready nations, powered by Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) and a thriving innovation ecosystem. Yet beneath this progress lies a structural contradiction. While India produces one of the world's largest pools of women STEM graduates,

women steadily disappear as the AI pipeline advances. At every stage, the pipeline leaks talent, lived experience, and innovation. The challenge is evident in the numbers: In STEM foundation, women account for 43 per cent of India's STEM graduates; in the tech workforce, representation falls to 26 per cent; in advanced AI roles, only 12 per cent of professionals are women; In senior AI leadership, women hold only 10 per cent of senior AI leadership positions.

The challenge extends beyond employment. Only 57 per cent of women have independent internet access, compared with 72 per cent of men. The root causes of this leakage are deeply social. These disparities arise from unequal nutrition, education, caregiving responsibilities, workplace discrimination, and language barriers. AI learns from society; if society is unequal, AI inevitably re-

flects those inequalities. Aasha, a member of a self-help group in rural Bihar, applies for a micro-loan. If AI credit models rely mainly on historical male financial patterns, they may underestimate her creditworthiness. In Gujarat, Meera, a community health worker, depends on AI-enabled maternal health tools. If the training data fails to reflect local nutrition and health conditions, inaccurate recommendations may affect maternal care.

India has already shown how technology can advance public welfare at scale. The India AI Mission now offers an opportunity to ensure AI follows the same inclusive path

The barriers emerge early. Kavya cannot pursue robotics because her school lacks advanced infrastructure. Pooja struggles with AI-enabled financial literacy, despite becoming an AI engineer, often finds herself the only woman in the room, with limited influence in product design. AI automates existing inequalities when trained on incomplete or biased data.

Yet AI can also expand opportunity. Across rural India, women's self-help groups have built strong financial ecosystems through collective savings and entrepreneurship. When women occupy positions of influence, the technology shifts. India's progress in AI-enabled inclusion reflects a deeper national principle. When India adopted its Constitution in 1950, it granted women and men universal adult franchise simultaneously. This commitment to inclusion con-

tinues today through DPI and provides a strong foundation for building inclusive AI much before the West reaches democracies.

India has already shown how technology can advance public welfare at scale. The India AI Mission now offers an opportunity to ensure AI follows the same inclusive path. True AI leadership cannot be measured only by models, investments, or patents. It must also be measured by whether AI reflects India's diversity of languages, cultures, socioeconomic realities, and lived experiences. Achieving this requires more than diverse datasets. Women and marginalised communities must participate as researchers, engineers, entrepreneurs, and policymakers.

The writer is a civil servant posted in the Ministry of Women and Child Development, Government of India. Views are personal

STATE OPPOSES AWARD OF CONCURRENT SENTENCES

10 years in jail inadequate, consider life term for Tejpal: Goa govt to SC

Sentence 'grossly disproportionate to nature, gravity of offences': State

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, August 18

THE GOA government moved the Supreme Court Tuesday, seeking enhancement of the 10-year rigorous imprisonment sentence awarded to Tarun Tejpal, former editor-in-chief of Tehelka magazine, convicted of the 2013 rape of a woman journalist.

The state called the sentence "manifestly inadequate" and "grossly disproportionate to the nature and gravity of the offences committed".

In its appeal filed before the top court, the state said the High Court had imposed only the minimum sentence of 10 years' rigorous imprisonment for each of the two aggravated rape convictions, with the sentences to run concurrently.



Tarun Tejpal, former editor-in-chief of Tehelka magazine

It urged the Supreme Court to enhance this to imprisonment for life, or such sentence as the court may deem fit with the same not running concurrently.

"He misused his position of authority and trust to commit the offences punishable under Sections 376 (2) (f), 376 (2) (k), 354, 354A, 354B, 341 and 342 of the IPC, while the victim was performing her duties" at an event organised by Tejpal, the state said.

It pointed out that the High Court had "inter alia, relied

upon the fact that 13 years had elapsed since the commission of the offences and that both the victim and the respondent had moved on with their lives, while imposing the minimum sentence and directing the sentences to run concurrently". It said "such reasoning is untenable" and "the passage of time cannot operate to the benefit of the offender or become a premium for the delay in the administration of justice, particularly at the cost of the victim".

The plea said the sentence "is further disproportionate in view of" the High Court's "own finding that the victim was subjected to nearly 1,000 pages of invasive cross-examination, during which the defence sought to harass and humiliate her and portray her as a woman of loose morals".

"These circumstances underscore the gravity of the offence and the trauma suffered by the victim, and warranted a sentence commensurate with the nature and seriousness of the crimes committed," it said.

The state said while it is not seeking to reopen or challenge

the conviction, the sentence "does not adequately reflect the gravity of the offences or the aggravating circumstances found proved by the High Court".

It pointed out that the High Court itself had found that Tejpal occupied a position of "dominance, control, trust and authority" over the victim.

"The delay taken for the victim to get justice cannot become a mitigating circumstance in favour of an offender so as to dilute the sentence for a grave sexual offence, particularly where the delay has not been shown to be attributable to the victim," it said.

The fact that Tejpal has a wife and two adult daughters or that he has not been accused of committing any other offence after the incident "cannot outweigh the gravity of the offences for which he now stands convicted," the state said.

The direction that the sentences should run concurrently "further substantially reduces the effective punishment for two distinct aggravated sexual assaults committed on two successive days. Each incident constituted separate criminality and deserves to be reflected in the sentence," the state said.

Meet testing firm under fire: Locked Lucknow office, 'nepotism' in UP

Shyamal Yadav
Manish Sahu
New Delhi, Lucknow, Aug 18

TSR DATA Processing Private Limited (TDPL), the testing firm at the heart of the Jharkhand government's decision to lock down the state selection commission's Combined Graduate Level exams, has a dubious record of alleged irregularities and "nepotism" that trails all the way to Lucknow in neighbouring UP.

In 2021-22, TDPL was one of three firms that conducted exams for 186 vacancies in administrative positions at secretariats of the UP Legislative Assembly and Council. In November 2024, an investigation by The Indian Express found that a fifth of these jobs went to relatives of TDPL directors Ram Beer Singh and Satya Pal Singh.

Last month, Ram Beer and key TDPL employees were arrested by Jharkhand Police's CID probing alleged irregularities in exams for government recruitment. The whereabouts of Satya Pal are not known, sources said. TDPL did not respond to an emailed request for comment on Tuesday.

In the UP case, the Lucknow Bench of the Allahabad High



The Indian Express report dated November 15, 2024.

Court had described the irregularities linked to TDPL as "shocking", raising questions of "integrity" and "nepotism", and called for a CBI probe.

The High Court also highlighted opacity in the conduct of the exams: the results were never made public, the list of selected candidates was not disclosed, and the total number of applicants remains unknown. The CBI probe was later quashed by the Supreme Court on a plea by the UP Legislative Council but the matter is still pending before the High Court.

According to court records, the UP Assembly recruitment was contracted to Broadcasting Engineering and Consultancy Services (BECIL), a Central Public Sector Enterprise under the Union Ministry of Information

and Broadcasting. BECIL hired TDPL to conduct the recruitment.

Sources in the UP administration said the company has not been awarded any government contract for conducting exams since the High Court took up the Assembly recruitment case.

On Tuesday, The Indian Express visited the "main office" of TDPL as listed in Registrar of Companies (RoC) records — a two-room set-up on the second floor of Adarsh Complex at Engineering College Chauraha in Lucknow. It found the office sealed.

When contacted, Station House Officer of the local Madiaon police station, Shivanand, said five police personnel from Jharkhand had visited Lucknow three days ago and sought assistance to conduct a search at the TDPL office.

"They arrived with a search warrant, and the Lucknow Police assisted them in the operation. The Jharkhand Police searched the premises and sealed the office. They also seized several documents. No office staff was present when the search was conducted," Shivanand said.

RoC records show that TDPL was incorporated in July 2010 by Ram Beer and Satya Pal, along with Mohammed Tariq, who exited the firm in 2013.

According to the company's latest declaration on August 29, 2025, for the financial year ending March 31, 2025, Ram Beer Singh and Satya Pal are the only two promoters. Each owns a 50 per cent stake, comprising 5,000 equity shares. The company has shown 965 employees and declared that all of them are male.

In 2024-25, RoC records show, TDPL's total "revenue from operations" stood at Rs 19.62 crore, against Rs 5.23 crore in 2023-24. Its total profit after tax in 2024-25 was Rs 48.54 lakh. The company's authorised capital was Rs 16 lakh, and as per RoC records, its last board meeting was held on February 15, 2025. Ram Beer and Satya Pal each drew a salary of Rs 18.60 lakh in 2024-25.

Ram Beer and Satya Pal are also directors in four other firms: Smiling Deeps Pvt Ltd, L&M Food and Beverages Pvt Ltd, KSR Infotech Pvt Ltd and Dreamlog Infotech Ltd.

UP Police records, meanwhile, show that Ram Beer and Satya Pal are on bail in separate recruitment case, based on a complaint registered in March 2021 by a Special Investigation Team probing the 2019 recruitment of Village Development Officers. Both were arrested on April 7, 2021, records show, with large quantities of cash allegedly recovered from them.

बिहार सरकार
लोक स्वास्थ्य अभियंत्रण विभाग
सूचना

स्वा. शिव बिहारी कुमार, सेवानिवृत्त कार्यपालक अभियंता (असैनिक), मुहल्ला-मोगलपुर, जिला दोली, कुमार प्रिंटेड प्रेस के पास, रानीपुर, मिर्जा चक, डाकघर-चोक पटना सिटी, बथना-खालेकला, अजित सिटी, जिला-पटना, पिन-800008 दिनांक-31.01.2017 को कार्ययोजना अनुसार हुए तथा इनकी मृत्यु दिनांक-22.04.2017 को हो चुकी है।

2. बिमारीय प्रमाण-172, दिनांक-20.03.2017 द्वारा स्वा. कुमार को पेशा एवं उपचार की स्वीकृति प्रदान की गयी थी, जिसके अंतर्गत में महालेखाकार (जो एवं हो) का कार्ययोजना, बिहार, पटना के पीपीओओ 40-2017/11111093, दिनांक-11.04.2017 के द्वारा स्वा. कुमार के पेशा में पेशा एवं उपचार की स्वीकृति प्रदान हेतु प्राधिकार पत्र निर्गत किया गया था। बिभाग द्वारा उनके सेवा तमाम की स्वीकृति प्रदान किये जाने के पश्चात् महालेखाकार कार्ययोजना द्वारा स्वा. कुमार को पेशा एवं उपचार के भुगतान संबंधी प्राधिकार पत्र भी निर्गत किया जा चुका है, परंतु स्वा. कुमार के मृत्यु होने के कारण भुगतान प्राप्त नहीं कर सके।

3. स्वा. कुमार के मृत्यु उपरान्त उनके सेवा तमामों के भुगतान उनके पुत्र श्री अमित कुमार / श्री सुमित कुमार किये जाने के हेतु बिमारीय प्रमाण-559, दिनांक-18.08.2020 एवं कोतियार स्मार्त द्वारा स्वा. कुमार को पुत्रों की अमित कुमार / श्री सुमित कुमार से उत्तराधिकार प्रमाण पत्र को उपलब्ध कराने का अनुरोध किया गया था, जो अब तक अप्राप्त है।

4. अतः स्वा. शिव बिहारी कुमार, सेवानिवृत्त कार्यपालक अभियंता (असैनिक) के पुत्रों श्री अमित कुमार / श्री सुमित कुमार को निर्देशित किया जाता है कि 15 दिनों के अन्दर उत्तराधिकार प्रमाण पत्र बिभाग में उपलब्ध कराना सुनिश्चित किया जाए। उक्त वांछित कागजात बिभाग में उपलब्ध नहीं कराने की स्थिति में किसी भी विपरीत परिस्थिति के लिए बिभाग जिम्मेवार नहीं होगा।

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नरो की मार, सर्वोच्च न्यायालय मुंबई परिसर।
सरकार के अपर सचिव

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
चिंताई कार्य मण्डल, मथुरा

अवलोकन-ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या-05/अप्रै0/अप्रै0/2026-27, दिनांक 13.08.2026 मथुरागढ़ राज्यपाल, उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु अर्जनपत्र निविदा (https://etender.up.nic.in) सिंचाई एवं जल संसाधन विभाग, उत्तर प्रदेश में चर्चित श्रेणी में पंजीकृत टेकनिकल बिद कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, सिंचाई कार्य मण्डल, मथुरा के कार्यालय में मूख्य अभियन्ता (पीएम) सिंचाई एवं जल संसाधन विभाग, 2030 मेटर हाइट गलित सफाई के सदस्यी द्वारा दिनांक 02.09.2026 को 15-30 बजे खोली जायेगी। पी-अवलोकन/टेकनिकल बिद में अवलोकन प्राप्त होने केकेवर को ही फाइनेलियल बिद खोली जायेगी। कार्यालय बंद होने अथवा अवकाश होने की दशा में बिद निविदा अर्जन केकार्यक्रम में उसी समय खोली जायेगी। निविदा दिनांक 27.08.2026 को 09.00 बजे से दिनांक 02.09.2026 को 15-00 बजे तक डाउनलोड/अवलोकन की जा सकती है। कार्य का विवरण निम्नान्व है:-

क्र. सं.	कार्य का नाम	कार्य का अनुमानित राशि (लक्ष/रुपये)	प्रकार (लक्ष/रुपये)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	सम्बन्धित कार्यालय का नाम	निविदा प्रारंभ का समय/दिनांक/स्थान	परीक्षण के लिए
1	मैट पीपर के बिदो	219.00	4.38	06 माह	उपरी	मैट पीपर के बिदो	परीक्षण के लिए
2	113560 पत्र कास करंट का प्रसूतिगत कार्य।				मैट पीपर के बिदो	मैट पीपर के बिदो	परीक्षण के लिए

विस्तृत अर्जनपत्र ई-निविदा सूचना का विवरण एवं निम्न जर्न उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की वेबसाइट (https://upgovt.up.nic/infotech) तथा सिंचाई विभाग की वेबसाइट (https://www.idup.gov.in) पर उपलब्ध है। उपरोक्त चर्चित सूचना तथा वेबसाइट पर प्रसूति सूचना में यदि कोई बिचना होती हो तो वेबसाइट पर प्रसूति सूचना हो मान्य होगी। बिद निविदा सूचना बिना किसी पूर्व सूचना के निरस्त किया जा सकता है। इसके लिए किसी प्रकार का कोई दया मान्य नहीं होगा।

U/PID-254800 Date 17/08/2026
www.upidatv.gov.in
(आलोक चतुर्वेदी)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

JAIPUR DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Indira Circle, Jawahar Lal Nehru Marg, Jaipur-302

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT) (E-Procurement)
NIB No.: 27/2026-27 (Job No.: 166/2026-27)

Online bids are invited from eligible and experienced contractors through the e-Procurement system for the following work:

S. No.	NIB No.	Name of Work	Tender Amount (In Lakh)	Sale/Download Date and End Date	Open Date	Job No.
1	27	Development and maintenance of existing old median plantation for 2 year, Induri Rly Phatak to Kharipta Phatak, Rly line to SKT College sector road, Maniara Phatak, Indira Circle, Dantali Siroli under rob median and Kharipta gulla to ring road greenbelt and RAS colony new median in H. zone-I	266.57	18.08.2026 27.08.2026	27.08.26	166/2026-27

U/NB No.: JDA2627WS0800306

The detailed NIT, tender document, eligibility conditions, terms and conditions and other relevant information are available on the following websites: Jaipur Development Authority (JDA), Jawahar Lal Nehru Marg, Jaipur - 302015. Website: (http://www.jda.rajasthan.gov.in) Rajasthan e-Procurement Portal- Website: (http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in) State Public Procurement Portal (SPPP), Rajasthan Website: (http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in). Bidders are required to submit their bids online through the prescribed e-Procurement portal within the stipulated period and in accordance with the terms and conditions of the tender document.

राजस्थान सरकार/26/10/23
Sr. Horticulturist

JAIPUR DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Indira Circle, Jawahar Lal Nehru Marg, Jaipur-302004

No. JDA/EE-C/21/80/2026-27/0-329 Date: 18.08.2026

NOTICE INVITING BID
NIB No.: JDA/EE-C/21/80/2026-27
UBN No.: JDA2627WSRC00305

Online Bids are invited up to 06:00 PM of 07.09.2026 for "Renewal/Construction of roads at various places in Zone-C 2 area JDA Jaipur (ARC)". The last date for Applying Bid and making online payment on JDA portal is up to 06:00 PM of 07.09.2026. The estimated cost of NIB is Rs. 407.81 Lacs. Details may be seen in the Bidding Document at our office or the State Public Procurement Portal website www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in, www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in and www.jda.rajasthan.gov.in/jda.

To participate in the bid, bidder must:

A. Participate in Tender & Deposit Payment on "Online Tender Participation Portal" of JDA at https://jda.rajasthan.gov.in/jda or by Single-Sign-On at http://service.jaipurja.org.

B. Submit e-Bid on "e-Procurement Portal" of GOR at www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in

Executive Engineer Zone-C 2

JAIPUR DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Indira Circle, Jawahar Lal Nehru Marg, Jaipur-302004

No. JDA/EE (Garden-II)/2026/0-185 Date: 18.08.2026

NOTICE INVITING BID
NIB No.: JDA/EE (Garden-II)/05/2026-27

Online Bids are invited up to 06:00 PM of 07.09.2026 for "Development of Swarn Jayanti Oxygen park near Vidhyadhar nagar Jaipur". The last date for Applying Bid and making online payment on JDA portal is up to 6.00 PM of 07.09.2026. The estimated cost of NIB is Rs. 486.46. Details may be seen in the Bidding Document at our office or the State Public Procurement Portal website www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in, www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in and www.jda.rajasthan.gov.in

UBN: JDA2627WS0800311

To participate in the bid, bidder must:

A. Participate in Tender & Deposit Payment of 'Online Tender Participation' Portal of JDA at www.jda.rajasthan.gov.in or by Single-Sign-On at http://service.jaipurja.org.

B. Submit e-Bid on e-Procurement portal of GOR at www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in

Executive Engineer (Garden-II)

RAJASTHAN MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD.
Old Working Women Hostel, Bahadur Nagar, Plot No. 10/10, Tonk Road, Jaipur, Pin-302004, Rajasthan
Website: www.rmsc.health.rajasthan.gov.in, Email: rmsc@rajasthan.gov.in, Phone No: 0141-2220000, 2220001

Ref No.: F02 (451)/RMSCL/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/18-13/2026-27/4827
Notice Inviting E-Bids

S. No.	Item Name/Description	Ref. No.	UBN	Estimated Value Rs. in Crore	Last Time & Last date for bid submission
1	Drugs	Ref.No.: F02 (451)/RMSCL/Procurement/Drug/NIB-13/2026-27/4813 Dated: 27.07.2026	MSC2627GLRC00048	34.47 Crore	01.09.2026 up to 06.00 pm

Raj.Samwad/C26/10/2402 Director (Procurement)

Rajasthan Urban Drinking Water Sewerage and Infrastructure Corporation Ltd.
Old Working Women Hostel, Bahadur Nagar, Plot No. 10/10, Tonk Road, Jaipur, Pin-302004, Rajasthan
Website: www.rudsi.health.rajasthan.gov.in, Email: rudsi@rajasthan.gov.in, Phone No: 0141-2220000, 2220001

Ref No.: F02 (451)/RMSCL/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/18-13/2026-27/4827
Notice Inviting E-Bids

S. No.	Item Name/Description	Ref. No.	UBN	Estimated Value Rs. in Crore	Last Time & Last date for bid submission
1	Drugs	Ref.No.: F02 (451)/RMSCL/Procurement/Drug/NIB-13/2026-27/4813 Dated: 27.07.2026	MSC2627GLRC00048	34.47 Crore	01.09.2026 up to 06.00 pm

Raj.Samwad/C26/10/2402 Director (Procurement)

Salute the Soldier

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

INSPECTOR	CONSTABLE
RAVI DUTT SHARMA 122 BN BSF 15.09.1942 - 19.08.1993	RAMESH CHAND 122 BN BSF 15.11.1968 - 19.08.1993

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Inspector Ravi Dutt Sharma and Constable Ramesh Chandra on their Balidan Diwas. On 17th Aug 1993, they sustained fatal injuries while operational duty in Singar area (J&K) and later succumbed to their injuries at 2nd base hospital on 19th Aug 1993.

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable Girish Kumar on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in area of BOP Simla - II, Panisagar (Tirupur). He fought bravely and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action has been highly recognized by GO by awarding him with Medal for Gallantry (Posthumously).

INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE (ITBP)

Asstt. Sub. Inspector Prakash Kumar Gope

ITBP salutes its braveheart Asstt. Sub. Inspector Prakash Kumar Gope of 48th Battalion, who laid down his life in the line of duty on this day in Sikkim in 2023.

RAJASTHAN RAJYA VIDYUT UTPADAN NIGAM LTD.
Old Bldg (7th-8th), Investment Building, Laxmi Nagar, Jaipur, Rajasthan

E-TENDER NOTICE: TN-34 (RVU2627GLOB01138)

Online tenders are invited for "PROCUREMENT OF HT CABLES FOR VARIOUS POWER PLANTS OF RVUN; Tender details are available on http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in (for e-tender), www.energy.rajasthan.gov.in/rvun & www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in.

Raj.Samwad/C26/10/2412 RVUN/PR-4464 Superintending Engineer (TD-II)

FABRICATION, SUPPLY & REPLACEMENT OF STEEL BRIDGE GIRDER

Tender Notice No.: DGBL/07/2026/01 Date: 11-08-2026

E-Tender are invited by the undersigned for the following work:

Tender No.: DGBL/08/2026/01

Name of Work : Fabrication, supply & Replacement of steel bridge girder of span of Br No.126 DN (1x76.2m) at km 137/3-4 near Jamanamukh-Juglani section and Br No.157 DN (1x30.5m) at km 175/1-2 between Habaipur-Lamsaakh section.

Approximate Tender Value: ₹ 70.84, 583.43/-

Bid Security: ₹ 23,41,900/-

Date & time of closing of tender at 15:00 hrs. and opening of tender at 15:00 hrs. on 03-09-2026. Complete information alongwith tender document of above e-tender are available in the website http://www.treps.gov.in

Dy. CE/Bridge-Line, Malignon

NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER CONSTRUCTION DIVISION
U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)
220, C-1, UNES, New Delhi-110002
E-mail: urbanworkslimit@yahooin Letter No. 490/NVIDA/27 Dated: 18.08.2026

Short Term E-Tender Notice

U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) invites E-bids for execution of "Survey, Supply design drawing, Supply of all materials, Labour, T&P etc. required for Laying of HDPE water pipe line (Replacement of existing AC Feeder main pipe line) from Delhi Road Chhota to Jain Nagar Bahadur along north side of Railway line. All completed and commissioned work shall be handed over to Nagar Nigam Meerut under Nagar Nigam Meerut Deposit Work with testing and commissioning as per specification of tender document. The scope of work also includes trial run of 03 months and defect liability period of 12 months for civil works after completion of successful trial run. All completed and commissioned work shall be handed over to Nagar Nigam Meerut after 03 months successful trial run period." and laying of water pipe line on percentage basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-bids documents will be available on U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) website (http://etender.up.nic.in and U.P.J.N. (Urban) website www.jnpsc.gov.in) for download from dated 19.08.2026 to 01.09.2026 up to 05:00 PM and technical bid shall be opened on 03.09.2026 at 03:00 PM in the office of undersigned in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender cost is Rs. 5000.00 + GST @ 18% for tender. Details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal (http://etender.up.nic.in & U.P.J.N. (Urban) website www.jnpsc.gov.in).

The Big Picture

WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 19, 2026

13

THE TATA SUCCESSION BATTLE

OVER TO NOEL

For years, Noel Tata, Ratan Tata's half-brother, 20 years his junior, was the 'other Tata', self-effacing and reserved. Now, as a corporate battle in the 158-year-old group takes a new turn, GEORGE MATHEW on the man whose influence will determine who gets to head Tata Sons

IT WAS set to be a done deal. Had it been put to vote, Natarajan Chandrasekaran would have sailed through, securing another term as chairman of Tata Sons, the holding company of the 158-year-old Tata Group. After all, four of the six board members were in his favour. But that day, February 24, 2026, the boardroom was tense. One man on the board, Noel Tata, had tough questions — about losses made by several companies in the \$180 billion group, about its possible public listing, and what justified another term for Chandrasekaran as chairman. It was clear that Noel Tata was in no mood to give Chandrasekaran a walkover.

At the end of the meeting at Bombay House, the headquarters of the Tata Group, Chandrasekaran proposed that the decision be deferred until a consensus was reached. He didn't want the extension of his term to go through without the approval of Noel Tata, chairman of Tata Trusts, the family-run philanthropic arm that owns roughly two-thirds of Tata Sons.

It was a point, Tata watchers say, when Noel, for long the 'other Tata' in the room, came into his own. It would have been hard for anyone to step into the legendary Ratan Tata's shoes, possibly even harder to step out of them. That Noel — Ratan Tata's half-brother, two decades his junior — could have that day effectively vetoed Chandrasekaran, the man Ratan Tata had appointed to the post instead of his half-brother, was remarkable for a business house that has long prided itself on reaching key decisions by consensus.

On August 12, Chandrasekaran announced his decision to exit as Tata Sons chairman at the end of his term in February 2027, bringing to a close one of the most dramatic boardroom battles in recent times. With Noel likely to be on the five-member selection committee that will choose Chandrasekaran's successor, he could have a decisive say in who comes next.

"In a company, the owner has every right to hire and fire key persons. Tata Trusts and group companies own majority stakes in Tata Sons. He (Noel) has every right to make recommendations for the post as Tata Trusts' chairman, obviously with the backing of other trustees," a senior Tata Group official told *The Indian Express*.

Ratan and Noel
From the 1990s until his death in 2024, Ratan Tata had been the public face of the Tata Group, the man at the heart of an empire spanning steel, automobiles, aviation, software, power, hotels, consumer businesses and much else. While he stepped down as chairman of Tata Sons in December 2012, he continued to lead Tata Trusts and have a decisive influence over the group's governance, until his death in October 2024.

It was then that Noel emerged as the family's main representative. While Ratan Tata's ailing younger brother Jimmy Tata paid public homage to his departed sibling at Mumbai's National Centre for the Performing Arts on October 10, it was Noel who received VIP guests throughout the mourning period.

In his homage, Noel Tata said, "There is no greatness where there is no simplicity, goodness and truth, Leo Tolstoy said. Measure Ratan Tata by these characteristics, and there can be no doubting what he brought to the world he lived in and what we have lost with his passing."

For the longest time, however, the half-brothers had been distant, with their upbringing under different circumstances. After Ratan Tata's father Naval Hormusji Tata separated from their mother Soonoo Commissariat, Ratan and Jimmy Tata were largely brought up by their grandmother Navabai Tata.

Naval went on to marry Swiss-born Simone Dunoyer, and by the time Noel was born to the couple in 1957, Ratan Tata was 20 years old.

In her 2021 book *The Tatas*, Freddie Mercury & Other Bawls, veteran journalist and *The Indian Express's* Contributing Edi-

Corporate Structure of Tata Group

TATA TRUSTS: Owns roughly two-thirds of Tata Sons, with the holdings primarily through various charitable trusts, including the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) and Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT)

Chairman: Noel Tata
TATA SONS: Tata Sons is the principal investment holding company and promoter of the Tata Group, which comprises 31 companies, including 26 publicly listed companies. Sixty-six percent of the equity share capital of Tata Sons is held by philanthropic trusts, which support education, health, livelihood generation and art and culture.

Publicly listed businesses under Tata Sons: TCS, Tata Motors, Tata Steel, and Titan

Private unlisted companies: Air India, Tata Digital, Tata Electronics, Tata International

Chairman: Natarajan Chandrasekaran

Chairman: Natarajan Chandrasekaran

tor Coommi Kapoor writes that when Ratan Tata returned to India after graduating from Cornell University and staying back in the US for seven years, it was to a very different home. "...it is possible that Ratan may have felt ignored in the family home. His father had a new family, which included his half-brother — christened Noel, since he was born on Christmas Day. Noel was twenty years younger, and perhaps Ratan resented the newcomer's presence. The relationship between Ratan and his stepmother is believed to be rather distant."

Noel, Kapoor writes, was then "the indulged baby boy, twenty years younger than his half-brother. Ratan was generally not present at Noel's mother Simone's Christmas and New Year bashes, even though he lived next door."

The Noel family lives in Windermere building in downtown Mumbai's Cuffe Parade, not very far from the sea-facing Bakhtawar, also called Cabins and Halekai bungalow, Ratan Tata's home in Colaba.

Noel, now 69, is married to Aloo Mistry, the sister of former Tata Sons chairman Cyrus Mistry. In 2003, Noel, along with the entire Mistry family, acquired Irish citizenship after his father-in-law Pallonji Mistry's marriage to Dublin-based Patsy Perin.

Noel's mother Simone, who was the brain behind Lakme, the Tata group's popular cosmetic brand, died in December 2025. Trent, the group's retail arm that Noel turned around and is arguably his biggest achievement yet, was created in 1998 from the proceeds of sale of Lakme.

"I only know Noel Tata as an academically well-qualified, accomplished, low-

profile person. With his distinguished mother, he built a Rs 180,000-crore retail enterprise in India," says R Gopalakrishnan, former Director of Tata Sons. Noel took over as Managing Director of Trent in 1999 after a Bachelor's from Sussex University (UK) and an International Executive Programme at France's INSEAD. Under Noel, Trent expanded dramatically across formats, eventually turning into the company behind household names such as Westside and Zudio. From one store in 1998, Westside grew to more than 1,200 stores across formats during his tenure.

In June this year, Noel announced at the Trent Annual General Meeting that he was stepping down as chairman in line with the Tata Group's governance guidelines, under which non-executive directors retire at 70.

Despite Noel's successful stint at Trent, Ratan Tata was, by all accounts, unwilling to promote his half brother. As late as 2019, Noel was not even a trustee on any of the major Tata trusts.

Besides, he was overlooked for the post of chairman of Tata Sons at least twice. In 2012, when Ratan Tata decided to retire as Chairman of Tata Sons, most eyes turned towards the low-profile, reticent Noel. But the mantle ultimately went to Cyrus Mistry.

Then, in 2016, when Mistry was dramatically ousted from the chairmanship, speculation swirled around Noel. But then, too, he was overlooked, this time in favour of Chandrasekaran, then the MD and CEO of Tata Consultancy Services, the group's flagship technology company.

In his book *Ratan Tata: A Life*, author and former bureaucrat Thomas Mathew

quotes Ratan Tata as saying, "Perhaps, if Noel had the experience of handling difficult assignments, he could have established his credentials more forcefully."

Apart from that rare remark, both Ratan and Noel Tata spoke very little about each other in public. But people close to Noel say that Ratan was fond of his half-brother's children Leah, Maya and Neville. Neville is already a trustee in Tata Trusts and is involved in the retail business. Leah works with Indian Hotels and Maya with Tata Digital and Trent.

In February 2019, Noel was finally inducted as a trustee of the Sir Ratan Tata Trust, one of the two core, allied trusts that anchor the Tata Trusts network. Kapoor writes, "It was only when Ratan's long-time financial advisor, Noshir Soonawala, stepped down, at the age of eighty-four, and reportedly called on Ratan to induct Noel that Ratan's half-brother was appointed in his place."

The bond between the two half-siblings, Coommi Kapoor writes, became stronger after 2016, around which time, Noel says in an interview, they met regularly. In February 2022, he was finally inducted as a trustee of the Sir Dorab Tata Trust, too.

Noel comes into his own

People who know him say Noel, usually seen in button-down shirts in blue or white, is self-effacing and reserved. "When I met him at a simple Tata guest house in Mumbai when I was involved in writing the book, I realised he has amazing vision about various things," Mathew says.

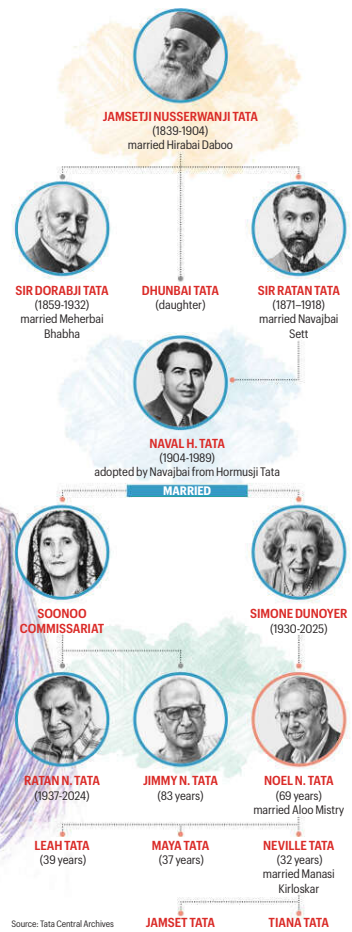
Others, however, see a different side. "As a business leader, he's untested so far," says a top source who is part of the Tata ecosystem. "He was not part of the core business of manufacturing in the group. He was the chairman of the loss-making Tata International."

A top source in the Tata Group says, "While Noel lacks the stature and standing of Ratan Tata in the Indian industrial landscape, he has proved his mettle by successfully running companies like Trent and Tata Investment Corporation... and he was on the boards of leading Tata companies like Tata Steel. His role will be that of a guide, guard and policy-maker for the group. He can always step in when Tata Sons or group companies make wrong decisions."

Yet, they all point to the February 2026 meeting, when he challenged Chandrasekaran on the latter's reappointment and the direction of the group, as evidence of a man increasingly willing to make his views heard and establish his authority — much as Ratan Tata had done decades earlier.

In 1991, when Ratan Tata took over as chairman of Tata Sons from Jehangir Ratanji Dadabhai (JRD) Tata, who stepped

THE TATAS



Source: Tata Central Archives

Upheavals since Noel Tata took charge

OCTOBER 2025: Mehli Mistry, a longtime trustee of the Sir Ratan Tata Trust and a close confidant of Ratan Tata, is voted out after trustees decline to renew his tenure.

FEBRUARY 2026: Ex-CEO of Citi India, Pramit Jhaveri, a supporter of Mistry, also does not opt for reappointment to the Trusts.

MAY 2026: Noel Tata votes against reappointment of Ratan Tata's close aide, former Defence Secretary Vijay Singh, who argued for listing of Tata Sons against Noel, does not opt for reappointment to Sir Ratan Tata Trust. He will exit all other Trusts by July 2027.

Tata Sons Chairman N. Chandrasekaran has now opted to vacate his post

down after leading the conglomerate for over 50 years, he eased out some of the most prominent faces — from Russi Mody of Tata Steel to Darab Sethi of Tata Chemicals and Ajit Kerkar of Indian Hotels — and replaced them with his men.

In Noel's case, it started with Mehli Mistry, his wife's cousin and Ratan Tata's close friend. Last year, Mehli was not renominated to the Tata Trusts. Another Tata Trusts member, former Citi India CEO Pramit Jhaveri, saw the writing on the wall and didn't opt for reappointment. Chandrasekaran, too, had earlier postponed the decision on his extension.

There had, for some time, been a sense within the group that Noel and Chandrasekaran had differing views on the direction of Tata Sons. Some of Noel's concerns were about the way the group was evolving under Chandrasekaran — including how far it should move into newer businesses, how those businesses were being managed and how the Tata Group's long-established culture should be preserved. The question of whether Tata Sons should remain private had become another point of difference, as had the losses being incurred by some of its newer and unlisted businesses.

The way ahead for Noel, Tatas

When the five-member selection committee, which may include Noel Tata, meets to decide on the new chairman of Tata Sons, there will be questions to confront. Will the new chairman be a Tata insider, someone promoted from the many Tata companies? A family member? A member of the Parsi community? Or will the Tatas look beyond as they scout for talent?

Those close to Noel say that his choice will reflect some of his concerns related to the Group.

While the market capitalisation of the Tata Group's listed companies has more than tripled over the past nine years, rising to around Rs 27 lakh crore, it has been accompanied by mounting losses at some of the group's major unlisted businesses, and these companies need to be returned to profitability.

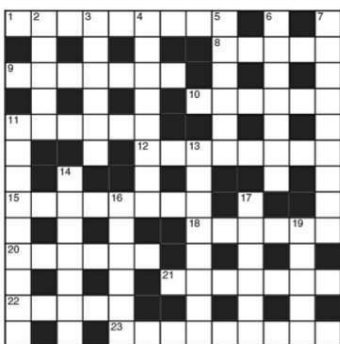
The losses of eight unlisted Tata companies stood at Rs 33,538 crore in FY26. Air India accounted for the largest share of these losses, with its annual loss doubling to Rs 22,238 crore. Tata Digital, another key unlisted business that houses the group's digital ambitions, reported a loss of Rs 4,974 crore during the year.

As the group looks for a new direction and investment plan in the wake of changing technological advancements, Noel's every move, especially the selection of the new chairman of Tata Sons, will be keenly watched and scrutinised.



(From left) Naval Tata with sons Noel and Ratan. SOURCE: HORIZONS, TATA TRUSTS

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS**
- 1 Rush to get on the panel (9)
 - 8 Character of those who are different (5)
 - 9 Chopped sausage to relieve hunger (7)
 - 10 Turn meant to amuse perhaps (6)
 - 11 Specify how a token may be regarded? (6)
 - 12 Press for a reduction? (8)
 - 15 Acrobats in glasses (8)
 - 17 They're up for approval (6)
 - 20 Make a second charge for killing? (6)
 - 22 Supply foodstuffs (7)
 - 23 A Belgian city is the subject (5)
- DOWN**
- 2 Almost rate as fools (5)
 - 3 Is under the spell of nymphs (6)
 - 4 I'd turn up in a sort of orange fabric (8)
 - 5 He refuses a measure of silk (6)
 - 6 He's involved with a cheat and is naturally spotted? (7)
 - 7 Hot lines upset Rose Smith (9)
 - 11 Planned a Yule rest with no frills (9)
 - 13 Sort of a-ali that's been forged? (4)
 - 14 Insinuates one politician isn't truthful (7)
 - 16 Abandons having days off work (6)
 - 17 An unnatural ending (6)
 - 19 The ghost of Shakespeare on arising (9)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 607A **ACROSS:** 1 Slobber, 4 Muses, 7 Rank, 8 Stickers, 10 Pedestrian, 12 Secure, 13 Signed, 15 Invocation, 18 Basement, 19 Beat, 20 Riser, 21 Editors **DOWN:** 1 Scrap, 2 Benedict, 3 Petard, 4 Mechanical, 5 Sees, 6 Suspend, 9 Astronomer, 11 Anti-hero, 12 Slumber, 14 Pounce, 16 Notes, 17 Uses

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given clue.

Is that which, when you stop believing in it, doesn't go away.

-Philip K. Dick (7)

EHVAE

ADMLT

ERTIR

BDNOOY

MSKNEB

Rebels, when you stop believing in it, doesn't go away.

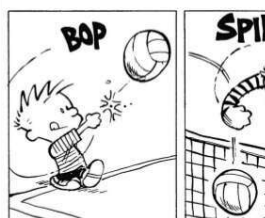
-Philip K. Dick

SOLUTIONS: 'Rebels', 'Time', 'Mashed', 'Nooby'

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius



ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLIS

- ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20):** Although mild quarrels might arise about how to share the expense of something, don't let this rankle you. Instead, focus on socialising, the arts, sports and fun activities with kids. This is a great day to chat. Tonight: Check banking details.
- TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21):** Tread carefully when talking to family members, spouses, partners and close friends, because things are tense today. Pull in your reins a bit. Keep things light. Tonight: Be cooperative.
- GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21):** There are two options available to you today. You can get caught up in squabbles with siblings, relatives, neighbours and work colleagues—or you can play hooky and have fun doing whatever you want. Tonight: Focus on your health.
- CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23):** Romantic partners must be patient with each other. Likewise, parents must be patient with their kids. It's the perfect day to redecorate and tweak your digs. You might even entertain. Get some physical exercise. Tonight: Socialise.
- LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23):** Today the Moon is at odds with your Sun, triggering domestic arguments and tension with people at home. Fortunately, fair Venus, will smooth your words. Dish out the sweetness. Tonight: Relax at home.
- VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23):** Something going on behind the scenes today might make you feel disgruntled. This mood might affect how you speak to others. Throw your energy into interacting with friends, groups and organisations. You also might buy something beautiful today. Tonight: An interesting conversation.
- LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23):** This continues to be a great time for you to buy wardrobe items, which is not a bad idea, because you like to look your best. Avoid money squabbles today. Tonight: Maintain your possessions.
- SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23):** Today you should avoid quarrels and power struggles with bosses, parents, teachers, VIPs and the police. Dabble in secret love affairs, or explore avenues in travel, medicine, the law and publishing. Stay out of trouble. Tonight: Define future goals.
- SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22):** Steer clear of controversial subjects today, because they will irritate you. Instead, decide to have fun with a friend or a group. Explore new ideas. It's also a passionate day. Tonight: Privacy.
- CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20):** Avoid squabbles with a friend today. Likewise, don't get caught up fighting a member of a group. Partners and close friends might annoy you. Instead, focus on goals, your career and earning some brownie points with bosses, parents and authority figures. Tonight: Be friendly.
- AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19):** There's a high probability that you might have a public argument with someone today. You might be at odds with a boss, parent, teacher, VIP or the police. The upside is not favourable. Work hard and get organised. Tonight: Be modest.
- PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20):** Don't get bogged down in arguments, which is easy to do. Focus on socialising with others and expressing your creative talents. Great choice. Tonight: Explore!

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Jasveer Bawa S/o Sushil Baba R/o A-21, 1st Floor, Block A Extn., Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide FIR No. 332/2025 U/S 318(4)/336(3)/340(2)/3(5) **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Janakpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Jasveer Bawa** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Jasveer Bawa** has absconded (or is concealing himself) to avoid the service of the said warrant,

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Jasveer Bawa** of FIR No. 332/2025 U/S 318(4)/336(3)/340(2)/3(5) **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Janakpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the date of **29.09.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Harjot Singh Aujla
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11
South-West District, Court No.05
Dwarka Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rashi Jain @ Riya D/o Varun Jain R/o E-12, Om Vihar, Phase-5, 40 Foota Road, Navada, Dwarka, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide FIR No. 332/2018 U/S 419/120B, **PS GTB Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Rashi Jain @ Riya** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rashi Jain @ Riya** has absconded (or is concealing himself) to avoid the service of the said warrant,

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rashi Jain @ Riya** of FIR No. 332/2018 U/S 419/120B, **PS GTB Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the date of **26.10.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Sanghamita
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
Room No. 54, Second Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohd. Abdul Tariq S/o Tahir Khan R/o H. No.-8, Gali No.4C, Aram Park, Shastri Park, Geeta Colony, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide FIR No. 17436/22 U/S 379/14/134 **IPC, PS Farsh Bazar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Mohd. Abdul Tariq** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mohd. Abdul Tariq** has absconded (or is concealing himself) to avoid the service of the said warrant,

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mohd. Abdul Tariq** of FIR No. 17436/22 U/S 379/14/134 **IPC, PS Farsh Bazar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the date of **25.09.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Akhil Malik
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
Room No. 38, Ground Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

NORTHERN RAILWAY CORRIGENDUM

Ref: Tender Notice No. -16/2026-27 Dated -27.05.2026 Sr. no. 06
(i) Tender No. -152352934 due on 15.09.2026

The corrigendum has been published on website www.reps.gov.in

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 285526

Government of Rajasthan
Office of Commissioner Industries and Commerce & Corporate Social Responsibilities (CSR)
Udyog Bhawan, Tilak Marg, Jaipur-302005

No.: E/1 UPSIN/D/Heat Construction/PPP Model/2026 Date: 06.08.2026
Notice Inviting Bid
Bid No. 01/2026-27

Online e-bids are invited for Selection of PPP Partner for Design Development, Construction, Financing, Operations and Management of Heat Infrastructure under PPP Model in Rajasthan. Detailed terms & conditions of bids can be viewed and downloaded from www.eproc-rajasthan.gov.in, www.rajasthan.gov.in, www.industrys.rajasthan.gov.in

The last date of bid submission is 09.09.26 up to 01.00 p.m.

Sd/-
Commissioner,
Industries & Commerce and
Chairman and Managing Director,
Udyam Pratsahan Sansthan

UIN: DS1267SL0B00043
DIPR/C14691/2026

उत्तराखण्ड लोक सेवा आयोग
संख्या 43/01/E4/FOREST DR/2024-25 दिनांक 18 अगस्त, 2026

सिआरि
'सहायक वन संरक्षक, लॉजिंग अधिकारी एवं वनसंरक्षिका' संयुक्त

परीक्षा-2026

एतद्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि सहायक वन संरक्षक, लॉजिंग अधिकारी एवं वनसंरक्षिका संयुक्त परीक्षा-2026 से अर्जनांत आवेदन शुल्क (सिआरि) दिनांक: 24 अगस्त, 2026 से 28 अगस्त, 2026 के परीक्षा परीक्षण दिनांक: 17 अगस्त, 2026 में औपचारिक रूप से सफल उम्मीदवारों को सहायक वन संरक्षक, लॉजिंग अधिकारी एवं वनसंरक्षिका संयुक्त परीक्षा-2026 से 09 सितंबर, 2026 तक परीक्षा भवन, उत्तराखण्ड लोक सेवा आयोग, हरिद्वार में किया जाएगा। उम्मीदवारों के लिए विहित अभिलेख सहायक वन संरक्षक एवं अन्य निदेश आयोग की वेबसाइट psc.uk.gov.in पर प्रकाशित किये गये हैं। उम्मीदवार अभिलेख सहायक वन संरक्षक के अनुसार निर्धारित तिथि एवं समय पर अभिलेखों के सहायक हेतु उपस्थित होना सुनिश्चित करें।

(आयोग के अधिकारी) सहायक वन संरक्षक, लॉजिंग अधिकारी एवं वनसंरक्षिका संयुक्त

Department of Water Resources,
Government of Odisha

"e" Procurement Notice No. ACED-BBSR-05/2026-27
Name of the Works: Total 03 (Three) Nos. Drainage work

2. Estimated Cost: Rs. 99.89 lakh to Rs. 402.06 lakh

3. Period of Completion: 11 (Eleven) months

4. Date and time of availability of bid document in the portal: From 11.00 hours of Dt. 20.08.2026 to 18.00 hours of Dt. 03.09.2026.

5. Last date/time for receipt of bids in the portal: 18.00 hours of Dt. 03.09.2026.

6. Date of Opening of Technical Bid: 05.09.2026 at 11.00 hours

7. Name and address of the Officer in Charge: Additional Chief Engineer, Drainage Circle, Unit-8, Bhubaneswar-751012. e-mail: dsdrainagebbsr12@gmail.com.

The publication notice will be intimated to the participated bidders to their registered e-mail & to their registered mobile number through an automated text message by e-procurement system. On such intimation, individual bidder needs to log in to their ID through ODC to know the uploaded summary, i.e. details of opening of financial bid, lottery date time, venue, acceptance of bid etc.

Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal of Odisha Government <https://tendersodisha.gov.in>. All information, notices, addendum, corrigendum cancellation notice etc. if required, will be published in this site.

Sd/-
Additional Chief Engineer
Drainage-Circle, Bhubaneswar
OIPR-32001/32409/16-26/70005

RAJASTHAN RAJYA VIDYUT PRASARAN NIGAM LIMITED NOTICE INVITING BIDS NO. 11 (2026-27) & NOTICE INVITING BIDS NO. 11 (2026-27)

RVPN invites competitive BIDS for following Civil works from experienced, reputed contractors registered in appropriate class with RVPN, S.A or AA class in Central/ State Government Department and their undertakings and registered in GST department. The Tender/Bid shall only be submitted through online tendering system of <http://eproc-rajasthan.gov.in>. The interested bidders shall have to be enrolled/registered with portal of <http://eproc-rajasthan.gov.in> for participating in the bidding process. S.No. 01 to 09 (NIB No. 0 of 2026-27 & 01 to 15 (NIB No. 11 (2026-27) UBN No. (VFN2627WS0B01235) to (VFN2627WS0B01237), (VFN2627WS0B01239) to (VFN2627WS0B01240), (VFN2627WS0B01242) to (VFN2627WS0B01244), (VFN2627WS0B01246) to (VFN2627WS0B01248), (VFN2627WS0B01264) to (VFN2627WS0B01266), (VFN2627WS0B01269) to (VFN2627WS0B01274), (VFN2627WS0B01288) to (VFN2627WS0B01291)

Raj.Samvad/C/26/70197 RRVN/TR/760/2026
Superintending Engineer (Civil), Jodhpur

अनुसूचित विकास प्राधिकरण, जयपुर
संख्या 43/01/E4/FOREST DR/2024-25 दिनांक 18 अगस्त, 2026

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Central Coalfields Limited

"A Maharatna Company"
(A Subsidiary of Coal India Limited)

Notice
"All the tenders issued by CIL and its Subsidiaries for procurement of Goods, Works and Services are available on website of Coal India Ltd. www.coalindia.in respective Subsidiary Company (CCL, www.centralcoalfields.in) CIL e-procurement portal <https://coalindiatenders.nic.in> and Central Public Procurement Portal <https://procure.gov.in> In addition, procurement is also done through GeM portal <https://gem.gov.in/>."

Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation Ltd.
D-Block, Swasthya Bhawan, Chokha, Jaipur-302005
Ph. No. 0141-2228887, Fax No. 0141-2228885, e-Mail: corporate@rcmshs.in

Ref. No.: F-8) BMS/CPW/M-4/NR-930/2025-26/661
Corrigendum / Addendum
Bid for item WASTE SW/RO, BLACK & YELLOW (15 & 25 Ltr) is invited from interested bidders up to Date: 08/09/2026: 06:00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on Procurement portal website <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> or <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> or www.dipronline.org or <https://procure.gov.in>

UBN No.: MSC2526GB000054
Director (P)
Raj.Samvad/C/26/70240 Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता जन स्वास्थ्य
अभियन्ता की विभागा वृत्त टोक
Email: sephedonk@gmail.com

अनुसूचित विकास प्राधिकरण, जयपुर
संख्या 43/01/E4/FOREST DR/2024-25 दिनांक 18 अगस्त, 2026

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No Khel Ratna for 1st times since 2014; 17 Arjuna awardees

Express News Service
Mumbai, August 18

BACK IN December, India's hockey vice-captain Hardik Singh was recommended for the Khel Ratna. On Tuesday, when the sports ministry officially released the names of the winners after a reevaluation of the selection process, the midfielder's name no longer features on the list.

In fact, for the first time since 2014 — and only the third time since the Khel Ratna was instituted in 1991-92 — no athlete will be honoured with India's highest sporting honour.

Not just Hardik. His teammates Lalit Upadhyay, a veteran of three World Cups and closer to 200 internationals, Mandeep Singh and Vivek Sagar Prasad — all of whom played a crucial role in India's return to the Olympic podium — would have hoped to be nominated for the Khel Ratna.

A Ministry official said the final list was declared after a 'thorough study of all applications in a manner that the integrity of the awards remained intact.' The Khel Ratna carries a cash prize of Rs 25 lakh, a medal and a citation.

Last year, four sportspersons were named Khel Ratna recipients. Chess world champion Gukesh Dommaraju, India's men's hockey team captain Harmanpreet Singh, para-athlete Praveen Kumar and Olympic medalist Manu Bhaker.

The awards were announced based on the recommendations of a selection committee chaired by the former SC Judge Justice (Retd.) Arun Kumar Mishra.

While there were no Khel Ratna winners, 17 athletes were conferred with the Arjuna Awards. Among them will be high jumper Tejaswin Shankar, sprinters Mohammed Ajmal V and Priyanka Goswami, badminton players Pooja Jolly and Pragathi Choudhary, chess players Vidit Gujrathi and Divya Deshmukh, hockey players Lalremasiami and Rajkumar Pal, and shooter Akhil Sheoran.

Three coaches were selected for the Dronacharya Award in the regular category — coaches Jolly and Praveen Singh, boxing coach Chhotu Lal Yadav and shooting coach Neha Nandkumar Chanav.

GALLE TEST, DAY 4

India set 372 as Pant's 66 papers over a middle-order collapse

4 wickets fell between overs 15 and 31, before southpaw took the game away from SL

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, August 18

INDIA ARE within touching distance of taking the series lead in Galle. If weather permits, they should get the remaining six Sri Lanka wickets and head to Colombo with a 1-0 lead. The forecast looks encouraging on the final day too, with showers expected only early in the morning, and even in the worst case of a delayed start on Wednesday, India have every reason to believe they can wrap up the Test.

The task won't be easy, though. Going by the signs late on Tuesday, they will have to work hard for it. Despite 14 wickets falling on the day, the pitch hasn't worn as much as expected. There is a good degree of turn on offer, which Galle is known for, but the bounce remains on the lower side. Batsmen who get their eye in on can defend off the back foot without much trouble.

That India removed short leg and silly point when the spinners operated, as early as the 21st over, once the ball had gone soft, showed the challenge they are up against. Instead, alongside a traditional slip, they kept a second slip, kneeling to make sure half-chances didn't go to waste. It was one such effort from Dhruv Jurel that gave India their fourth wicket. They would have had a fifth, that of Dhananjaya de Silva, only for Ravindra Jadeja to overstep after KL Rahul had pounced it at first slip. Instead, Sri Lanka ended Day 4 on 84 for 4. Fighting out a draw is possible, but they will have to bat out of their skins to do it.

Having set a target for the win, India knew they had to be patient and disciplined with the ball. The low bounce means batsmen have the option of disrupting the spinners with the sweep, so the pitch hasn't evolved into one where the spinners can simply land in the right areas and let the surface do the rest. That India didn't turn to Kuldeep Yadav till the 29th over said everything about their reading of the conditions. As the slowest of their three spinners, he gives batsmen more chances to survive. With the new ball, wickets were key, and India were right on the mark. Mohammed Siraj's surprise bouncer brought the first wicket, of Nishan Madushka, while Manav Suthar's straighter delivery trapped concussion substitute Pasindu Sooriyabandara. In for Dinesh Chandimal, first ball. Kamindu Mendis couldn't resist chasing a wide delivery off Prasidh



Mohammed Siraj took the wicket of Nishan Fernando in the seventh over to get India off the mark. CREMAS

There is a good degree of turn on offer, which Galle is known for, but the bounce remains on the lower side. Batsmen who get their eye in can defend off the back foot without much trouble

Krishna, Rahul taking a sharp catch at slip, before Lahiru Udara fell to Suthar. Despite that opening burst, once the ball softened, the same bite went missing, something India will need to find again on the final day.

Safe target set

When play began on Day 4, with India leading by 178 runs, the question was at what point they would feel safe from losing the Test. At Galle, teams chasing targets under 150 have succeeded every time they've tried. But for targets of 150 and above, successful chases have been rare, including Pakistan's 342 in 2022. This surface, under covers for a long period and baked under the sun over the last couple of days, had not deteriorated as much as expected. So India's approach followed predictable lines. With the pitch not wearing much, and rain a possibility, India knew they had to give their bowlers time to take 10 wickets, and came out looking to score quickly in the second innings.

But as had been the case through the Test, India tried to be aggressive while the ball retained its hardness, and it meant they lost wickets more

often than they would have liked. After Yashasvi Jaiswal was dismissed for nought off the third ball of the innings, KL Rahul and Devdutt Padikkal started briskly. But between the 15th and 31st overs, exactly when they would have wanted to press on, they lost four wickets, leaving the responsibility to Rishabh Pant. By then the ball had gone soft, but the turn remained as sharp as ever, setting up a riveting contest.

The Sri Lankans fancied their chances against Pant, with fieldsers in attacking positions. He sensed the opportunity to score, provided he was brave, and he was, taking the right risks without being reckless. His shot selection was calculated; by now he knew what worked and what didn't. Unlike the top order, he preferred to play on either side of the square, not just the safer option but the more effective one against spin. His 66 off 69 balls stretched the lead beyond Sri Lanka's reach.

Take away Pant's innings, Padikkal's 44 and Rahul's 35, and the rest of the order managed only 42 between them, as India finished on 193. Their approach was questionable, but

Scorecard

SRI LANKA vs INDIA
GALLE
TOSS: India won, chose to bat
India 1st innings-462
Sri Lanka 1st innings-284
India 2nd innings-193
Yashasvi Jaiswal c Dickwella b Fernando 0 (3b)
KL Rahul c sub (Rathnayaka) b Jayasuriya 35 (47b, 2x4, 2x6)
Devidutt Padikkal lbw b Nwantha 44 (75b, 6x4)
Shubman Gill lbw b Jayasuriya 8 (20b, 1x4)
Rishabh Pant c Dickwella b Kumara 66 (68b, 8x4, 2x6)
Dhruv Jurel c Dickwella b Fernando 7 (55b, 1x4)
Ravindra Jadeja c sub (Sooriyabandara) b Kumara 9 (19b)
Manav Suthar c Dickwella b Fernando 9 (25b, 1x4)
Kuldeep Yadav c de Silva b Jayasuriya 5 (10b)
Mohammed Siraj not out 2 (6b)
Prasidh Krishna c Kumara b Fernando 2 (7b)
EXTRAS (lb 1, nb 3, w 2) 6
TOTAL (48.5 Overs) 193 all out
FOW: 1-0 (Yashasvi Jaiswal, 0.3 ov), 2-65 (KL Rahul, 14.4 ov), 3-81 (Shubman Gill, 20.5 ov), 4-111 (Devidutt Padikkal, 27.2 ov), 5-120 (Dhruv Jurel, 30.3 ov), 6-174 (Rishabh Pant, 40.3 ov), 7-179 (Ravindra Jadeja, 42.3 ov), 8-188 (Manav Suthar, 46.2 ov), 9-190 (Kuldeep Yadav, 47.1 ov), 10-193 (Sooriyabandara, 48.5 ov)
BOWLING: Kishan Fernando 8.5, 0-31-4; Keshava Nwantha 23-3-86-1; Prabhath Jayasuriya 11-0-43-3; Dhananjaya de Silva 1-0-4-0; Lahiru Kumara 5-0-28-2

Sri Lanka 2nd innings

Nishan Fernando c Krishna b Siraj 6 (27b)
Lahiru Udara c Jurel b Suthar 16 (58b, 1x4)
Pasindu Sooriyabandara lbw b Suthar 9 (7b)
Kamindu Mendis c Rahul b Krishna 2 (12b)
Dhananjaya de Silva not out 31 (73b, 3x4)
Sonali Dinanath not out 25 (36b, 4x4)
EXTRAS (lb 1, nb 3) 4
TOTAL (34 Overs) 84/4
FOW: 1-13 (Nishan Madushka Fernando, 6.6 ov), 2-14 (Pasindu Sooriyabandara, 7.2 ov), 3-21 (Kamindu Mendis, 10.4 ov), 4-47 (Lahiru Udara, 14.4 ov), 5-51 (Dhananjaya de Silva, 16.4 ov)
BOWLING: Mohammed Siraj 5-11-11; Manav Suthar 11-0-30-2; Prasidh Krishna 8-13-1; Ravindra Jadeja 6-0-16-0; Kuldeep Yadav 3-0-8-0; Devdutt Padikkal 1-0-5-0

given they were pushing for a win with rain a threat, that's a conversation for another day. They finished the job. A target of 372 looked safe.

Adventurous Rishabh retains offence while keeping team first

Sandip G
New Delhi, August 18

THERE ARE glorious Test careers that pass with nominal numbers in the six column. Australia opener David Boon, at odds with the machismo of his bristling moustache and piercing eyes, struck only two sixes in 18,116 balls. English opener Mike Atherton, no less obdurate, managed only four off the 20,609 deliveries he soaked up in Test cricket. VVS Laxman, disinclined to the savage pleasure of hitting sixes, brush-stroked only five balls beyond the fence.

Unlike in the shorter formats, it isn't a handicap or an anomaly there, but a number largely irrelevant to the game. Ben Stokes, the leading six-hitter in the long form, is remembered for his nerveless heists; the six-hitting prowess is merely an embellishment. Even Viv Richards, prophet of the most brutal swipes, is deified less for his sixes than for his swaggering aura. The six is not a requisite. It is, largely, dispensable.

The premise of the six in this format is what makes Rishabh Pant's feat, a century of sixes, the quickest ever, all the more striking. He has built a career out of a Test batsman's most dispensable run-scoring option. He needed only 4,934 balls for his hundred sixes, one every 49 balls. Stokes's 138, a record now at the mercy of Pant, came at one every 90 balls. Second on the list is Brendon McCullum, whose 107 arrived at one every 93rd ball. Adam Gilchrist, the first to reach a hundred, completes the quartet. It's a list of absorbing list. Jacques Kallis, cricket's perceived stone-waller, has hit more sixes (97) than Brian Lara (88), Sachin Tendulkar (69), AB de Villiers (64) and Ricky Ponting (73).

The achievement won't be romanticised the way Don Bradman's 9999 is, or Brian Lara's 400, or Sachin Tendulkar's 51 hundreds. Nor will it stand as a metaphor for T20 cricket's pull on the Test game (even after the Bazball boom, a six still arrives only once every 155 balls), or suddenly make the six the strongest currency in the sport. It exists instead as an exotic outlier, never fishing up to celebrate the quirk that make Pant such an unputdownable watch.

A six is his method. It's his



Rishabh Pant scored 66 off 69 balls for India on Day 4. CREMAS

madness too. He plays perfectly crisp strokes along the ground; he unfurls scything cuts, drills bullet cover-drives, whips through flicks. That's often his intention, until the bowler bristles in his run-up and the blood rushes in Pant's veins. That's when instinct overrides instructed wisdom, unbothered by the situation, his own form, or the sniff of a milestone.

It's as natural to him as a cover drive was to Virat Kohli, a flick to Mohammed Azharudin, or the front-foot defence, ripped straight off the steeple, was to Rahul Dravid. It's an expression of his joy, of the way he plays the game and feels it too. The record may well be a byproduct of his aggression rather than something he ever set out to chase. But the six is his meter. It isn't merely a tool to disrupt a bowler's length, a ploy to deny him rhythm. It's the stream his runs flow through. Sixes account for 600 of his 3,557 runs.

A Pant six is riveting theatre. It's unpredictable; he might hit the first ball of an innings for six, even if the situation screams for caution. It subverts logic: he takes on the fiercest bowlers, reverse-sweeping James Anderson among them. It borders on absurd: one-handed, upper body flailing, knees buckled, his whole frame tumbling in the follow-through. It finds corners others struggle to set a field for.

The technique itself fascinates: the balance, the stillness even in motion, the free-flowing swing, the extraordinary reach for a man of his height, the loose bottom hand. The six carries his ambition and his desire. But more than either, it carries the free-spiritedness that defines the way he plays. It's his method, and his madness.

India-Pak rivalry: Once thrilling, now one-sided

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, August 18

LAST SATURDAY, play in the middle of a World Cup match had to be stopped because Pakistan's players had forgotten their kitbag, which contained protective gear, in the changing room. A few months earlier, during the Pro League tour in Australia, they were scrambling for money to pay for their hotel stay. In another era, both incidents would have been unthinkable.

Pakistan were once hockey's trendsetters. They won four World Cups, three Olympic gold medals and produced artists who changed how the game was played. They weren't merely India's greatest rivals; for long periods, the Green Shirts were India's tormentors.

On Wednesday, when the neighbours meet in a do-or-die Pool Stage finale for both, the contest will still carry all the familiar emotions. But the balance of power has shifted so dramatically that the fixture now feels less like the renewal of a rivalry and more like a re-match of a game that was lost.

The numbers tell the story. Before 2000, India and Pakistan played 92 matches. Pakistan won exactly half of them, 46, India won only 30, while 16 ended in draws, according to The Hockey Museum. Since January 1, 2000, they have played 93 times. India have won 43, including a 7-1 hammering most recently in June. Pakistan have won 38. Twelve have been draws. The transformation becomes even starker when viewed through the prism of recent history. In-



India have beaten Pakistan 17 times in their last 20 meetings. H

dia's longest winless run against Pakistan lasted eight matches between 1988 and 1989. Pakistan haven't beaten India consistently for a decade. Their current winless streak against their neighbours stands at 20 matches and counting, a run dating back to April 2016.

The overall head-to-head record still favours Pakistan — 84 wins to India's 73, with 28 draws. But the gap is shrinking rapidly. And the reasons have little to do with talent.

There was a time when Pakistan showed a willingness to stay ahead of the curve. At the 2004 Athens Olympics, as then coach Roelant Oltmans experienced, their all-foreign coaching staff included a video analyst, something that wasn't commonplace in international hockey, especially in Asia. There was money, there was expertise and there was an understanding that the game was

{ HOCKEY WORLD CUP }

CATCHING UP

India vs Pakistan head-to-head BEFORE 2000

PLAYED: 92; India: win: 30;

Pakistan: win: 46; Draws: 16

SINCE 1 JANUARY 2000

PLAYED: 91; India: win: 43;

Pakistan: win: 38; Draws: 12

10 Number of years since India have lost to Pakistan. The two teams have played 20 times since the team's last defeat to the neighbours — at South Asian Games in February 2016 — India have won 17 times, drawn twice while one was abandoned due to rain.

SOURCE: THE HOCKEY MUSEUM

changing.

Signs of disconnect

Somewhere along the way, that momentum disappeared. The financial troubles are well documented, but reducing Pakistan's decline to a lack of funds would be simplistic. The bigger problem has been their inability to keep pace with a sport that has transformed dramatically over the last two decades.

The signs of that disconnect have surfaced in the unlikelyst of places. Training sessions have been affected by something as basic as a shortage of match-quality balls, as former Japan coach Siegfried Alkman experienced during his stint there. That might sound insignificant, but modern hockey is built on repetition and intensity. Coaches want multiple balls in circulation so that drills can continue without interruption. If players spend half

the session collecting stray balls, the quality of training inevitably suffers. The same story plays out elsewhere.

Sports science, once considered an added advantage, is now a necessity. GPS trackers that monitor workload and recovery have become standard equipment across top teams. Video analysis has evolved from being an optional extra to an indispensable tool. Conditioning methods have become more sophisticated. Nutrition, recovery and data analysis are no longer supporting elements; they are central to performance.

Pakistan, however, have often appeared stuck between two eras. Perhaps nowhere is that more evident than in their style of play. The breathtaking attacking instincts that once defined Pakistan hockey have

n't disappeared. Their players can still dribble out of tight spaces and produce moments of improvisation that few teams can replicate.

But modern hockey has become less forgiving of individualism. Ironically, many of these criticisms could have been directed at India, too. A little over a decade ago, Indian hockey was battling administrative chaos, financial uncertainty and questions over governance. But while India modernised, professionalised and embraced new ideas, Pakistan struggled to make the same transition.

And that divergence is now reflected in everything, from infrastructure and results to the most telling statistic of all: the rivalry itself. Wednesday's contest will still be labelled an India-Pakistan clash. It will still be marketed as one of hockey's great rivalries. And there will still be enough history between the two nations to ensure that the match matters.

But every India-Pakistan fixture now carries a lingering sense of melancholy. Because what was once a battle between equals has become a reminder of how one country adapted to the demands of modern hockey while the other slowly lost touch with them.

Yet, Harmanpreet Singh & Co. would be careful. India, one of the contenders to reach the World Cup semifinals, have everything to lose if they do not win. For Pakistan, the stakes aren't as high. Which is when they can be the most unpredictable and dangerous, the decline and history notwithstanding. **INDIA vs PAKISTAN, 6.30pm**, Live on Star Sports and JioHotstar

India women settle old score with South Africa, win 6-1

Tushar Bhaduri
New Delhi, August 18

FOLLOWERS OF hockey of a certain vintage would remember that it was South Africa who denied Indian women their first visit to an Olympics in 32 years. In the qualifying tournament in Delhi, they beat the home team 3-1 in a winner-takes-all clash in 2012. South Africa weren't considered one of the favoured teams in women's hockey even then.

That the group match between the two teams at the 2026 FIH World Cup was seen mainly as a chance for India to boost their goal difference says everything about the contrasting paths the two teams have taken over the last decade and a half. In that sense, the 6-1 win for Sjoerd Marjine's side was on expected lines, and India now have to avoid defeat against England on Thursday to make the next round.

After failing to qualify for London 2012, India reached Rio 2016. South Africa fell short of that one, though India returned from it winless, finishing last among 12 teams. Tokyo was a different story, a memorable campaign that took them to the semi-finals and had them threatening a medal.

India were always favourites going into Tuesday's contest in Amsterdam, especially after holding China to a 2-2 draw in their first game, while South Africa were thrashed 4-0 by England.

They took a quarter to find their rhythm, but after breaking the deadlock through a



The win against South Africa was India's biggest in the history of the Women's World Cup. HOCKEY INDIA

scrappy Sunelita Toppo goal in the 11th minute, they quickly put daylight between themselves and their opponents. The South Africans were often their own worst enemies, with sloppy turnovers in midfield and a failure to catch the ball from their defensive circle at the first opportunity.

They have players who catch the eye with pace and skill, Onthalie Zulu and Bianco Wood among them, but the fact that they couldn't trap the ball cleanly at the top of the circle on two of their three penalty corners pointed to the gulf in class between the sides.

Six different Indians scored on Tuesday, which will please the team management, but Navneet was the standout again. It was she who settled any anxiety within the team when she doubled India's lead from a penalty corner, choosing not to take a direct shot at

goal but instead moving the ball to her side, creating space and drilling a low first into past Marlies van Tonder in the South African goal.

Sushila Chanu made the game safe, a 3-0 lead at half-time taking the pressure off India, who could then focus on pushing their goal difference above England's, the Tier 1 team that will play earlier in the day. Three more goals, all reverse hits, from Deepika, Lalremasiami and Sakshi Rana, put five clear goals between the sides. Kayla de Waal got South Africa's first goal of the campaign with five minutes left, but it was little more than a consolation.

There was a moment of concern in the final minute when de Waal's trailing strike, at the edge of the Indian circle, struck Ishika Chaudhary, who left the field with blood running from her head.

BWF WORLD CHAMPIONSHIPS

Lakshya stutters, soars to conquer opening hurdle

Overcomes drift, his opponent's height and crowd pressure to advance to Rd 2

British Raj
New Delhi, August 18

THERE WAS drift, there was a crowd and there was a tall opponent on the other side for Lakshya Sen. The 2021 World Championships medallist first negotiated the drift, then enthralled the crowd and at last, dominated Austrian shuttler Collins Valentine Filimon in three games to win 16-21, 21-8, 21-4 in the first round of the Badminton World Championships.

Welcomed by a roaring crowd, Lakshya entered the tie as the favourite but took his own sweet time (the first game) to understand the drift and the tricky conditions in the arena.

He started well with two strong pushes to the back court but the towering Austrian responded with straight smashes. Filimon used the overhead smash, in particular, to good use and took the lead at the mid-game break.

He built on it as Lakshya started erring at the net. Lakshya's errors gave Filimon a decisive lead of 19-14. The Indian tried to make a comeback but failed as Filimon won the first game 21-19. "There was drift in the stadium and my net shots were not travelling. I was apprehensive about the power to put on the shot. But I changed it in the second game, got my opponent engaged in rallies and started dominating," Lakshya explained.

The 25-year-old couldn't generate the power required



Lakshya Sen beat Collins Valentine Filimon of Austria 16-21, 21-8, 21-4. AP

while tackling the drift and struggled against the smashes of Filimon. "Whenever I played it short, he had an advantage. He would either drive or smash it, which resulted in the loss of the first game," he said.

This is not the first time Lakshya has faced issues against a tall opponent; during the India Open is year, Lin Chun-yi also smashed his lifts easily.

Tactical shift

However, as the sides changed, Lakshya figured out how to deal with the drift and his opponent's height also. He changed his tactics and decided not to give any more shots at attacking length to his opponent.

Once in the groove, Lakshya started mixing his deceptive drops with down-the-line smashes which resulted in Filimon making multiple errors. "In the second game, I was aware that my side was the faster one and I started gener-

ating the power to trouble my opponent," said Lakshya.

Filimon held fort for some time but Lakshya started dominating after the mid-game interval of 11-8, and didn't let his opponent take any more points in the game.

It was a mix of errors from Filimon as the crowd pressure grew and Lakshya getting better with his strokes.

"The crowd definitely helps. It gets easier, knowing that they are backing us," Lakshya said.

The third and final game was an exhibition of attacking badminton and deception from Lakshya as he won it 21-4, completely dismantling the challenge of Filimon. "Once my game plan started working, I became more free and my body language started changing," the star Indian shuttler said.

The changing body language was visible as he started enjoying his shots and having fun on the court. He started

with a down-the-line smash, then went on to deceive Filimon on the net and eventually use his drops to kill the points.

There was an exchange at the net where Lakshya hit to the right, moved left, and then dropped the shuttle on the opposite side of Filimon, almost mirroring a well-executed body feint on the football field.

To work on his understanding of drift, he trained at the big hall at the National Centre for Excellence in Guwahati. "The goal was to get used to conditions because we had a bit of time after our last tournament to prepare," he said.

Lakshya will take confidence from his win today, even as his draw got trickier with fifth seed Christo Popov getting knocked out in the opener by Kenta Nishimoto.

The "Superstar" — as described by the crowd — does not have an easy road ahead but he has the support, the preparation and a win now.

Evolution of the women's jump smash, and where Treesa's stacks up

Shivani Naik
New Delhi, August 18

THERE IS speed that's the length of a blink of the eye — like what Gayatri Gopichand has at the net. While the footwork and explosive stomp to the net are visible, Gayatri and Treesa Jolly's 21-15, 21-12 win over Americans Lauren Lam and Allison Lee also included the computer-processor-paced thinking of Gayatri, which proved the difference in the Round 2 win over opponents with the same ditto style as them, but smarter, swifter executions.

Then there is the altitude 3D pace that Treesa Jolly gets when she leaps high for jump smashes. "Treesa's smash is amazing. When I'm playing from the front, I can hear her smash," Gayatri said of the whoosh that streaks past her ear.

Circa 2005-06, the gazelle-like elegant style of women's badminton started soaring into the vertical plane.

Not only did the smash gain power, but it also boasted altitude. The women's jump smash has some outstanding poster girls now — in India, the finest at the elite level is Treesa.

Newly bestowed with the Arjuna Award declared on Tuesday, the duo calmly completed a start-to-finish victory, and logged court time over back-to-back matches to reach the Round of 16.

Returning from injury sustained on the eve of her Uber Cup departure, Treesa had taken her time to ease back into tournament play, winning in the Philippines.

But it was the familiar sight of Gayatri rushing to the front and, importantly, Treesa rushing to the back and taking off with her head bobbing on the Court 1 horizon that signalled the duo was back.

That sort of powerplay is not merely a preference now. With Chinese World No 1 in women's doubles, Liu-Tan



Treesa Jolly hits a jump smash as Gayatri Gopichand waits for the return in their match against USA's Lauren Lam and Allison Lee. PTI

making the plyo-power game the bedrock of their aggressive style, the women's game has transcended into a both-feet airborne full-blooded smash. In the Treesa-Gayatri match, American Lauren Lam mirrored the Treesa smash, albeit from the left side.

Perhaps the most effortless jump smasher among women is 3-time World Champion in singles, Akane Yamaguchi. "It just naturally came to me," she said after her first-round win. The 5-ft-1 naturally needed the yo-yo power with her frame

and her arching smash, where she drags the shuttle from well behind her head, is iconic now. A feat in agility, the underrated element is how she lands from a leap and carries on in long rallies. Her inspiration? "Arisa Higashino" — the former mixed doubles Olympic medallist with her men's partner Yuta Watanabe, whose explosive pop smash she matched.

The OG of women's jump smashing was in Delhi too. Scottish Kirsty Gilmour, who might've lost to Han Yue, but not before making life difficult

for the Chinese. She would name former World No 2, Julianne Schenk, as her inspiration. The jump-smashers cohort now has Thai Supanida Katethong along with Yamaguchi, while the likes of Chen Yufei, Wang Zhi Yi and PV Sindhu are more the hop smashers, reaching the shuttle on the bounce of toes.

The jump smash evolution, though, is sweeping through women's badminton — and Treesa-Gayatri are firmly on board now. "Treesa has the big jump smash, but I know I need to get better at the back court," Gayatri, who relies on angles and timing for her smashes, said.

IMPORTANT RESULTS:
MEN'S SINGLES: 14-Lakshya Sen (IND) bt Collins Filimon (AUT) 16-21, 21-8, 21-4; Kenta Nishimoto (JPN) bt S-Christo Popov (FRA) 21-17, 21-19; 3-Jonatan Christie (INA) bt Matthias Kicklitz (GER) 21-15, 21-14

WOMEN'S SINGLES: Unnati Hooda (IND) bt Thet Htar Thuzar (MYA) 22-20, 21-16; 4-Chen Yufei (CHN) bt Lo Sin Yan Happy (HKG) 18-21, 21-8, 21-11; 11-Nozomi Okuhara (JPN) bt Ozge Bayrak (TUR) 18-21, 21-16, 21-9
MEN'S DOUBLES: 4-Aaron Chia/Soh Wooi Yik (MAS) bt Peeratchai Sukphun/Pakapon Teeraratsakul (THA) 15-21, 21-11, 21-18

WOMEN'S DOUBLES: Treesa Jolly/Gayatri Gopichand (IND) bt Lauren Lam/Allison Lee (USA) 21-15, 21-12; Gabriela Stoeva/Stefani Stoeva (BUL) bt Kavipriya Selvam/Simran Singh (IND) 21-7, 21-14
MIXED DOUBLES: Jonathan Lai/Crystal Lai (CAN) bt Rohan Kapoor/Ruthvika Shivani Gadde (IND) 20-22, 21-19, 21-17; Emre Sonmez/Yasemen Bektas (TUR) bt Ashith Surya/Amrutha Pramuthesh (IND) 16-21, 30-29, 24-22.



नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री



राज्य के
दिल्ली सरकार



दिल्ली परिवहन निगम

राष्ट्रीय राजधानी क्षेत्र दिल्ली सरकार



रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

200 नई इलेक्ट्रिक बसें

एवं

लेडीज स्पेशल बस सेवा

एवं

दिल्ली-करनाल अंतरराज्यीय ई-बस सेवा तथा राजघाट डिपो-1 में पब्लिक ईवी चार्जिंग स्टेशन का

शुभारंभ

मुख्य अतिथि

सरदार तरनजीत सिंह संधू
माननीय उपराज्यपाल, दिल्ली

श्रीमती रेखा गुप्ता
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डॉ. पंकज कुमार सिंह
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श्री सूर्य प्रकाश खत्री
माननीय विधायक, तिमारपुर

दिनांक: 19 अगस्त 2026 | समय: 11:00 AM
दिल्ली यूनिवर्सिटी स्पोर्ट्स कॉम्प्लेक्स



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